

JOB

THE BOOK OF JOB.

PREFACE.

This Book takes its name from the holy man, of whom it treats; who, according to the more probable opinion, was of the race of Esau, and the same as Jobab, king of Edom, mentioned Gen.

xxxvi. 33. It is uncertain who was the writer of it. Some attribute it to Job himself; others to Moses, or some one of the prophets. In the Hebrew it is written in verse, from the beginning of the third chapter to the forty-second chapter. Ch. --- The beginning and conclusion are historical, and in prose.

Some have divided this work into a kind of tragedy, the first act extending to C.

xv., the second to C. xxii., the third to C. xxxviii., where God appears, and the plot is unfolded. They suppose that the sentiments of the speakers are expressed, though not their own words. This may be very probable: but the opinion of those who look upon the work as a mere allegory, must be rejected with horror. The sacred writers speak of Job as of a personage who had really existed, (C.) and set the most noble pattern of virtue, and particularly of patience. Tob. ii. 12. Ezec. xiv.

14. Jam. v. 11. Philo and Josephus pass over this history, as they do those of Tobias, Judith, &c.

H. --- The time when Job lived is not clearly ascertained. Some have supposed (C.) that he was a contemporary with Esther; (D. Thalmud) on which supposition, the work is here placed in its chronological order. But Job more probably live during the period when the Hebrews groaned under the Egyptian bondage, (H.) or sojourned in the wilderness. Num. xiv. 9. The Syrians place the book at the head of the Scriptures. C. --- Its situation has often varied, and is of no great importance. The subject which is here treated, is of far more; as it is intended to shew that the wicked sometimes prosper, while the good are afflicted. H. --- This had seldom been witnessed before the days of

Abraham: but as God had now selected his family to be witnesses and guardians of religion, a new order of things was beginning to appear. This greatly perplexed Job himself; who, therefore, confesses that he had not sufficiently understood the ways of God, till he had deigned to explain them in the parable of the two great beasts. C. xlii. 3. We cannot condemn the sentiments expressed by Job, since God has declared that they were right, (ib. v. 8) and reprimands Elihu, (C.

xxxviii. 2.) and the other three friends of Job, for maintaining a false opinion, though, from the history of past times, they had judge it to be true. This remark may excupate them from the stain of wilful lying, and vain declamation.

Houbigant. --- However, as they assert what was false, their words of themselves are of no authority; and they are even considered as the forerunners of heretics. S. Greg. S. Aug. &c. T. --- Job refutes them by sound logic. S. Jerom. --- We may discover in this book the sum of Christian morality, (W.) for which purpose it has been chiefly explained by S. Gregory. The style is very poetical, (H.) though at the same time simple, like that of Moses. D. --- It is interspersed with many Arabic and Chaldaic idioms; (S. Jer.) whence some have concluded, that it was written originally by Job and his friends (H.) in Arabic, and translated into Heb. by Moses, for the consolation of his brethren.

W.

--- The Heb. text is in many places incorrect; (Houbig.) and the Sept. seem to have omitted several verses. Orig. --- S. Jerom says almost eight hundred, (C.) each consisting of about six words. H. --- Shultens, in 1747, expressed his dissatisfaction with the labours of all preceding commentators. To explain this book may not therefore be an easy task: but we must be as short as possible.

H. --- Those who desire farther information, may consult Pineda, (W.) whose voluminous work, in two folios, will nearly (H.) give all necessary information.

C.

JOB 1

CHAPTER I.

Ver. 1. Hus. The land of Hus was a part of Edom; as appears from Lament. iv.

21. --- Simple.

That is, innocent, sincere, and without guile, (Ch.) in opposition to hypocrites and double dealers.

C. --- Heb. Tam, "perfect."

Ver. 3. Sheep. Heb. including "goats," which are equally valuable in that country for milk. ---

Camels. These animals were used for riding in those barren sands, where they can travel for four days without water; and that which is muddy is best for them. --- East, in the desert Arabia. Sept.

add at the end of the book, that Job was king; and he seems to have been independent, (C.) and to have had other kings who acknowledged his authority. Pineda. C. xxix. 7. &c. --- Each city had its own king in the days of Abraham and of Josue. Job, or Jobab, resided at Denaba. Gen. xxxvi.

32. C.

Ver. 4. His day of the week in succession; (Pineda) or each on his birthday, (Gen. xl. 20. Mat.

xiv. 6. Grot.) or once a month, &c. The daughters of Job were probably unmarried.

Ver. 5. Blessed. For greater horror of the very thought of blasphemy, the Scripture both here and v. 11, and in the following chapter (v. 5. and 9.) uses the word bless, to signify its contrary. Ch. 3

K. xxi. 10. --- Thus the Greeks styled the furies Eumenides, "the kind," out of a horror of their real name. Even those who are the best inclined, can hardly speak of God without some want of respect, (C.) in the midst of feasts, where the neglect of saying grace is also too common. H. ---

Sept. "they have thought evil against God." Every kind of offence may be included, to which feasting leads. M.

Ver. 6. The sons of God. The angels, (Ch.) as the Sept. express it. C. --- Satan also, &c. This passage represents to us in a figure, accommodated to the ways and understandings of men, 1.

The restless endeavours of satan against the servants of God. 2. That he can do nothing without God's permission. 3. That God doth not permit him to tempt them above their strength: but assists them by his divine grace in such manner, that the vain efforts of the enemy only serve to illustrate their virtue and increase their merit. Ch. --- A similar prosopopeia occurs, 3 K. xxii. 19.

Zac. i. 10. C. --- Devils appear not in God's sight, but sometimes in presence of angels, who represent God. S. Athan. q. 8. ad Antioc, (W.) or some ancient author. --- The good angels can make known their orders to them. Zac. iii. 1.

Jude 9. Both good and bad spirits may be considered as the ministers of God.

C. --- They appear in judgment; though the latter could not see the Lord.

Ver. 9. In vain, without recompense. H.

Ver. 11. Face, like a hypocrite, (Sanctius) or rather curse thee openly, v. 5. H.

Ver. 12. Hand. God permits evils. W. --- The devil can do nothing without leave.

C.

Ver. 15. Sabeans, descended from Abraham, in the desert (C.) or happy Arabia.

These nations lived on plunder. Pliny vi. 28. M.

Ver. 16. Heaven, or the air, where the devils exercise a power. Ephes. ii. 2.

Ver. 17. Chaldeans. Some copies of the Sept. read "horsemen." These nations inhabited the other side of the Euphrates, but made frequent incursions to plunder their neighbours. C.

Ver. 20. Head. Heb. torn his hair, and rolled in the dust. Bochart. Isai. xv. 2. &c.

C. --- The fathers oppose this example to the apathy of the stoics. S. Aug. de Civ. Dei. i. 9. Rom. i. 31.

Ver. 21. Thither. To that earth from which all are taken. H. --- Ista terra gentes omnes peperit & resumet demum. Varro. --- Ut ater operiens. Pliny ii. 63. See 1

Tim. vi. 7. --- As...done. Some copies of S. Jerom omit this, which is borrowed from the Sept. C.

Ver. 22. By his lips, is not in Heb. but occurs C. ii. 10. --- God. Much less did he blaspheme, as satan had said, v. 11. He did not consider all as the effect of chance, or like a mere philosopher.

His thoughts were regulated by religion and the fear of God. C. --- The virtue of Job was so much the more wonderful, as he lived among the wicked. S. Greg.

He bore patiently with the loss of all things: and English Catholics have often imitated him. W. --- He might well record his own good actions, the gifts of God, being moved by divine inspiration, like Moses, &c. S. Greg.

JOB 2

CHAPTER II.

Ver. 1. Day. Job had been under trial for some time, perhaps a year. C.

Ver. 2. Through it. Seeking whom he might devour. 1 Pet. v. 8. H.

Ver. 3. Simple. Plain-dealing, mild, and without guile. S. Greg. W. --- Without cause. This may form a new sentence. H. --- Thy proposal and attempts are vain. C. --- Job has not deserved this treatment. S. Chrys. &c.

Ver. 4. Skin: a proverbial expressing, denoting that a man will part with any thing sooner than his life, (C.) or health. H. --- Satan hints, that if those inestimable blessings should be endangered, (C.) Job would shew his real sentiments. H. --- Skin was formerly used instead of money, at Sparta. Senec.

Ben. v. 14. &c. Yet perhaps not in the time of Job.

Ver. 6. Life. Afflict him with any species of illness; but do not kill him, (C.) nor inspire him directly with wicked thoughts. Grot.

Ver. 7. Ulcer; the leprosy: and even with that species which is called the venereal disease, which may be contracted without any crime. Job was afflicted with a complication of the most painful and disgraceful disorders.

Pineda. C.

Ver. 8. Potsherd. His nails were worn, and poverty had left him nothing else. ---

Dunghill. Heb.

"ashes." H. --- S. Chrysostom represents this place as visited by pilgrims, instructive and more brilliant than any throne. Hom. 5. ad Pop. Ant. -- Sept.

add, "upon the dung, without the city: and after a long time had elapsed, his wife also said to him, How long wilt thou wait, saying: Lo, I will still tarry a little while, expecting the hope of my salvation? For behold thy memory is perished from the land, thy sons and daughters, the pains and labours of my womb, whom I brought forth in labour and sorrow, to no purpose. But thou sittest in the open air, the night long, amid the corruption of worms, while I wander like a slave, seeking for one place and house after another, in expectation of the sun setting, that my labours may cease, and the sorrows which now surround and hold me fast. But speak thou some word to (or against) the Lord, and die."

H. ---

This addition has been omitted in the Comp. edition, to make it like the Vulg.

(C.) though it is found in all the Greek copies (Nobilis) and fathers, and also in several Latin Bibles. It seems, however, to be only a gloss of some transcriber. The devil had not destroyed this wife, as she would prove one of his most powerful auxiliaries. C.

Ver. 9. Bless. She speaks with cruel irony. C. --- Curse God, that he may take away (S. Basil) thy miserable life; or, after taking this revenge on such unjust treatment, put an end to thy own existence. Beza and Amama excuse this woman, though condemned by Job. They pretend that she only meant to insinuate, like the rest of his friends, that he must be guilty of some grievous crime, which she urges him to confess, giving glory to God, before it be too late. H.

Ver. 10. Foolish. The same word often means impious, (C. i. 22.) and ignorant, (H.) or

"delirious." Aquila. Ps. xiii. 1. --- Lips. The Jews assert, without reason, that he was guilty in his heart. C.

Ver. 12. Heaven. This denoted mourning or indignation. Jos. vii. 6. Acts xxii. 23.

Ver. 13. Seven days, &c. They sat with him for a good part of the day, and of the night, during seven days: and spoke nothing all that time that could give him any uneasiness. Ch. M.

Olympiad. --- They mourned for him as if he had been dead. Their mutual grief was too great for utterance. But the text seems to intimate that they remained with Job, all this time. Scultet. C.

--- Their design in coming was really to afford him consolation; but being under a mistake, respecting the conduct of Providence towards mankind, (C.) they erred involuntarily, (T.) and by attempting to prove their assertions, as if none but criminals could be so grievously afflicted, they eventually insulted the holy man. Tob. ii. 15. --- They argued on the principle, "that under a just God no one is miserable, unless he have deserved it;" not reflecting that god sometimes puts his best servants to the trial, that their merit and glory may increase. Notwithstanding their piety and learning, they became therefore the devil's most powerful agents unawares: (C.) and though they were not properly heretics, as they acquiesced when better informed, they were a figure of them, by drawing from many undeniable truths false inferences, and by a parade of learning, and of new things. S. Greg. Mor. iii. 24. and v. 18. --- They also judged rashly of Job's secret behaviour. W.

JOB 3

CHAPTER III.

Ver. 1. Cursed his day. Job cursed the day of his birth, not by way of wishing evil to any thing of God's creation; but only to express in a stronger manner his sense of human miseries in general, and of his own calamities in particular.

Ch. --- He has these only in view: though, in another light, it is better for a man to be born, and to undergo any misery, that he may obtain eternal rewards. H.

--- Some allowances must be made for extreme pain, and for the style of the Eastern (C.) poetry. H. --- Jeremias, (xx. 14.) Habacuc, (i. 2.) the psalmist, and even our Saviour in his agony, made use of such strong expressions. Mat.

xxvi. 39. and xxvii. 46. Some heretics accuse Job of impatience and blasphemy. The devil, therefore came off with victory; and the praises given to Job's patience are false. He might offend by some degree of exaggeration. C.

But even that is by no means clear. Time past could not be recalled, nor receive any injury by the maledictions. H.

Ver. 7. Praise, by the appearance of the stars. C. xxxviii. 7. C.

Ver. 8. Day. The nations of Ethiopia, under the line, curse the sun as their greatest enemy.

Strabo xvii. Pliny v. 8. --- They also brave the fury of the leviathan or crocodile.

C. xl. 27. and xli. 1. Ps. lxxiii. 14. The natives of Tentyra, upon the Nile, were supposed to be a terror to that monster, or they were very

courageous in entangling and pursuing it. Seneca q. 4. 2. Pliny viii.

25. --- Leviathan. Prot. "their mourning." De Dieu rejects this interpretation, substituting "and thou, leviathan, rouse up," &c. The fathers generally understand the devil to be thus designated.

Sept. "he who is about to seize the great whale," (H.) or fish, which they also explain of the conflict of Satan with Jesus Christ." Origen, &c.

Ver. 10. Nor took. Sept. "for it would then have freed my eyes from labour."

Ver. 11. In the. Heb. "from the womb," (H.) or as soon as I was born. C. --- He seems to have lost sight of original sin, (v. 1.) or there might be some method of having it remitted to children unborn, which we do not know. H.

Ver. 12. Knees, by my father or grandfather. Gen. xxx 3. Iliad ix. C.

Ver. 13. Sleep. So death is often styled.

Olli dura quies oculos et ferreus urget

Somnus: in æternam clauduntur lumina noctem. Æneid x.

Ver. 14. Consuls. Heb. "counsellors," or any in great authority. Sept. "kings, the counsellors of the land, who rejoiced, boasting of their swords." The same word, *choraboth*, (H.) means both swords and solitudes. D. --- Those great ones had prepared their own tombs, which were usually in solitary places; (C.) or they had filled all with their extensive palaces; and removed the people to a distance. H.

Ver. 15. Houses, while alive; (C.) or their tombs were thus enriched with silver, (M.) as this practice was not uncommon, v. 22. Joseph. xiii. 15. --- Marcian forbade it. S. Chrys. complains it subsisted in his time. Orat. Annæ. C.

Ver. 16. Light; dying in the womb. He expresses a desire that he had been thus prevented from feeling his present miseries and danger of sin. H.

Ver. 17. Tumult. In the grave they can no longer disturb the world. M. - -- In strength. Sept. "in body." Both heroes and labourers then find rest, (C.) if they have lived virtuously. H.

Ver. 18. Bound in chains, like incorrigible slaves, (C.) or debtors. Cocceius. ---

These were formerly treated with great severity. Luke xii. 59. C.

Ver. 21. Not. They feel the same eagerness for death as those who seek for a treasure; (C.) and when death is at hand, they rejoice no less than those who discover a grave, in which they hope to find some riches, v. 15. 22.

Ver. 22. Grave, full of stores, or the place where they may repose. H.

Ver. 23. To. Why is life given to? &c. The uncertainty whether a man be worthy of love or hatred, (Ecclii. ix. 1.) and whether he will persevere to the end, is what fills Job with distress; though we must trust that God will suffer none to be tempted above their strength. 1 Cor. x. 13.

--- He finds himself surrounded with precipices, and in the dark. C. --- So God often tries his faithful servants. D.

Ver. 24. Sigh, through difficulty of swallowing, (Pineda) or sense of misery. H.

Ver. 25. Fear. In prosperity he feared the assaults of pride. Now he is in danger of yielding to impatience and despair. C.

Ver. 26. Dissembled my sufferings, making no complaint, not only during the seven days that his friends had been with him, but long before. Heb. and Sept.

"I was not in safety, nor at rest; neither was I indolent: (H. in the administration of affairs. C.) yet trouble came." H. --- I have enjoyed no peace, since the wrath of the Lord has found me. C. --- In such a situation, Job might well beg to be delivered, (H.) and to pray that those things which obstructed his repose in God might be removed; considering them not so much as the works of God, as the effects of sin.

Pineda. W. --- In this light he cursed his birth-day, and will no longer look upon it as a joyful and happy day. D.

JOB 4

CHAPTER IV.

Ver. 1. Themanite. People of this city, about twelve miles from Petra, in Arabia, were renowned for wisdom. Jer. xlix. 7. Bar. ii. 22. Pythagoras therefore visited this country. S. Cyr. con. Jul. x.

--- Eliphaz attempts to prove that no innocent person is chastised. He does not speak of small faults, to which any person may be exposed, and which God may severely punish. But he will have Job to be a great offender, at least in secret, and represents himself in too advantageous a light; though he was really a good man, and meant well. C. --- But this did not exempt him from sin, (C. xlii.) no more than Eliu. C. xxxii. Bonum ex integra causa; malum ex quolibet defectu; as theologians agree. H.

Ver. 2. Conceived? and to which the speech of Job had given occasion. M. ---

Sept. "Who shall bear the force of thy words? For if thou," &c. H.

Ver. 4. Knees. It is just that thou shouldst apply thy instructions to thyself. M.

Ver. 5. And thou. Sept. "and has touched thee. But thou makest haste" (H.) to flee. Heb. "art consternated." We may easily prescribe for others, but when we are sick we know not what to do. C.

Ver. 6. Where? Sept. "Rather is not thy fear foolishness as well as thy hope, and the innocence of thy path?" H. --- Is not all hypocrisy? M. C. --- Many of the assertions of Job's friends are true, but their inferences are false. M.

Ver. 7. Destroyed? They never were eternally. But Abel and many other just persons, have been exposed to tribulation in this world, (W.) for their greater improvement. Yet Eliphaz falsely concludes from the sufferings of Job, that he must have been a criminal. C. --- If any one

should now hold the same opinion, we should deem him very ignorant or foolish. But we have observed, (Pref.) that this was not so obvious at that time. Cain, the giants, Her, Onan, Sodom,

&c. had been made examples of divine vengeance. But a new order of things was now commencing.

Houbigant.

**Ver. 8. Reap them. He insinuates that Job now reaps what he had sown.
Gal. vi.**

8.

Ver. 11. Tiger. Heb. Layish, means also an "old lion." Sept. murmekoleon, "antlion," which some have deemed fabulous, improperly. Bochart, vi. 5. Ælian, xvii. 42. --- Eliphaz tacitly accuses Job of violence and pride. Ven. Bede. C.

Ver. 12. Private. Heretics pretend such obscure visions, rather to get credit than to edify others.

S. Greg. v. 18. W. --- Many suppose that Eliphaz was guilty of feigning: but the greatest part think that he had truly seen a vision, but did not draw the proper conclusion from it. C. --- Prot.

"Now a thing was secretly brought to me, and mine ear received a little thereof." H.

Ver. 13. The horror. Heb. "thoughts," while I considered the cause of thy distress. C.

Ver. 15. Spirit: angel, or gentle breeze. C.

Ver. 16. And I. Prot. " there was silence, and I heard a voice." Marg. "a still voice." Sept. "But I heard a breeze and a voice." H.

Ver. 17. Maker. It is thought that these were the words of the angel. If God punish without cause, may not the sufferer esteem himself the better of the two? You must therefore be guilty.

C. --- Job would never dispute; but God was infinitely more pure than man, who may nevertheless be free from grievous sins. W. --- The highest angel has nothing but what he has received from God, in comparison with whom he is still as a mere nothing. But this does not prove that Job was a criminal, or that he pretended to arrogate to himself any excellence, independent of the giver of all good gifts. He did

not assert that he was impeccable: yet, with God's grace, he might be innocent. C.

**Ver. 18. Angels, who fell, as the fathers explain it. E. T. --- Heb.
"behold, he put no trust in his servants, and his angels he charged with
folly." C. xv. 15. and xxv. 5. and 2 Pet. ii. 4. Prot. H.**

**Ver. 19. Foundation. Children of Adam, whose bodies are taken from
the dust.**

M.

Ver. 20. Understandeth. Heb. "regardeth." Sept. "can help himself." H. --- Man is justly punished because he does not reflect on what he ought. C.

Ver. 21. And they. Heb. "doth not their dignity pass away with them? They die without wisdom." H. --- This is but too frequently the case of the great ones of this world, who never discern true from false riches. C.

JOB 5

CHAPTER V.

Ver. 1. Saints. This is a proof of the invocation of the saints (C.) and angels. H.

--- The Jews often begged God to have mercy on them for the sake of the patriarchs. 2 Par. vi. 42. C. ---

Eliphaz, therefore, exhorts Job, if he have any patron or angel, to bring him forward in his defence. M. --- Sept. "Invoke now if any one will hear thee, or if thou perceive any of the holy angels," (H.) as I have done. M. --- He extols himself, to correct the pretended presumption of his friend, (C.) and other defects, which none will dare to deny, as he supposes. See S. Greg. v. 30.

W.

Ver. 2. Foolish and...little, here denote the wicked, as in the book of Proverbs.

C. --- He accuses Job of anger (M.) and folly. C.

Ver. 3. And I. Sept. "But presently their subsistence was eaten up." I envied not their riches: but judged they would soon end. H.

Ver. 4. Gate, in judgment. M.

Ver. 6. Ground. If you had not sinned, you would not suffer. C.

Ver. 7. Bird. Heb. "sparks fly up." H. --- You can no more then expect to pass unpunished, since it is impossible for man to be innocent! (C.) and, at any rate, labour is inevitable. M. --- We must gain our bread by the sweat of our brow. W.

Ver. 8. I will, or if I were in your place, I would sue for pardon. C. --- Prot. "I would seek unto God," (H.) under affliction. M.

Ver. 15. Mouth; detraction and calumny. C.

Ver. 19. In six, mentioned below; (M.) or in many, indefinitely. C. --- Both during the six days of (M.) life, and at death, God's grace delivers us. S. Greg. W.

Ver. 21. Scourge. Ecclus. (xxvi. 9. and xxviii. 21.) has the same expression. See Jam. iii. 6. C.

--- Calamity, from robbers, as the Heb. shod, (H.) intimates. The word is rendered destruction, vastitate, v. 22. M.

Ver. 23. Stones, so as not to stumble; or, the rocks will be a retreat for thee.

Ver. 24. Beauty does not mean his wife, as some grossly imagine, (C.) but a house well ordered.

M. --- Heb. "thy habitation." Yet Sanchez adopts the former sentiment. In effect, the habitation includes all the regulation of a wife and family. H.

Ver. 26. Abundance. "With loud lamentations." De Dieu. --- "In full age, like as a shock of corn cometh in its season." Prot. --- After a life spent in happiness, thy memory will not be obliterated.

Many shall bewail thy loss. H.

Ver. 27. Which thou. Sept. "And what we have heard: but do thou reflect with thyself what thou hast done." H. --- What had been revealed to Eliphaz was very true. Yet his conclusions were unwarrantable. C. --- How confidently does he speak of his own knowledge, and how great must have been his disappointment, when God condemned him of folly, and sent him to be the prayers of that very man whom he now considered as a wretched sinner! H.

JOB 6

CHAPTER VI.

Ver. 2. My sins, &c. In the Heb. my wrath. He does not mean to compare his sufferings with his real sins; but with the imaginary crimes which his friends falsely imputed to him: and especially with his wrath or grief, expressed in the third chapter, which they so much accused. Though, as he tells them here, it bore no proportion with the greatness of his calamity. Ch. --- Job does not deny but he may have transgressed. C. See C. vii. 20. --- But his is not conscious of any mortal offence; such as his friends insisted he must have committed, as he was so cruelly tormented. H.

--- Some deny canonical authority to the words of Job, because God reprehended him. But S.

Greg. (Mor. vii.) says, Ab æterno judice casurus laudari non potuit. D. - -- "The man who was on the point of falling, could not be praised by the eternal Judge;" (H.) and it seems to be a mistake that Job erred, (Houbig.) though asserted by many. See C. W. &c. --- Wrath. Heb. "O that my grief (H. or complaints. C.) were thoroughly weighed, and my calamity laid in the balances together." Prot. H. --- A just man confesses his own sins, but not those which are wrongfully laid to his charge. W.

Ver. 3. Heavier. The figure hyperbole is frequently used in Scripture, to give us some idea of what surpasses our understanding. Job intimates that he punishment was incomparably greater than his sins. As he and other saints, particularly our Saviour and the blessed Virgin, have thus patiently suffered more than they had deserved, these merits form part of that treasure of the Church, out of which the pope and bishops are empowered to dispense indulgences, to release people from the pains due to sin, either in this world or in purgatory. W. --- Sept. "Yea, these (sorrows) are heavier than the sand of the seashore. But, it seems my words are wicked." H.

Ver. 4. Rage. Heb. "poison," (H.) or "venom;" (Chal. M.) as it was customary to use poisoned arrows. C. --- Sept. "When I begin to speak, they pierce me. For what! Does the wild ass continually bray, except when he is in quest of food?"

H. --- It is easy for those to be silent who suffer nothing. The wild asses were so common in those parts, (C.) that Herod sometimes slew 40 in a hunt.

Joseph. Bel. i. 16. --- Many fabulous account have been given of them. Some are still found in Ethiopia resembling a mule, except in the ears, and beautifully striped with grey, black, and reddish colours. Bernier.

Ver. 6. Salt. I wonder not that you should consider my lamentations as insipid; I now find some consolation in them, v. 7. C. --- Or can. Heb. "or is there any taste in the white of an egg?"

(Prot.) or in blue milk? (Mercer) or "in the spittle, which a man swallows in a dream?" See Isai.

xxviii. 8. If pain did not extort these complaints, should I find any pleasure in them? C. --- Sept.

"is there any taste in vain words?" Can I hear your arguments without indignation? H. M. ---

Some MSS. add, "For to a hungry soul even bitter things appear to be sweet,"

from Prov. xxvii. 7.

C.

Ver. 9. Off, and release me from this state of misery and danger. H. --- He is ready to die cheerfully, if it be God's will. C. --- Sept. "May the Lord, who has begun, wound me, but not take me away finally. Yea, let my city, over which I have exulted, be my grave. I will not spare, for I have not belied a word of my holy God." H.

Ver. 11. End. Sept. "time." I am too weak and short-lived to bear all this. H. --- I can perceive no end. M. --- Keep. Prot. "prolong my life." H. --- "What is the extent of my soul, to reach so far?" C. --- Longanimity is the characteristic of a great soul. H.

Ver. 12. Brass. This is proverbial. Homer (Iliad A) says, "Attack the Greeks; their skin is neither of stone, (C.) iron, or brass." Those who are aware of their own frailty, ought not to expose themselves to dangerous company, particularly to those of the other sex.

Ver. 13. Myself. "Have I not placed my trust in him?" God alone. H. --- All my other friends have abandoned me, v. 15. C. --- Can they wonder if I express my grief? H. --- Familiar. Heb.

"is wisdom removed far from me?" H. --- Has my strength abandoned me, so that I cannot be recognized? C.

Ver. 16. Them. They shall run from a less to a greater evil. C. --- Sept. "Those who respected me, have now fallen upon me, like snow or ice; (17) as when it is consumed with heat, it is no longer known where it was: (18) thus I have been abandoned by all, lost and expelled from my house." Consider, (19) Heb.

continues, in the comparison of the torrents, (15) "which are hidden by the ice and snow," and are left dry and of no service in summer, when most wanted.

**H. --- So these friends stood by me only in the days of my prosperity. C.
---**

Luther and the Dutch version follow the Vulg. Amama says, improperly. He proposes that of Pagnin, "which (torrents) are darkened by the ice. Snow is concealed in (Mont. upon) them." H.

Ver. 18. Entangled. Like meandering streams, my friends act crookedly. M.

Ver. 19. While. Till the torrents subside, when the caravans from these towns of Arabia may pass on. Job may also address his friends, (C.) and bid them consider how few had taken any notice of him. M. --- Prot. "the troops of Tema looked, the companies of Sheba waited for them."

Ver. 20. I. Heb. "they had hoped" to pass along. H.

Ver. 21. Come. Heb. "are good for nothing." C. --- Prot. marg. " like to them."

Ver. 25. Why. Heb. "How strong are the words of truth!" C. --- Whereas. Prot.

"But what doth your arguing reprove?" What part of my discourse do you find erroneous? Sept. "But it seems the words of the man of truth are deceitful. Yet I do not beg from you (a word or) strength." H.

Ver. 26. Wind. Job humbles the vanity of Eliphaz. C. --- Sept. "nor shall your rebuke silence my words: for I will not admit the sound of your discourse. Nay, you rush," &c.

Ver. 30. Mouth. He engages their attention. C. --- Heb. "Cannot my taste discern perverse things," (Prot. H.) or "the evil" which I endure? My complaints are not surely unfounded. C.

JOB 7

CHAPTER VII.

Ver. 1. Warfare. Heb. "is it not determined" (H.) for some short space, as the Levites had to serve from 30 to 50 years of age; (Num. iv. 3. and viii. 25.) and the days of a hireling are also defined and short. Isai. xvi. 14. Amama. --- No soldier or hireling was ever treated so severely as Job. Yet they justly look for the term of their labours. Sept. have peiraterion. Old Vulg. tentatio.

"Is not the life of man a temptation?" C. --- Palæstra, school, or time given to learn the exercise of a soldier and wrestler; or of one who has to prepare himself for a spiritual warfare, and for heaven. H. --- Are we not surrounded with dangers? and may we not desire to be set at liberty?

The Vulg. is very accurate, (C.) and includes all these senses. H. --- A soldier must be obedient even unto death, and never resist his superior. W. ---

Hireling, who has no rest till the day is spent. C.

Ver. 3. And have. Heb. "they have appointed for me." C. --- God treats me with more severity, as even the night is not a time of rest for me, and my months of service are without any present recompense. H.

Ver. 4. And again. Heb. "and the night be completed, I toss to and fro," (H.) or "I am disturbed with dreams, (C.) till day break." Vulg. insinuates that night and day are equally restless to a man in extreme pain. H. --- As I find no comfort, why may I not desire to die? M. --- I desire to be dissolved, as being much better, said S. Paul.

Ver. 6. Web. Heb. "the weaver's shuttle." C. xvi. 23. Isa. xxxviii. 12. H. --- The pagans have used the same comparison. But they make the three daughters of Necessity guide the thread of life. Plato Rep. xii. Natal. iii. 6. --- Sept. "my life is swifter than speech." Tetrapla, "than a runner." C. --- Hope. Heu fugit, &c. Ah!

time is flying , never to return! H.

Ver. 7. Wind. What is life compared with eternity, or even with past ages? C. ---

"What is any one? Yea, what is no one? Men are the dream of a shadow," says Pindar; (Pyth. viii. Skias onar onthropoi) "like the baseless fabric of a vision."

Shakespeare.

Ver. 8. Eyes, in anger, (C.) or thy mercy will come too late when I shall be no more.

Ver. 9. Hell, or the grave. M. --- He was convinced of the resurrection. But he meant that, according to the natural course, we can have no means of returning to this world after we are dead.

Ver. 10. More. This may be explained both of the soul and of the body. Ps. cii.

16. The former resides in the body for a short time, and then seems to take no farther notice of it (C.) till the resurrection.

Ver. 11. Mouth. I will vent my bitter complaints before I die. H.

Ver. 12. Sea. Ungovernable and malicious. Some of the ancients looked upon the sea as a huge animal, whose breathing caused the tides. Strabo i. Solin xxxii. --- They represented its fury as proverbial. "Fire, the sea, and woman are three evils;" and they call the most savage people sons of Neptune. Agel. xv.

21. --- Am I so violent as to require such barriers? Am I capacious, or strong enough to bear such treatment? C.

Ver. 15. Hanging. Prot. "strangling and death, rather than my life," or Marg.

"bones." H. --- Any species of Death would be preferable to this misery. C. ---

Who would not entertain the same sentiments, if the fear of worse in the other world did not withhold him? But Job had reason to hope that his sorrows would end with his life. H. --- It is thought that he was

dreadfully tempted to despair. C. --- Yet he resisted manfully, and overcame all attempts of the wicked one.

Ver. 16. Hope of surviving this misery. H.

Ver. 17. Magnify him, or put his to such severe trials. He is not worthy of thy attention. C. ---

Heb. ii. 6. H.

Ver. 18. Suddenly. During his whole life, he is exposed to dangers; (C.) of if, at first, he taste some comfort, that is presently over. The greatest saints have experienced this treatment. H.

Ver. 20. Sinned. I acknowledge my frailty. M. --- How may I obtain redress? C.

--- Job's friends maintained that he was guilty. But he does not acquiesce in their conclusion, that these sufferings were precisely in punishment of some crime, though he acknowledges that he is not without his faults. H. --- Shall.

Heb. also, "what have I done to thee?" I have only hurt myself. But this reasoning is nugatory. Though God loses nothing by our sins, they are not less offensive to him, as the rebel does his utmost to disturb the order which he has established. The sinner indeed resembles those brutal people, who hurl darts against the sun, which fall upon their own heads.

C. iii. 8. C. --- Opposite, as a butt to shoot at. H. --- Myself. Heb. was formerly

"to thee," till the Jews changed it, as less respectful. Cajet. --- Sept. still read,

"and why am I a burden to thee?"

(H.) as I am under the necessity of complaining, in my own defence. C. --- I throw my grief upon the Lord, that He may support me. Ps. liv. 23. 1 Pet. v. 7.

Pineda.

Ver. 21. Be. He lovingly expostulates with God, and begs that he would hasten his deliverance, lest it should be too late. C.

JOB 8

CHAPTER VIII.

Ver. 1. Suhite, from Sue, the son of Abraham, who dwelt in the desert Arabia; (Gen. xxv. 2.) though several suppose, without reason, (C.) that Baldad resided at Sueta, in Cœlosyria. M. ---

He was the second in age and dignity. Pineda.

Ver. 2. How long. He seems tired with hearing, (H.) and accuses Job of want of moderation, representing him as a hypocrite, (C.) and an obstinate defender of his own opinion, against the better judgment of Eliphaz; (M.) though he was in reality only a constant asserter of truth. W.

Ver. 3. Just. He begins with the same principle as Eliphaz, which nobody denied. But he does not reflect, that God may cause even the just to be afflicted, for their trial and improvement.

Ver. 4. Iniquity, and suffered them to perish. C.

Ver. 6. Peaceable. Justice and peace shall kiss. H. --- Prosperity will attend the righteous. C.

Ver. 9. That. Heb. "because our days." H. --- Baldad strives, in vain, to prove what nobody contested. But he does not come to the point, and shew that Job was guilty. Past histories might have informed him that the just are often persecuted, like Abel, Abraham, Jacob, and Joseph. C.

--- It is true, these were afterwards comforted in honour, except the first, who was slain, and better off in the other world. But Job might hope for the same treatment; and no man can be pronounced happy or miserable till his death.

After a storm a calm frequently ensues; as Baldad might have seen verified in the person of his friend, if he had waited patiently, and not

judged so peremptorily from equivocal arguments. H. --- We must allow, however, that what he said had been generally true. Houbigant.

Ver. 11. Sedge-bush, or flag. Heb. achu; so called, because from one root many brothers (as it were) spring. Sept. style it Boutomon, as it was usually "cut for oxen." Gen. xli. 2. Parkhurst.

H. --- As plants die without suction, so do those who depart from God. M.

Ver. 12. Herbs, for want of moisture. C. --- Sic transit gloria mundi. H. -- The prophets often compare the prosperity of the wicked to grass, (Ps. xxxvi. 2.

Jam. i. 10.) and Baldad ranks Job with them.

Ver. 14. Him, the hypocrite, or God. C. --- Both shall one day condemn the ill use of riches. H.

Ver. 15. He. The spider, or rather the hypocrite, who will not be able to screen himself, by his possessions, from the wrath of God. C.

Ver. 16. Seemeth. Heb. "he is green before the sun" beat upon him. --- Rising, ortu, for horto, (H.) as the Heb. &c. have "garden," (M.) with some Latin editions. He had compared the wicked to a rush without moisture. But the just is like a plant in a fine garden, which is not hurt by the sun beams. It will grow even among stones, (C.) and may be transplanted without danger, v. 19.

H. --- The whole may be, however, a continuation of the former simile. The rush will presently be scorched, as if it were thrown among stones, and its place will know it no longer, v. 18. M.

Ver. 19. Joy. Sept. "the catastrophe of the wicked, for another shall spring," &c.

H.

Ver. 21. Until. If thou be simple, (H.) or irreproachable, (C.) God will make thee exult. H. ---

Until, &c. M. --- He will restore thee to thy former state of affluence. C.

JOB 9

CHAPTER IX.

Ver. 2. God. Job answers both his friends, and with admirable humility acknowledges that in God's sight he is full of defects; but not of such a nature as to fall (C.) under the cognizance of man. I am not conscious to myself of anything; but...God is the judge. 1 Cor. iv. 4. H.

Ver. 3. Thousand. Ps. cxlii. 2. "Woe even to the praise-worthy life of man, if God judge without mercy." S. Aug. H.

Ver. 4. Resisted. Heb. and Sept. "hardened himself against him."

Ver. 5. Removed, by earthquakes. Pliny ii. 83. C. --- In Calabria, 5th Feb. &c.

1783, during the most destructive and dreadful earthquake, a level valley was removed entire about a mile, and a hill, with the trees still growing, was projected down a declivity half a mile, and another above four miles. Sir W.

Hamilton. --- Sept. "who makes the mountains grown old, and they know not who overturns them in his wrath." H. --- Kings and empires fall to ruin at his command. C.

Ver. 6. Pillars. These are represented as fixed in the waters. Prov. viii. 29. Ps.

xxvii. 16. &c.

Ver. 7. Seal. So that they appear not. He alludes (C.) to masters confining their servants with seals, before locks were invented. Macrob. vii. 3. --- From these noble effects of God's power, Job takes occasion to humble himself. C.

Ver. 8. Heavens, like a tent. Ps. ciii. 2. These nations lived under tents; (C.) and beholding the magnificent one which God had spread over the

heads of alol, Job, in rapture, (H.) wonders that he should have created such a pavilion for his servants.

Ver. 9. Arcturus, &c. These are names of stars or constellations. In Hebrew, Hash, Cesil, and Cima. Ch. --- And chadre theman, (H.) the "bottom or seals of the south," which were to him invisible, being the Antarctic constellations. The ancients were acquainted only with these four, (Homr, Virg. Æn. iii. &c.) which denoted the four quarters and seasons. C. --- Ash, Arcturus, "the bear's tail,"

near the north pole, (H.) rules in autumn, when the year begins (C.) in Arabia.

Cesil, (H.) or Orion, on the west, styled by astronomers "the heart of the scorpion," rises about the autumnal equinox, and presides over winter; (C.) and Cima, (H.) the Hyades, or the seven "rainy"

stars, do over spring, the "pleasing" season, as Cima denotes, (C. xxxviii. 31.) when navigation commences. "The Seals of the south," designate summer. C.

--- We must not, however, imagine that Job countenances poetical fables; (S.

Jerom in Amos v. 8.) or that he called the constellations by these names, Arcturus, &c. C. --- Heb. "who makes the fire, the spirit, and the light," Cima.

C. xxxviii. 31. H. --- The creation of these seems grander than the making of any constellation, and all the stars had been asserted to be the work of God, v.

7. What connection is there between the names assigned by the Rabbins and the Heb. terms? R. Abraham observes that the last is "a northern star, causing heat, and producing fruit." Parkhurst. --- The Arabs were convinced of the influence of the stars; (C. xxxviii. 31.) and living under a sky generally without clouds, could easily observe them. Roger. ii. 2.

and 15. --- Sanchez asserts, that the peasants in Spain can point out the stars by name. C. --- Inner. Prot.

**"the chambers." They agree with the Vulg. in the other names. Sept.
"who makes the Pleiads, and Hesper, and Arcturus, and the store-
rooms of the south? H. --- They are styled inner with respect to us, who
cannot see them.**

**Ver. 11. Understand, as he is a spirit; (M.) and not that God is
changeable, but his works and judgments are above our
comprehension, and we are always liable to change. Hence the proud
erroneously think themselves to be in favour; while the humble, on the
contrary, keep at a distance, and still sue for pardon, when their sins
have been forgiven. Luke xviii. 13. Eccle. ii. 1.**

C.

Ver. 13. God. Prot. " If God will not withdraw his anger, the proud helpers do stoop under him. "

Sept. "For he is not turned aside by wrath;" (or Rom. edit.) "God, whose anger cannot be averted," (H.) unless we repent: (C.) "under him the whales below heaven bend." H. --- Perhaps they may have had some notions, like the Rabbins, respecting Leviathan; and S. Jerom may have alluded to the fable of the giants placed under mountains; (Æn. iii. and ix. C.) or to Atalas propping the skies. H. --- World. Great heroes, (C.) Kings, (Pineda) angels, (M.) who move the spheres, (W.) or devils. Eph. vi. 12. Cajetan.

Ver. 14. What? Heb. "Much less shall I answer him, choosing even my words with him." H. ---

This is the conclusion from the display of God's power. C. --- No eloquence will persuade him.

H. --- Though not conscious of any sin, Job will not justify himself (1 Cor. iv.

W.) before God.

H.

Ver. 16. Voice. So much am I beneath his notice. How unjust were the aspersions of Job's friends, who accused him of presumption and blasphemy!

C. --- No one ever spoke with greater humility (H.) and respect of God's absolute dominion. C. --- He will attribute nothing to his own prayers, as he is still in the dark. M.

Ver. 17. Without cause. That is, without my knowing the cause; or without any crime of mine.

Ch. --- To argue from my afflictions, that I am a criminal, is unjust. C. ii. 3.

"Notions mistaken, reasonings ill apply'd,

And sophisms that conclude on either side." Pope, Pleasures, &c.

Ver. 19. Equity. Heb. "if judgment, who will appoint me a time," (H.) or "set me before him,"

and undertake my defence? Who will dare to sit as judge between us?

Ver. 20. Condemn me, as this conduct would appear presumptuous. C. -- Sept.

"if I be just, my mouth will utter impiety," (H.) in declaring it. Olymp.

Ver. 21. Life, under this uncertainty and affliction. M.

Ver. 22. Consumeth. Eccle. ix. 2. H. --- This principle is incontrovertible. W. --- I do not retract it. M. --- The misery inflicted on the just, is not contrary to the goodness of the Almighty. Job perfectly

discovered this truth, which puzzled his enlightened friends, and most of those who lived before Christ; (Ps. lxxii. 2.

Jer. xii. 1. C.) and even Job himself was not fully convinced of the motives of the Providence, till God had explained them. Houbigant. C. xlii.

Ver. 23. Innocent. Having expressed his sentiments clearly, now he mentions what he could desire under the pressure of misery. M. --- Seeing the danger of falling, to which he was exposed, he begged to be delivered by death. We are taught by our Saviour to pray, Lead us not into temptation. Matt. vi. 13. God does not laugh at our sufferings, but he acts like a surgeon, and cuts without minding our complaints. Ridere Dei est humanæ nolle afflictioni misereri. S.

Greg.

C. --- Heb. "If the scourge slay suddenly, he will laugh at the trial of the innocent." Prot. H.

Ver. 24. Wicked one, (H.) the devil, (M.) or any impious person who enjoys prosperity. He, (C.) or even God permissively, covered the face, (H.) by bribes; so that judges pass sentence unjustly.

--- Then. If it be not the devil, (M.) or God. C.

Ver. 25. Good, of late. Heb. "they see no good."

Ver. 26. Carrying. Heb. lit. "of desire," belonging to one person, or full of goods, which he desires to carry quickly to market. M. --- Chal. agrees with us.

But most interpreters var. Pagnin retains the original, ebe; (H.) supposing the rive Abeh, or Avah, is meant. It certainly implies expedition; "they have hastened like (C.) the eagle to its prey." Sept. "Is there any trace of ships, or of an eagle flying in quest of food?" H.

Ver. 27. Sorrow. I cannot entirely repress it. C. --- The more I strive, (H.) the greater is my pain.

M.

Ver. 28. Works. Heb. "sorrows." I dread their increase, and fear impatience.

Even in the midst of prosperity, Job offered sacrifice, lest the sins of his children should be laid to his charge.

Ver. 29. Vain. Why have I endeavoured to repress my grief in silence? God does not forbid us to complain, but only to murmur. C. --- Sept. "Since I am wicked, why did I not die?" H. --- Should a wretch be even suffered to live" S.

Chrys.

Ver. 30. Snow. Nitre bring off the dirt better. Chal. "soap." Heb. bor, is supposed by many to be the Borith of Jer. ii. 22. Snow-water was also used through delicacy in summer. Petron. Sat.

Ver. 31. Abhor me. This striking expression intimates something extremely filthy. God will make his servants discern many stains, even when they have aimed at the greatest purity. C.

Ver. 33. There. Sept. "O that an umpire, (or mediator) were between us, and one arguing and giving ear in the midst of both!"

Ver. 35. Fear him. Sept. "and I shall not fear, but speak. For I am not conscious to myself of injustice." H. --- The dread of incurring God's displeasure makes me prefer to be silent; and if I had no other reason, this fear would suffice, as I should not be master of myself under such anxiety and pain. C. --- If my sufferings were at an end, I should take courage, and speak in my own defence, (M.) in answer to my false friends. H.

JOB 10

CHAPTER X.

Ver. 1. Life. Job had intimated a fear to proceed any farther. C. --- But perceiving that he had not convinced his friends, he continues his discourse (H.) in still stronger terms, yet so as to acknowledge the justice of God. C. ---

Speech against. Heb. "complaint upon, (H.) or respecting myself," I will deplore my misfortunes, (C.) or I will say no more about them. M.

Ver. 2. Judgest. Heb. "contendest with me," as with an enemy? Is it to punish some fault, or only to make thy grace shine forth? C.

Ver. 3. Calumniate permissively, by treating me in such a manner, that others lay false crimes to my charge. Heb. "oppress and despise the work." ---

Wicked, who are ready enough (H.) to assert that virtue is useless, (C.) and that God mindeth not human affairs. My affliction will confirm them in their false notion, (H.) and my friends will triumph as if their arguments were well founded. The devil will also exult. C. --- He knew that God could not be guilty of calumny, and inquireth why he is afflicted. W.

Ver. 4. Seeth, judging only of the exterior. T. v. 6.

Ver. 5. Days, sometimes denote judgments. 1 Cor. iv. 3. Is God liable to change, like men, or does he stand in need of time to examine them, or fear lest they should escape? C. --- Is it necessary for him to prove his friends, to know their real dispositions? Sanctius.

Ver. 7. Shouldst. Heb. and Sept. "Thou knowest that...and there," &c. H. --- It would be vain for me to appeal to any other. C.

Ver. 8. Sudden, like a potter's vessel? Job was reduced to misery all at once. C.

--- He acknowledges that God may destroy him as his creature; but that character encourages him to hope for mercy, grace, and glory. W.

Ver. 10. Milked. Heb. "poured me out as milk, and curdled me like cheese?" H.

--- See Wisd.

vii. 1. The ancients explained our origin by the comparison of milk curdled, or cheese; (Arist. i.

10. Pliny vii. 15.) which the moderns have explained on more plausible principles. C. --- Yet still we may acknowledge our ignorance with the mother of Machabees. 2 Mac. vii. 22.

Ver. 12. Thy fatherly visitation (H.) but still preserved my life. C.

Ver. 13. Rememberest. Sept. "canst do all things." Heb. "this is with thee." H.

--- I am convinced that thou still regardest me with affection, though it would appear as if thou hadst forgotten me. C.

Ver. 14. Iniquity? Punishing me for the sins which seemed to be pardoned. C.

--- Heb. "If I sin, then thou makest me, and wilt not suffer; (H.) or if thou hast not pardoned my iniquity: (15) And," &c. C.

Ver. 15. Woe. Thou wilt not suffer me to pass unpunished. C. --- Head. I will adore in silence.

C. ix. 15. 31. Ven. Bede. C.

Ver. 16. Pride. If I give way to pride, thou wilt pull me down, though I were as fierce and strong as a lioness. Heb. "for it (affliction) increaseth. Thou huntest me." Prot. --- Returning. Heb. and Sept. "again." H.

Ver. 17. Witnesses, afflictions; (M.) "wounds." Pagnin. T.

**Ver. 20. Lament. Heb. "take comfort," (H.) or breath. C. ---
Repentance is always necessary, but more particularly at the hour of
death. W.**

Ver. 21. Death, to the grave, or to hell, (C.) if my sins deserve it. H.

**Ver. 22. Horror. At death all distinction of ranks is at an end. T. --- Heb.
"where the light is as darkness." Prot. Sept. "To the land of eternal
darkness, where there is no sound, nor life of mortals to see." H.**

JOB 11

CHAPTER XI.

Ver. 1. Naamathite. Sept. "the Minean," in Arabia Felix, or rather of the Meonim, not far from the Themanites. Judg. x. 11. Sophar was probably a descendant of Sepho, styled by Sept.

Sophar, (Gen. xxxvi. 11. and 1 Par. i. 36.) brother of Thaman, and grandson of Eliphaz, the son of Esau. C. --- He speaks with greater insolence than the two others, (Pineda) and inveighs against Job, insisting that he can be punished thus only for his crimes. C.

Ver. 2. Much. The speeches of Job seemed tedious to him, because he was not of his opinion.

M. --- He might have applied to himself and his friends the fault of talking too much, as they all spoke many things to no purpose, whereas Job went straight to the point. W.

Ver. 3. Men. Heb. "shall thy lies make men keep silence?" Sept. "Blessed be the short-lived son of a woman. Speak not much, for there is no one to give sentence against thee." H. --- Mocked, by not acquiescing to their solid arguments, (M.) and speaking with much animation. Pineda.

Ver. 4. Sight. Job had just said the reverse. C. ix. 2. S. Chryst.

Ver. 6. Law. Heb. Thushiya, (H.) "the essence" of any thing. Hence it is explained, "law, strength, comfort," &c. We might translate, "and that the reality of thy crimes deserved double punishment," &c. The obligations of the natural, and also of the written law of Moses, with which Job was (C.) perhaps (H.) acquainted, (C. xxii. 22.) are very numerous and difficult. The ways of Providence are not easily understood, though some are obvious enough. He rewards and punishes. C. --- Sept. "for it is double of what has come against thee, and then thou wouldst know that thy sins are justly requited." Prot.

"that they are double to that which is: Know, therefore, that God exacteth of thee less than thine iniquity deserveth. " 1 Esd. ix. 13. H.

Ver. 7. Perfectly? If not, it is rash to find fault. M.

Ver. 11. It? to inflict punishment. Sept. "he will not overlook." H.

Ver. 12. Is. Heb. "is he heart? or wise, (C.) he who is born like a," &c. Shall he assert his independence, or pretend to be wise? H. --- The Hebrews place wisdom in the heart, as we do courage. C. xii. 3. Prov. ii. 2. &c. C.

Ver. 13. But. Heb. "If thou direct thy heart, &c. Thou mayst lift up thy face," (v.

15. H.) without fear. 2 K. ii. 22. C.

Ver. 14. Iniquity. Of this Job was not conscious, and therefore could not confess it. W.

Ver. 15. Without. Sept. "as clean water, thou shalt pass away corruption, and shalt not fear."

Ver. 17. Brightness. Sept. "But thy prayer, like the day-star and life, shall arise to thee from the south, or as at noon-day." Heb. "Thy age (H.) shall appear clearer than the noon-day, and darkness like the morning." Prosperity shall succeed, (C.) when thou shalt think all lost. M.

Ver. 18. Secure, dying full of hope. Chal. Heb. "thou shalt dig," (for water, which was there a great treasure. Gen. xxi. 25. and xxvi. 15.) or to fasten down thy tent, (C.) "and rest secure." H.

Ver. 19. Face. Luther translates "shall flatter thee." The Dutch version, which is taken from Luther's, has mistaken a letter, and rendered "shall flee before thee," which shews the danger of translating without recurring to the originals.

Amama.

**Ver. 20. Soul, because hope deferred causeth pain to the soul. Prov. xiii.
12. M.**

**--- Heb. "their hope shall be the sorrow, or the breathing out of the
soul." C. ---**

**Prot. "the giving up of the ghost." Margin, "a puff of breath." C. xviii.
14. H.**

JOB 12

CHAPTER XII.

Ver. 2. You. Heb. "truly you are the people, and wisdom will die with you!" This irony is very sharp. C. --- "Are you alone men? or shall?" &c. Sept. Syr.

Ver. 4. Mocked. He retaliates on Sophar, (C. xi. 3. H.) who had very seriously exhorted Job to call on God, as if he had been ignorant of this duty. C. --- God will one day force the wicked to retract their false notion, in despising his servants. Wisd. v. 3. W.

Ver. 5. The lamp. Such is the just man, who under affliction is (H.) exposed to the ridicule of men who live at their ease. --- For. Heb. "to fall." C. --- Sept. "It was appointed for me to fall under others at the time fixed."

Ver. 6. Abound. Heb. "are at peace." C. --- The prosperity of the wicked is therefore no proof that they are pleasing to him. H. --- All nature testifies that God exercises a sovereign dominion over his works. He may therefore cause the just to suffer, though they be guiltless. This is one of Job's grand maxims.

C.

Ver. 11. Taste. For this no master is requisite; so I stood in no need of your information, (C.) of such trite remarks. H.

Ver. 12. Ancient. He rather chides the youth of Sophar for offering to give him lessons. Old age is indeed commonly wiser and more experienced. Yet, what is man's knowledge compared to that of God! v. 3.

Ver. 17. To a. Heb. "to be despoiled" of their wisdom and riches. C. --- Sept.

"into captivity."

H. --- Crafty plotters at last fall into such misconduct, as to be derided by men of the meanest capacity. W.

Ver. 18. Looseth. Sept. "setteth kings upon the throne," &c. --- Belt. This was usually very magnificent, and a military ornament. See that of Pallas described. Æn. x. Job intimates that God derives kings of their authority, at pleasure. Heb. may also signify that he looseth the bond or prisoner of kings, and reduces themselves to slavery. C. --- Things never remain long in the same state. H. --- Even kings are sometimes obliged to beg. M.

Ver. 19. Without. Heb. "despoiled." Sept. "captives." Cohanim, may comprise both sacred ministers and civil princes. 1 K. viii. 18. All are equally subject to God. C.

Ver. 20. Speakers. Permitting them to speak deceitfully, (C.) or causing their oracles to be contemned. H. --- Heb. "he withdraws speech from men of confidence." C. --- Neemanim, (H.) ambassadors or prime ministers. Num. xii.

7. He disconcerteth the best concerted plans.

Ver. 21. Relieveth. Heb. "ungirdeth (disarms) the strong." C. --- Sept. "but the lowly (humble) he has healed."

Ver. 22. Of death. Talmaveth (H.) may perhaps simply denote darkness. C. ---

God bringeth to light the most hidden things. H.

Ver. 23. Multiplieth. Heb. Sept. and Syr. "deceiveth," (C.) suffering them to confide too much in their strength, so that they fall an easy prey. H. --- How many nations, once so powerful, are now fallen; while others of no account have risen to eminence!

Ver. 24. Changeth. Heb. "taketh away the heart," or prudence "of princes."

Hence they follow the most absurd counsels. Isai. xxix. 19. C. --- No way. This was the case of Pharaoh, when he pursued the Israelites into the sea; (T.) and the like may rationally be feared by those princes, who attempt to make innovations in the true religion, or in the sound laws of a kingdom. M.

JOB 13

CHAPTER XIII.

Ver. 1. All, without your information. C.

Ver. 3. Reason. Heb. "to dispute with, or before God," concerning the matter which we have in hand. He appeals to God, as to the judge of all.

Ver. 4. Having. Heb. "But ye are sewers of lies." C. --- Sept. "unskilful surgeons, (who, instead of sewing up a wound, increase it) and all of you doctors of evil;" vain empirics. --- Maintainers.

Prot. "ye are all physicians of no value." H.

Ver. 5. Men. Prov. xvii. 28. If you had been silent, you might still have had the reputation of wisdom. C.

Ver. 6. Judgment. Heb. "pleading" before our common judge. H.

Ver. 8. Accept. Heb. "will you not be seized with fear?" Olympiodorus translates, "will you stand in his presence, and dispute with him?" C. --- Sept.

"Are you sent to be judges?" &c. or, do you suppose that you hope to gain his favour? C. --- He knows the state of my soul best; then I myself: but you are quite in the dark. W.

Ver. 9. Or. Heb. "Is it good that he should examine you, would you escape?" C.

Ver. 10. His. Heb. "persons." Because you see me afflicted, you infer that I am guilty; and think this mode of judging most honourable to God, whom you wish thus to please. H. --- But he stands not in need of lies; (C.) and something farther is still to be proved. H. --- You judge rashly, as if you designed to please a prince, (M.) without examining the cause of the accused. H.

**Ver. 12. Necks. Sept. "body." Heb. also, (H.) "heights," (C.) or
"fortifications."**

Grotius.

Ver. 13. Whatsoever. Heb. "come what will. " Sept. "that my anger may cease."

H.

Ver. 14. Why you seem to ask do I thus eagerly desire to die, (H.) as if I wear tearing my own flesh, and exposing my soul to danger, (W.) like a madman? T.

--- Is it not better for me to address myself to God, that he would hasten my departure, than thus to tear my flesh with my teeth? C. --- Some have supposed that Job really did so in extreme anguish, (V. Bede) the leprosy occasioning such an insupportable irritation. H. --- But the expression insinuates an interior anguish or despair; (Isai. xlix. 26.) in which sense Pythagoras enjoins, "no to eat the heart." ---

Hands, in imminent danger of death. Ps. cxviii. 109. --- S. Gregory explains it in a moral sense:

"It is to manifest the intention of the heart by the actions." H.

Ver. 15. In him. Heb. lu is read, though lo, "not," is written in the Heb. text. H. ---

Protestants,

&c. follow the sense of the Vulgate, and Junius comes to the same, as he reads lo with an interrogation: "Should I not hope in him?" Luther and the Belgic version go astray: "Behold he shall kill me, and I cannot expect," or hope; I am resolved to die: which words indicate "extreme impatience."

Amama. --- Sept. "If the powerful (or Lord) lay [not] hands on me, since it is commenced? No: but I shall speak and arraign [you] before him," &c. The words not and you are thus placed in Grabe's edition. H. --- Ways. I do not pretend that I am quite blameless. C. ---

Prot. "I will maintain (Marg. prove or argue) mine own ways before him." H. --- I will hope, like Abraham, even against hope, to shew that I

am not actuated by despair: yet I will continue to declare my innocence, v. 16. T.

Ver. 16. Hypocrite. If I were such, I should not dare to appeal so boldly to his tribunal. C.

Ver. 17. Truths. Lit. "riddles" to you. Heb. achavathi, (H.) means "instructions,"

&c. C.

Ver. 18. Just. He was in extreme anguish, yet still trusted in God. W.

Ver. 19. Peace. It will be some consolation to explain my reasons. If I am fairly overcome, I shall die with more content. C.

Ver. 20. Only. He makes the same petition to God as C. ix. 34. and xxxiii. 7. H.

Ver. 23. Offences, which might be hidden to Job himself. W. --- He speaks to God with the freedom which he had requested, desiring to know if he were really guilty, (C.) that he might give glory to him, (H.) by an humble confession.

Ver. 26. Bitter. The judge wrote down the sentence; which he read, or gave to his officer. C. ---

Youth, for which I thought I had satisfied. H.

Ver. 27. Stocks, in which the person's legs were sometimes stretched to the sixth hole; (C.) at other times, the neck was confined. M. --- Some translate the Heb. "in the mud," which agrees with the other part of the verse. --- Steps. Heb.

and Sept. "roots," or ankles, which retain the prints made by the stocks.

Ver. 28. Rottenness. Sept. "an old vessel," or skin, to contain wine, &c. C. ---

My condition might excite pity. M.

JOB 14

CHAPTER XIV.

**Ver. 1. Man. He exposes to God the common miseries of mankind. C. ---
They cannot avoid many miseries in their short life, yet may be brought
to heaven.**

W.

Ver. 2. Shadow. Pulvis et umbra sumus. Hor. iv. Ode 7. "Come then, ye men, whom nature condemns to spend your days in darkness, ye who resemble the leaves, are of little strength, formed of mud, shadow-like,...of a day's duration, miserable mortals, men like dreams, attend to the immortals." Aristoph. Avib.

--- Most of these expressions occur in Job, Ps. ci. 12. Wisd. ii. 5.

Eccle. ii. 23. &c.

Ver. 3. With thee. He seems beneath God's attention: (Arist. Met. viii. 9. Cicero, Nat. ii.) but as the knowledge and other attributes of the Deity are infinite, he must necessarily attend to the whole creation. The moral actions of men being also infinite in their object, tending to God, or contradicting his ordinances, they are not beneath the consideration of an infinite Being. C.

Ver. 4. Seed, is not expressed in Heb. "unclean." It may refer to Adam. There is no contagion in the seed to infect the soul, as Tertullian supposed; it is only unclean in the cause, as every person who is born according to the common course of nature, becomes a child of Adam, and partakes in his original sin.

The Scholastics. T. --- Only art. Essence itself. Carthus. --- "The justification of the sinner is a greater miracle than the creation of the world." S. Aug. ibid. ---

The birth of Jesus Christ was free from stain; (Luk. i. 35.) as was also the conception of his virgin Mother, by the power of God; (M.) and his grace, as it is piously believed. H. --- He alone can purify man.

C. --- Heb. "who can produce what is clean out of the unclean? Not one." Or Chal. "Is there not one?" Sept. "For who shall be pure from corruption? Not so much as one: (5) though his life be only of one day

upon earth." The more ancient Fathers have generally quoted the text in this manner, to prove original sin; (H. S. Cyp. Tert. S. Deo. Mag. in Nat. i. &c. T.) and Bellarmine almost does the same, (Grat. iv. 4.) observing that the Sept. have taken in three words from the following verse: "though his days are few." Yet there are some words which are not in Heb.

though the doctrine here maintained is indubitable. Amama. --- Job was fully convinced of it, and adduced it as plea for mercy. It also tends to keep us in the most profound humility and watchfulness, to resist the motions of concupiscence. C. --- Man,

"Now too late,

Saw the rash error, which he could not mend;

An error fatal not to him alone,

But to his future sons, his fortune's heirs." Blair's Grave. Milton, x. 151. H.

Ver. 6. Hireling, who rejoices at being permitted to rest a little. So, before death, suffer me to have some relaxation. C. vii. 1.

Ver. 8. Dust. After being even exposed to the air, for a long time, some branches will take root, like the rose of Jericho, the willow, &c.

Ver. 9. Scent, or light touch. Dan. iii. 94. M.

Ver. 10. Is he? Will he naturally come to life again?

Ver. 11. Sea. There would be no supply of rain for the fountains. Eccle. i. 7. All would continue dry: so when the blood is once gone, life is at an end. See 2 K.

xiv. 14. C. --- The water cannot go back. M.

Ver. 12. Till. At that time, the general resurrection will take place. Vat. Scultet.

--- But people will never revive, according to the course of nature. In S. Matt. v.

18. Ps. lxxi. 7. till is used in this sense. C.

Ver. 13. That thou mayst protect me in hell. That is, in the state of the dead; and in the place where souls are kept waiting for their Redeemer; (Ch.) and in the grave, where the body awaits the resurrection. H. --- These words are repeated in the office of the dead, in the name of the souls in purgatory. Carthus. a. 34.

--- They are adduced in proof of limbo. But sheol denotes also

"the grave." Amama. --- What then? The soul is not confined there. It must consequently be explained of the lower receptacle for souls, as well as of the grave. H.

Ver. 14. Dead. Shall one in a condition nearly as bad, like myself, be restored to health? Yes, I entertain this hope. C. --- Thinkest thou, is not in Heb. or Sept.

The latter speaks (H.) clearly of the resurrection. C. --- "For if a man die, shall he revive, having completed the days of his life? I wait (for thee) till I be again."

Grabe. H. --- Warfare. C. vii. 1.

Ver. 16. But. Heb. "Mark out, (C.) or dost thou not observe my sin?" This fills me with terror, (H.) unless thou shew mercy.

Ver. 17. Cured. Heb. "sewed up." This method and sealing was in use to keep things of value, before locks were invented. C. --- Sept. "thou hast noted if I had transgressed unwillingly, akon."

Yet God will not make us accountable for what we cannot help.

Ver. 19. Man. Heb. and Sept. "the hope of man." H. --- He must not expect to be more privileged than all other things, which time consumes. C. --- Job again deplores human misery.

M.

Ver. 20. Strengthened. Sept. "driven away." Pagnin, &c. --- "Thou wilt treat him harshly." C.

Ver. 21. Or dishonour. He cannot naturally be informed. M. --- God may, however, reveal to souls departed, what may increase their accidental happiness or misery. H. --- Hence the Church prays to the saints. Job is speaking chiefly of the body in the grave, and of what appear exteriorly. During life man cannot foresee the state of his children; not in the other world, would their condition render him happy or otherwise. C. Mercer. --- Sept. "If his sons be many,...or...few, he knows not." H. --- He is not affected in the same manner as he would be, if living. W.

Ver. 22. Over. Heb. "within him." H. --- During life man is full of cares, and presently he is consigned to the dreary tomb, v. 19. C.

JOB 15

CHAPTER XV.

Ver. 2. Heat. Heb. "east wind," (H.) or give vent to passion. H. --- Eliphaz now rebukes Job without any reserve. C. --- He was perhaps displeased at the comparison used by the latter. C.

xiii. 4. Baldad had also hinted that Job's discourse was nothing but wind. C.

viii. 2. H. --- Being unable to answer his arguments, he reviles him as an enemy of God. W.

Ver. 3. Equal. God, who is far above thee. Heb. "Will he (the wise) argue with less words, or with speeches which are nothing to the purpose?" C.

Ver. 4. God. Another, after thy example, will assert his own innocence under affliction, and will not fear, nor have recourse to God by humble prayer. Behold the dangerous consequences of thy principle. C.

Ver. 5. Blasphemers. Heb. "of the crafty," which is sometimes taken in a good sense. Sept.

"thou hast not distinguished the speeches of the princes." Thou hast not shewn respect to our admonitions, (C.) or understood our meaning. H. --- Thou rather choosest to imitate those false sages, who strive to deceive the world.

Abuse could hardly be carried to greater lengths than it is by this man; who before spoke with some moderation. C. iv. C.

Ver. 7. First. Is thy experience so great, (M.) or art thou the most excellent of men? To hear thee we are but novices. C. xiii. 5. C.

Ver. 8. His. Heb. "dost thou restrain wisdom to thyself? Sept. "or has wisdom come to thee?"

H.

Ver. 10. Fathers. Heb. and Sept. "father." H. --- Eliphaz always speaks first, and hints that he was as old, perhaps older, than Job; who had rather found fault with the youth of Sophar. C. xii.

12. He also boasts that they, or their country, furnished master of great wisdom and experience than even Job's father. C.

Ver. 11. Thee. This would not be difficult, (T.) if thy presumption did not prove an obstacle.

Thou makest small account of those comforts or of our advice, trusting in thy own justice. C. ---

Sept. "Thou hast been chastised little, considering thy sins. Thou hast spoken with excessive insolence."

Ver. 12. Why. Sept. "What has thy heart dared, or what have thine eyes brought thee?" Heb.

"what do thy eyes wink at?" (H.) through pride and disdain. Ps. xxxiv. 19. Prov.

vi. 13. C. ---

We need not wonder that Eliphaz should misunderstand the looks of Job, (H.) since he gives such a false notion of his speeches. C.

Ver. 14. Just. Few are free from all spot; but venial sins do not hinder a man from being styled truly virtuous. W.

Ver. 15. Unchangeable, of his own nature, and during this life. C. --- Heb. and Sept. "is not trusted by him," till they have been tried, (H. C. iv. 17. None is good but God alone. Mar. x. 18.) in comparison. T.

Ver. 16. Water, with the utmost avidity and unconcern. Prov. x. 23. and xxvi. 6.

Ver. 17. Seen. He had before given himself out for a prophet. Perhaps he may only mean to deliver what he had been taught, or had learned by experience, v.

18. His observations are in themselves just; but the application to Job is no less insulting. C.

Ver. 18. Wise. Prot. "which wise men have told from their fathers, and have not hid it. " C. viii.

8. The authority of tradition was then very great; and why should it now be despised? H.

Ver. 19. Them. Their antiquity, courage, and purity of morals must consequently be greater, as they have preserved themselves from the inroads of strangers. C.

Ver. 20. Proud; uncertain. Heb. "in pain." H. --- Sept. "numbered," or few. Gen.

xxxiv. 30.

These are the maxims which Eliphaz had received in a vision, or from the ancients, v. 17. The description of a tyrant's life was admirably verified in Dionysius, of Syracuse, (C.) and in our Cromwell, (H.)---

"-----pale and trembling in the dead of night." Pope.

---who rarely lodged two night in one chamber. Clarendon. --- Such live in dread, (H.) and seldom die a natural death.

Ad generum Cereris sine cæde et vulnere pauci

Descendunt reges et siccâ morte Tyranni. Juv. x. 113.

Nocte dieque suum gestare in pectore testem. Juv. xiii.

They bear always about the witness, "conscience." H. --- They distrust every one, and are hated by all.

Districtus ensis cui super impia

Cervice pendet, &c. Hor. iii. Ode 1.

--- These miseries are incident to the wicked, but are improperly addressed to Job. W.

Ver. 26. And is. Heb. "even upon the thick bosses of his buckler." H. --- God thus seizes his antagonist, who, like Pharaos, swells with pride. C. Deut. xxxii.

15.

Ver. 28. Heaps, by his ambition and fury, (C.) and exactions, (Cajet. M.) till the king chooses to rebuild the cities. Vatab.

Ver. 31. That he. Heb. and Sept. "for vanity shall be his reward." H. --- If he would repent, he might still be safe. M.

Ver. 32. Hands; strength and prosperity. C. --- Sept. "his branch shall not grow thick." H.

Ver. 33. First. Heb. "unripe." H. --- He shall derive no aid or comfort from his young family.

Ver. 34. Congregation, or family. --- Bribes. Lit. "presents," which H. frequently were not given freely, but extorted as a real tribute. C. --- Sept. "for the death of the wicked is a martyrdom," or proof of his impiety. "But fire shall consume the houses of the present (or bribe) receivers."

Ver. 35. Sorrow. Heb. "mischief." H. See Ps. vii. 15. Isai. xlix. 4. --- The tree is known by its fruit. Eliphaz sufficiently insinuates, that he is speaking of Job. C.

--- His, or "its," the congregation's womb, v. 34. Prot. "their belly." H.

JOB 16

CHAPTER XVI.

Ver. 2. Comforters. "Job's friends or comforters," are become proverbial, to denote people who do the contrary to what they seem to promise. H. --- Never did men sustain worse the character of comforters. They all magnify their knowledge and piety, and make the most absurd application of their principles to Job's condition. C. --- He was not ignorant that tyrants and wicked men were often, may generally till the age in which he lived, visited with visible judgments. H.

Ver. 3. Windy, inconclusive arguments. They all entertain a mean opinion of their adversaries, as they did not agree in the application of the propositions.

Hence though they might be true, they were nothing to their present purpose.

C. xv. 3. H. --- Trouble. You can speak without any pain: but the case is far different with me. M. --- Heb. "what emboldeneth thee to answer?" H. ---

Who asks thee for advice? C. --- True friends will give it without upbraiding, or laying false crimes to the charge of any one. W.

Ver. 4. My soul. If you had experienced my state of misery, (H.) I surely would not have behaved thus to you. C.

Facile, cum valemus, recta consilia ægrotis damus:

Tu si hic sis, aliter sentias. Terent. Andria.

Ver. 5. Wag, or shake my head out of pity. C. xlii. 11. Nah. iii. 7. The same sign often indicates astonishment or contempt. Ps. xxi. 8. Matt. xxvii. 28. C.

Ver. 7. But. Heb. "If I speak," &c.

Ver. 8. Limbs. Heb. "company," (H.) or family. The assemblage of my limbs is also disordered by the leprosy.

Ver. 9. Against me, in your opinion, as if I were guilty of lies. Heb. "my leanness bears witness, my falsehood has risen up against me and answered me to my face;" which may be understood in the same sense as the argument of Eliphaz.

He is designated by the false speaker; (C.) unless we explain it of the wrinkles, which falsely indicated that Job was advanced in years, or of the malady; whence it was gathered that he must be a criminal. M. --- Prot. "my leanness riseth up."

H.

Ver. 11. Cheek. His friends seemed so enraged, as to be disposed to do so. C.

--- These expressions were strikingly verified in Christ. M. --- The outrages may also be attributed to the devil; (C.) or, by personification, to the malady of Job.

M.

Ver. 14. Lances. Heb. "archers." Sept. "they have encompassed me, throwing lances into my veins, or loins, not sparing," &c. H. --- Bowels. Heb. and Sept.

"gall," being afflicted with a dysentery. S. Thomas explains it of his children, who were slain. H.

Ver. 16. Flesh. Heb. "horn." Sept. "strength." H. --- I have lost all my beauty and splendor, and have put on the garments of penance. C.

Ver. 17. Dim. Heb. and Sept. "covered with the shadow of death," (H.) greatly impaired. Some have almost lost their sight by weeping; and death seemed ready to close Job's eyes. C.

Ver. 18. Hand, which has not been defiled with any injustice. M. --- When. Heb.

"and my prayer was pure." I never neglected this sacred duty, (C. i. 5.) as my friends accuse me. C. xv. 4. H. ---

They continued in their false accusation: so he repeats the same true answer.

W.

Ver. 19. In thee. Let the cry of my blood, which issues from my wounds, and the injury which my reputation has suffered, come before the throne of God.

Calumny is a species of murder. See Gen. iv. 10. C. --- If I be really guilty, I am willing to remain unburied. Let the dogs lick up my blood. Cajet. --- Cry. Let the hills re-echo my sufferings. Pineda.

Et quodcumque meæ possunt narrare querelæ,

Cogar ad argutas dicere solus aves. Propertius.

Ver. 21. Full. Heb. "scorners." Therefore I appeal to inanimate things; and, above all, to God, who cannot give a wrong judgment.

Ver. 22. Judged. Heb. "might plead." H. --- Earthly judges may be compelled to pronounce sentence publicly. Job is afraid lest the justice of his cause should remain undecided, till death overtook him, v. 23. Pineda.

Ver. 23. Years. Heb. and Sept. "of number." Pauperis est numerare pecus. H. ---

Like a man under affliction, Job repeats what he had said. C. xiv. 5. M. and C. x.

20. H.

JOB 17

CHAPTER XVII.

Ver. 1. Spirit. Heb. "breath is corrupt," (H.) or spent. I cannot breathe without the greatest difficulty. C. --- Only. Sept. "But I want the grave, and do not obtain it." H.

Ver. 2. Not sinned. That is, I am not guilty of such sins as they charge me with.

Ch. --- Heb. "the wicked were not with me" in friendship at any time. Prot. " Are there not mockers with me?" H.

--- Job was doubly afflicted, with corporal pain and calumny: yet hopeth in God. W.

Ver. 3. Fight. I am secure under thy protection. Heb. "who will strike hands with me?" or stand bondsman for my debt? Prov. vi. 1. Who will take my place? You accuse me of weakness and of impiety: but how would you act, if you were treated in the same manner? C.

Ver. 4. Understanding. They will not answer for me. They are not of such a generous disposition; nor can they distinguish between the punishment of guilt and the trial of virtue. C.

Ver. 5. He. My friend. C. --- Heb. "speaketh flattery," (H.) or promiseth to caress me, while he neglects his own children. But the sense of the Vulg. and Chal.

seem preferable. My friends speak as if they could do any thing, and as if no trial would stagger their resolution. But they durst not be in my situation for a short time. C. --- Like hunters, who have promised their children some prey, my friends will not, however, gain the victory over me. M.

Ver. 6. Example. Prot. "a tabret." H. --- The people sing over my misfortune.

Lam. iii. 14. I am represented as a victim of God's just indignation. C. - -- Sept.

"a laughter," or laughing-stock. H.

Ver. 7. Indignation of God, or of myself. M. --- Nothing. Heb. "as a shadow." C.

Ver. 8. Hypocrite. If you condemn me, I shall comfort myself with the approbation of the righteous, and still maintain my station. H. --- Men of sense and virtue will tremble at the judgments of God, and will never join the crowd of scoffers. C.

Ver. 10. Man. He offers to dispute with them again, and convince them of folly; (M.) or rather he here concludes his address to them, and invites them to change their preposterous judgments.

Ver. 11. Thoughts, or fine projects of living happy a long time. C.

Ver. 12. Day. Sleep flees from me. M. --- All is in confusion. --- After. Heb. and Sept. "light is near in the face of darkness." H. --- I still hope for relief.

Ver. 13. Hell. Seol. The region of the dead. Ch. --- Prot. "grave." H. --- But this text proves that there was a place of rest called hell. W. --- He speaks here chiefly of the body. C. --- Mors ultima linea rerum est. Hor. --- "Death is the end of all." H. --- If I refrain from complaining, still I cannot expect to be restored to health.

Ver. 14. Sister. I am nearly related to such things, and ready to drop into the grave, as my flesh is already devoured by worms. M.

Ver. 15. Who. Heb. "who shall see my hope?" I wish all might witness it. H. ---

But I expect no redress on this side of the grave. C.

Ver. 16. Deepest pit. Literally hell. Ch. --- Heb. "We shall go down to the bars of the pit, when we shall rest together in the dust." My hope

may be frustrated by death; (H.) or you, my friends, must also go to the house of eternity. C.

JOB 18

CHAPTER XVIII.

Ver. 2. Understand ye. Teach this man to comprehend what we say. He deigns not to address Job in person: but repeats most of his former remarks respecting the wicked, as if they were unquestionably applicable to Job. C. viii.

C. --- Heb. "mark ye." Sept. "do thou attend." H. ---

Baldad speaks to many who might be of Job's opinion, as he was a figure of the Church, defending the common cause; while his friends, like heretics, speak both true and false things. S.

Greg. xiv. 1. W.

Ver. 3. Reputed. Sept. "silent as four-footed animals before thee? (H.) without discipline or understanding." C. xvii. 4. M.

Ver. 4. Thou. Heb. "He teareth his soul in his fury!" H. --- This is spoken with an air of contempt, as if Job were mad. C. xiii. 14. C. --- Place. We should expect to see such effects, as soon as we would allow that God punishes thee, without thy being guilty. Hitherto he has treated the wicked only with such rigour. Still thou wouldst assert that thou art a singular example of an innocent man under oppression! C.

Ver. 6. Light; prosperity, (M.) offspring, &c. C.

Ver. 7. Step. He shall be greatly embarrassed, (M.) like a man in a narrow pass, (C.) beset with thorns. H. Prov. iv. 12. --- Sept. "the weakest have made a prey of his possessions. H.

Ver. 8. Meshes, (maculis) or holes of the net. M. --- The more he strives to get out, the more he gets entangled. C.

Ver. 9. Thirst: the greedy hunter. C. --- Heb. "the robber." H.

Ver. 11. Fears. Hunters used to place loose feathers round the wood, except where the gin was laid, in order to frighten the prey into it.

Puniceæque agitant formidine pennæ. Georg. iii.

Jer. xlviii. 44. "Like timid stags, while you avoid the moving feathers, you are entrapped in the strongest nets." S. Jerom, c. Lucif. --- Every thing tends to fill the poor beast with alarm. So the devil, conscience, and enemies on all sides, best the wicked. C.

Ver. 13. First-born denotes the best, or the worst. H. --- Death. Heb. "of death,"

the devil, or a premature death, and most cruel enemy. C. --- Sept. "But death devours his most beautiful things." H.

Ver. 14. Confidence. Sept. "health." --- Let. Prot. "and it shall bring him to the king of terrors;"

(H.) or, "thou (O God) shalt," &c. Sept. "let him be in the greatest (C.) want, on account of a royal accusation," (H.) of high treason. C.

Ver. 15. Tent, when he is gone to purify it.

Et veniat quæ lustret anus lectumque locumque,

Præferat et tremulâ sulphur et ova manu. Ovid. Art.

--- Yet Moses does not mention sulphur as a thing proper for purifications.

Some think that Baldad hints that his house will be destroyed with lightning, or rendered uninhabitable by a loathsome smell.

Ver. 16. Harvest. Heb. also, "branch;" (C.) his family, (M.) and all on which he trusted. C. ---

All must be destroyed, root and branch.

Ver. 20. Them. Lit. "the first," who were witnesses of his misery. H.

JOB 19

CHAPTER XIX.

Ver. 3. Ten times; very often. --- Oppress me. Heb. word occurs no where else, and is variously translated. It may signify, "to dig a pit for me." C. vi. 27. Ps. vi.

6. Job repeats nearly what he had said before, only with greater vehemence.

He admits that Providence treats him in an unusual manner. Yet he still retains an assured hope, and arraigns his adversaries before the divine tribunal. C. ---

Yet he rather hesitates; (v. 4. 6.) and this species of ignorance is the folly of which he, at last, accuses himself. C. xlii. 3. It was no real fault, ib. v. 8. H.

Ver. 4. With me. I alone am answerable for it. But I am no wiser for your remarks. If I have sinned, have I not been sufficiently punished? C. --- Sept.

"Yea, truly, I was under a mistake; and the mistake still remains with me, to have spoken a word which was not becoming. But my speeches are erroneous and importunate." He talks thus ironically. H.

Ver. 5. Reproaches, which I endure, as if they were a sure proof of your assertion. H. -- I must therefore refute you. C.

Ver. 6. With an equal judgment. S. Gregory explains these words thus: Job being a just man, and truly considering his own life, thought that his affliction was greater than his sins deserved; and in that respect, that the punishment was not equal, yet it was just, as coming from God, who give a crown of justice to those who suffer for righteousness' sake, and proves the just with tribulations, as gold is tried by fire. Ch. --- He knew that God would surely give a just reward. 2 Tim. iv. S.

Greg. xiv. 16. W. --- The friends of Job had too contracted a notion of Providence, supposing that the virtuous could not be afflicted. Job allowed that the ordinary rules were not here observed.

Heb. "the Lord hath perverted or overthrown me." C. --- This gave him no small uneasiness. If the thing had been as plain as it appears now to us, he might have refuted all with a bare denial.

Houbigant.

Ver. 7. Hear. Jeremias makes the same complaint, Lam. iii. 8. C.

Ver. 12. Troops: (latrones) "free-booters," (H.) or "soldiers." Sanctius.

Those nations made a practice of plundering one another's territories, without any declaration of war. Mercury and Autolychus are praised for thefts of this description. Odys. xix. See Judg. xi. 3. Sept. "his temptations (C. or militia; peirateria) came rushing together upon me; lying down (H.) in ambush, (C.) they surrounded my paths." H.

Ver. 17. Entreated. Prot. add, "for the children's sake of mine own body." Sept.

"I invited with flattering speeches the sons of my concubines. (18) But they cast me from them for ever. When I arise, they speak against me." H. ---

Interpreters generally suppose that Job speaks of the children by his inferior wives: though he might have some at home by the first wife, who were not old enough to be invited to the feast, with those who were destroyed. C.

Ver. 18. Fools; wicked men, (M.) or the meanest of the people, (C.) whom (H.) these unnatural children (C.) resembled. Heb. "young children." Prot. H.

Ver. 19. Some. Heb. "men of my secret." Sept. "who knew me;" my most intimate friends. ---

And he. Heb. and Sept. "They whom I love are." H. --- These ungratefully joined with the rest, in turning their backs on their benefactor. W.

Ver. 20. Teeth. I am like a skeleton, so strangely emaciated, and my flesh corrupted: even my bones are not entire. H. --- Heb. "I have escaped with the skin of my teeth." Only my gums are left. My bones cut the skin. Sym. "I tore my skin with my teeth."

Ver. 22. Flesh? acting with the like inhumanity towards me. Am I not then sufficiently tormented in you opinion, that you insult over my distress? C.

Ver. 24. In a. Heb. "lead, in the rock for ever." Prot. Sept. have, "for ever," after book, (v. 23) and subjoins, "with a writing instrument of iron and (or) lead, or be engraven on the rocks for a memorial." Grabe insinuates that before there was only, "and on lead, or be engraven on the rocks." H. --- Instrument, (celte) means "a chisel," (H.) like cœlum from cœlo: " I engrave."

Pineda. --- S. Jerom, (ad Pam.) and the late editor of his works, retain this word, as the older editions of S. Greg. did; (C.) though certè, "surely," has been inserted instead, from several MSS.

by the Benedictines. H. --- Ancient MSS. and Latin Bibles have more generally the latter word.

But the received editions are supported by many MSS. (C.) and the Sept.

egglyphenai, expresses as much. Celtis est, glupheion. Amama. Casaub. in Athen. vii. 20. p. 556. --- An inscription, in Dalmatia, has the same sense: Neque hic atramentum vel papyrus aut membrana ulla adhuc; sed malleolo et celte literatus silex. "Here as yet was neither ink, nor paper, nor any parchments; but a flint stone was lettered with a mallet and a chisel.." The former modes of writing were not, in effect, invented by the days of Job. C. ---

But it was long very usual to make use of lead. Pineda.

--- What he desired to have written in such durable characters, (H.) was the following sentence, in proof of his unshaken confidence in God,

and as a refutation of his friends, who accused him of despair and blasphemy, (C.) as also the whole history of his conflict. His desire has been granted.

T.

Ver. 25. Redeemer may be understood of the Deity, without confining it to the second Person; (Isai. xli. 14. and lxix. 7. Piscator) though it may have a more peculiar reference to Christ: (Junius. H.) in whom he believed, as the Redeemer of all mankind. C. --- Earth. Yea, ere long I shall be restored to health, (S. Chrys. Grot.) as an earnest and figure of the resurrection. Nothing is more common, in Scripture, than for the same prophecy to have a double accomplishment; one soon after it is made public, and another more sublime and remote. Job seemed to have no expectation of surviving his present misery, (v. 7, and C. vii. 7. and xxiv. 15.) unless God now revealed it to him, as a figure of his future resurrection, founded on the hope of our Saviour's, which he expresses in much clearer terms. Heb. "I know that my Redeemer is living, and that he will raise himself one day upon the earth," (C.) like a conqueror, (H.) or wrestler, having overthrown his antagonist: (Amama) or, "he will stand the last upon the earth, or dust," (Piscator) ascending his throne, to judge all.

Deodat. --- Yet Luther translates, "and one day he will raise me up from the earth;" which is not conformable to the Heb. Others explain, "he...will place (26) this, my skin, after they (worms) shall have ruined it." Pagnin. Mont. --- But Amama suspects that the latter is not in earnest. Pineda defends the Vulg. and observes that yakum (H.) may signify, "will raise" himself, or "me;" the latter being at least a consequence of the former, if S.

Jerom did not read it me in his copy. So S. Paul argues; If Christ be risen, we also shall rise again. Sept. "For I know that he is eternal, who will set me free,"

(H.) by death, (C. or redemption; ekluein) "upon the earth."

Ver. 26. And I. Sept. "But he will raise up my body or skin, which has sustained these things.

This now has been accomplished for me by the Lord; (27) which I know within myself, which my eyes have seen, and not another. For all things are accomplished in my bosom." I am as fully convinced of this glorious event, (H.) as if it were past. C. --- Heb. "and though, after my skin, worms destroy this body, yet in my flesh shall I see God." Prot. or in the margin, "After I shall awake, though this body be destroyed, yet out of," &c. Various other interpretations are given.

H. --- But we had as well adhere to the Sept. Vulg. &c. D. --- God. Sixtus V. and some other editions, add "Saviour." C. --- Job would see the Messiah by the eyes of his prosperity. S. Aug.

or Faustus, ser. 234. t. v. App. Sanctius. --- He hoped also to see God face to face in glory (C.) though not by means of his corporeal eyes, (H.) and to be restored to favour, so that God would no longer turn his back on him. , C. xlii.

5. S. Gregory, when legate at Constantinople, convinced the patriarch Eutychius, by this text, that after the resurrection, our bodies will be palpable, and not aerial only. C. --- It contains an express profession of Job's faith, on this head. We shall rise the same in substance. W.

Ver. 27. Myself. Heb. "for myself," and for my comfort; not like the reprobate, who shall see their judge to their eternal confusion. Job insists so much on this point, that he shews he is not speaking merely of the divine favour being restored to him, in the re-establishment of his health and affairs, but that he raises his mind to something more solid and desirable, of which the former was only a faint representation. C. -- - "No one since Christ has spoken so plainly of the resurrection, as this man did before the coming of the Messiah."

S. Jerom, ad Pam. --- This. Heb.

" though my reins be consumed within me;" (Prot. H.) or, "my reins (desires and tender affections) are completed in my bosom." C.

Ver. 28. Let us. Sept. "Why do we contend against him? and the root of the word (reason) we shall find in him." He provokes us to speak thus.

H. ---

Hebrew reads, "in me." But the Chal.

&c. "have him, " as the sequel requires; unless Job speak this in his own person. I am ready to answer you; or, have you really discovered in me any grounds for your virulent attack? C.

Ver. 29. Know. Sept. "And then they shall know that their power is nowhere;"

or, "where is their substance?" Grabe. H. --- Job menaces his friends with God's judgments, as they had done him.

c.

JOB 20

CHAPTER XX.

Ver. 2. Therefore. From this concession which thou hast just made. M. -

--

Various. Heb.

**"Hence do my thoughts cause me to answer, and for this I hasten."
Sept. "I did not thus suspect that thou wouldst contradict these things,"
&c. H. --- Sophar only speaks this second time; and he produces little
new, but begins with an air of more moderation, as if the arguments of
Job had made some impression upon him. C. --- He attempts to prove
that the wicked have no comfort long; which is true in one sense, as all
time is short, though they may prosper all their lives, as Job corrects
his observation. C. xxi. 13. W.**

Ver. 4. I know. Heb. and Sept. "dost thou not know?"

Ver. 6. Pride. Sept. "presents." H. --- Riches may be meant by pride. C.

Ver. 7. Hill. Heb. "his own dung." H. Prov. x. 7.

**Ver. 8. Fleeth. The poets assign wings to sleep and to dreams. Homer,
&c.**

**Isaias (xxix. 7.) describes a man who dreams that he is eating, and finds
himself hungry when he awakes. Such is the live of the avaricious, (C.)
and of all wicked people. H.**

**Ver. 9. Behold him, as if it were susceptible of resentment, and entered
into the views of God. C.**

vii. 10. Ps. xxvi. 35. C.

**Ver. 10. Be. Heb. "seek to please the poor, and his hands shall restore
their goods," which the wicked had gotten by oppression. H.**

**Ver. 11. Vices of, is not in Heb. but must be understood. H. --- Youth.
Some translate, "hidden."**

Sophar perhaps accuses Job of some secret abominations, for which he was afflicted with the venereal disease. At least, nothing is more common than to see people brought to old age and infirmities unnumbered, (C.) before their time, in consequence of riotous living in their youth. H.

--- Youth may also denote the sin in which we are born, which is the source of all our maladies, and is always dragging us towards the grave. C.

Ver. 12. Evil of any king, and particularly (H.) injustice, which at first seems sweet, but will prove in the end a mortal poison. C. --- The unjust will be forced to restore his ill-gotten goods, or suffer eternally for the neglect, v. 14. 18. H. ---

Habitual sins are also overcome with most difficulty, v. 11. M.

Ver. 16. Head. Heb. "venom." Sept. "the wrath of dragons." C. --- Vipers. The same Heb. term is elsewhere rendered basilisk, or asp. The precise import of such things is not easily ascertained.

Pineda. --- Tongue. The ancients thought that serpents communicated the venom by the tongue, or sting. Moderns think they do it rather by the teeth. C.

Ver. 17. Butter. The impious may have a short-lived pleasure, but it will not give perfect satisfaction. The poets use similar expressions. C.

Mella fluant illi, ferat et rubus asper amomum. Virg.

Flumina jam lactis, jam flumina nectaris ibant. Met. i.

Ver. 18. Suffer eternal torments. C. --- Heb. "according to his substance, shall the restitution be, and he shall not rejoice." Prot.

Ver. 20. Them. Death will overtake him, like the rich man. Luke xii. 20. C.

Ver. 21. Continue. Heb. "no one shall look for his goods." The sinner eat up all in his life-time, or saw his possessions slip from him. H. --- At least, he shall not take them with him to the grave.

C.

Ver. 23. May. Heb. "And when he shall be about to fill his belly," like king Baltassar, death shall hurry him away. C. --- Rain. Sept. "hurl sorrows upon him," (H.) by an untimely death, followed with eternal hunger and thirst. Thus was treat the rich glutton. Luke xvi. 22. C.

Ver. 24. Brass; of which metal the strongest bows were made. Prot. have,

"steel:" (H.) but brass was used by the ancients for the same purpose. C. ---

This proverb shews that those who endeavour to escape from men, fall into the hands of God. Delrio. Adag. 9, t. ii.

Incidit in Scyllam cupiens vitare Charbydim. Virg. M.

Ver. 25. The sword is, occurs not in the Vulg. (H.) though it be in the Compl.

and Sixtine editions. C. --- Heb. "It is drawn, and cometh out of the body; the glittering sword cometh out of his gall; terrors are upon him." Prot. "May likewise the dart come out through his body," &c. H.

--- Ones. Heb. " Enim; giants, who formerly inhabited the land of Moab, near the eastern Idumea.

Their name might be placed for any cruel enemies. C.

Ver. 26. Darkness, or misery. C. --- Sept. "Terrors upon him, (26) and all darkness may await him." H. --- He shall find no means of escaping. C. ---

Kindled. Heb. "blown." S. Gregory observes that hell-fire is corporeal, but very different from our material fire. Chal. &c. explain this passage

in the same sense. It may also intimate interior anguish, (C.) lightning, (Vatable) pestilence, (Grot.) and every species of calamity. C. --- Tabernacle, in hell. M. --- We may also translate, "he who is left," (H.) the offspring shall be also miserable. M.

Ver. 27. Heavens, as his sins have cried for vengeance. Gen. xviii. 20. C. --- All creatures shall fight against the wicked. M.

Ver. 28. Exposed. Heb. "the bud, (C.) or increase of his house, shall depart,"

(H.) and be led away into captivity, (C.) and ruined. Sept. "Let final destruction draw away his house, and the day of wrath overtake him."

Ver. 29. Doings. Lit. "words." Heb. "of his decree." H. --- This is what he may expect for him impiety both in words and actions. C.

JOB 21

CHAPTER XXI.

Ver. 2. Do. "After your opinion." M. --- Sym. "hear." Sept. "may this be for your consolation,"

(Heb.) which I shall receive from you, or which you may make use of, if you should be afflicted (C.) as I am. H. --- Job undertakes to show that the wicked are sometimes suffered to enjoy a long prosperity.

Ver. 4. Troubled. Heb. "Why is not my spirit shortened" by death, if your assertion be true? (H.) or why may I not be "troubled," since I have to deal, not with an enlightened judge, but with men who are under the greatest prejudices? C. --- I seem to you to dispute against God. Have I not then reason to tremble? v. 6. H. --- Though he disputed with men, it was concerning Providence and eternal things. W.

Ver. 5. Hearken to. Lit. "look steadfastly on me." H. --- Compare my present with my former condition, and do not pretend to fathom God's judgments; which fall me also with astonishment, when I consider why the virtuous are distressed, and the wicked prosper, v. 7. --- Mouth be silent.

Harpocrates, the god of silence, was represented in this posture; and Virgil says, *Intentique ora tenebant*. *Æneid* ii. --- Sept. "upon the cheek," like men in deep consideration. C.

Ver. 7. Riches. This is what fills me with great anxiety. Yet it quite destroys the force of your argument, (C.) since you pretend that the prosperity of the wicked is never of long duration. We see them, however, live to an advanced old age, (H.) continually offending God, and annoying their neighbours. C. ---

Sept. "yea, they grow old in riches."

Ver. 8. Sight. The Jews esteemed this as the greatest blessing and mark of God's favour. Yet it was also equivocal, as it was often possessed by

the wicked. C.

Ver. 9. Rod. Divine judgments. M. Ps. lxxii. 5.

Ver. 10. Cattle. Lit. "ox," bos. Prot. "their bull gendereth, and faileth not." H. ---

But Bochart explains it of the cows' bringing forth every year. C. --- Ox is used in the same sense, both by sacred and profane authors. H. --- A great part of the riches of these nations consisted in cattle.

Ps. cxliii. 14. Zac. viii. 5.

Ver. 11. Their. Sept. "They continue like eternal sheep, as if they and their flocks would never die. C. --- And play, is to shew the nature of the dance. It is not in Heb. H. --- The children are healthy and sportive. M. --- Sept. "they play before them." H.

Ver. 13. Moment. Sept. "in the rest of the lower region, adou, they shall be laid," (H.) in the grave. M. --- A sudden death, without agony or sickness, (H.) was the choice of Julius Cæsar, the night before he was slain. *Repentinum inopinatumque prætulera*t. Sueton. --- But the enlightened servant of God would rather desire time to do penance, and to prepare for death. For who shall presume that he has that charity which banisheth fear? C. --- Hell. The same term is used for the place where the damned are tormented, as for that where the souls of the just waited (C. vii. and xvii.) for their Redeemer's coming. But here Job is speaking of the apparent happiness of the wicked; (H.) and only alludes to the grave, (C. M.) or comfortable death and burial of the reprobate: though, at the same time, he may declare that their souls are buried in hell.

H.

Ver. 14. Ways. The too common effect of riches. Prov. xxx. 8. Eccli. v. 2.

Ver. 16. Because, is not in Heb. "Lo, their good is not." They are not possessed of true riches, or of good sense. Alex. Sept. "For good things were in their hands: but the works of the impious are not pure." No: the more they possess, the greater is their perversity. Grabe substitutes oukathora, for kathara; God

"does not behold" the works, &c. which is more conformable to the other editions; and thus the blasphemies of the impious are continued. H. --- When we are not sensible of our wants and dependance, we think less on God. C. ---

Hand, or power, they are only the gifts of God; far be then such sentiments from me. C.

Ver. 17. How often. When do we witness the downfall of the wicked? Mercer. ---

Or, in a contrary sense, how often are they miserable as well as the just? Such things are, therefore, a very equivocal argument, to prove either side of the question. Those who are afflicted, and cling closer to God, must be accounted virtuous and happy; while that prosperity is fatal which is an occasion of our neglecting his service. C. --- Job answers his own questions, v. 7. If the wicked be happy for a time, their future state is deplorable, and often they forfeit even their temporal advantages. M.

Ver. 19. The sorrow. Prot. "his iniquity." Marg. "that is the punishment. " H. ---

The children shall share in his punishment, (C.) when they have been partakers, or imitators of his injustice.

H. --- Know his offence, and whether there be a God (C.) and Providence. M.

Ver. 21. And if. Heb. "when" he is cut off in the midst of his days: he does not regard the happiness or misery of those whom he leaves behind. H. --- The children are rather taken away for his punishment, while he is living, as their misery would not touch him in the grave. M.

Ver. 23. Hale, or healthy. Heb. "in perfect strength." H. --- Sept. "simplicity, or folly." S. Aug.

reads with the old Vulg. "in the strength of his simplicity, (C.) or innocence. H.

--- These outward appearances prove nothing for interior piety or wickedness.

C.

Ver. 24. Bowels. Prot. "breasts" (Marg. "milk-pails") are full of milk. But the Sept. Bochart, &c.

agree with the Vulgate. Job describes a corpulent man (C.) living in luxury, like the glutton. H.

Ver. 25. Any. Heb. "ever having eaten with pleasure." H.

Ver. 27. Me. I perceive you are not convinced; and what you say respecting the wicked, is pointed at me. M.

Ver. 28. Prince. Job, (M.) or rather the tyrant, whose lot we know is miserable, as he falls a victim of God's justice. C. xx. 7.

Ver. 29. Way. Travellers, who have seen foreign countries, (Vatab.) or any one that may be passing, (Sanchez) will answer this objection (H.) in my favour. M.

--- They will all agree in testifying that the wicked prosper, even for a long time.

C.

Ver. 30. To the. He will be requited indeed, at last; or rather, when others are in the utmost danger, he will be protected as it were by God. Sept. (C.) or Theodotion, "the wicked is kept on high," chouphizetai. All from v. 28 to 33

inclusively, is marked as an addition to the Sept. by Grabe, who has supplied many similar omissions, of which Origen and S. Jerom complained. H.

Ver. 31. Done. Man is afraid, and God defers to take cognizance. C.

Ver. 32. Dead. Heb. "the sheaves," being quite ripe for harvest, and even in the tomb, the tyrant retains some sort of pre-eminence, as he is buried with honour, an set like a more elevated sheaf, to inspect the rest. C. --- Godiss, is rendered by Prot. "tomb," (margin) "heap." But (C. v. 26.) where only the word occurs again, we find "a shock of corn," and this comparison seems very suitable here. The damned shall watch, alas, when it will be to no purpose, among the heap of fellow-sufferers, who would not think while they had time to repent. After millions of night spent thus without sleep or ease, we may imagine we hear their mournful lamentations from the depth of the abyss.

Always misery! and never any hope of ease! H. --- "Eternity," says Bridayne, (ser.

in Maury's Eloq.) "is a pendulum, the vibration of which sounds continually, Always! Never! In the mean while, a reprobate cries out: What o'clock is it?

And the same voice answers, Eternity!"

Thus at last the wicked shal awake from the sleep in which they have spent their days; (H.) and their watching, restless, and immortal souls (S. Thom.) will bitterly lament their past folly. What profit will they

derive from the honours paid to their corpse by surviving friends, (H.) even though they be embalmed, and seem to live in marble statues? Pineda.

Ver. 33. Acceptable to the gravel of Cocytus. The Hebrew word, which S. Jerom has here rendered by the name Cocytus, (which the poets represent as a river in hell) signifies a valley or a torrent: and in this place, is taken for the low region of death, and hell: which willingly, as it were, receives the wicked at their death: who are ushered in by innumerable others that have gone before them; and are followed by multitudes above number. Ch. --- Isaias (xiv. 9.) and Ezechiel (xxxii. 21.) describe the splendid reception in hell of the kings of Babylon and of Egypt, nearly in the same manner as Job does that of any sinner who has lived in prosperity. C. xxxviii. 17. He gives life to the whole creation, in the true spirit of poetry. C. --- The rich man is represented as tenderly embraced by his mother earth; (C. i. 21. H.) the very stones and turf press lightly upon him; as the ancients prayed, Sit tibi terra levis. Heb. "the stones or clods of the torrent (C.) shall be sweet to him, and he," &c. H. --- S.

Jerom has chosen to mention a particular river, instead of the general term nel,

"a torrent or vale," to intimate that Job is speaking of the state after death.

--- Cocytus is a branch of the Styx, a river of Arcadia, of a noxious quality, which the poets have place in hell. Pineda. --- Sept. "The pebbles of the torrent became sweet to him, and in his train every man shall come, and unnumbered men before him." Alex. MS. has "men of number;" the two first letters of anarithmetoi being omitted. H. --- The Church reads in her office for S.

Stephen, Lapides torrentis illi dulces fuerunt: ipsum sequuntur omnes animæ justæ. Many explain this passage of Job as a menace. The wicked have carried their insolence so far as to (C.) give orders to (H.) be buried with the utmost pomp: but in the other world, they shall be thrown ignominiously among the other dead. S. Greg. &c. C. --- They

were little moved with the thought of death, as it was common to all.
But what will they think of eternal misery? H.

Ver. 34. Vain. These arguments shew that your assertions are destitute
of proof, and afford me no comfort. C.

JOB 22

CHAPTER XXII.

Ver. 2. Knowledge. How then canst thou dispute with God?

Ver. 3. Profit. God rules all with justice or with mercy: since, therefore, he punishes, it must be for some guilt, and not for his own advantage. But he might still chastise for the good of man, or to manifest his own power. Jo. ix. 3.

God also punishes the sinner for the wrong which he does to himself. S. Aug.

Conf. iii. 8. Any one may discover the sophism of Eliphaz. If God were indifferent with regard to our virtue, who would be able to advance one step towards him? C. ---

Man is unprofitable indeed to God, but he may reap great advantage from piety himself; and this is what God desires, as well as his own glory. Mat. v. 17. W.

Ver. 4. Fear. Thus malefactors are condemned, that they may no longer disturb society. But may not God afflict the just, though he have nothing to fear? C.

Ver. 5. Iniquities. He adduces no fresh arguments, but boldly taxes Job with many crimes, which a person in his station might have committed. He rashly concludes that he must have fallen into some of them at least. C.

Ver. 6. Pledge. Heb. "person." Debtors might be sold. Matt. xviii. 30.

Ver. 7. Water. Job's disposition was the reverse. C. xxix. 15. Such inhumanity would hardly be conceived possible among us. But he Idumeans were guilty of it; (Num. xx. 18. Isai. xxi. 14.) and if it had not been probable, Eliphaz would not have dared to speak thus. C.

Ver. 8. It. Heb. and Sept. intimate that Job accepted persons, and gave sentence in favour of his rich friends. H.

Ver. 9. Arms; possessions, condemning orphans unjustly.

Ver. 11. Waters, and misery, (C.) which such conduct deserved. H.

Ver. 12. Stars: and of course, that his Providence regardeth not human affairs.

C. --- When an infidel observed, "I think the gods are too great to want my adoration," Socrates well replied,

"The greater they appear to thee, the more oughtest thou to treat them with respect and honour."

Xenophon, Memor.

Ver. 14. Doth. Heb. "seeth not." Sept. "is not seen." --- Poles, on which the whole machine seems to turn. C. --- "Hipparchus intimated that there would be a time when the hinges, or poles of heaven, would be moved out of their places." Colum. i. 1. Heb. and Sept. (according to Origen's edition, v. 13 to 16)

"he walketh about in the circuit of heaven." H.

Immortali ævo summâ cum pace fruatur

Semota a nostris rebus, sejunctaque longè. Lucret.

This was the error of the Egyptians, (Arist. Mun. 84.) which Eliphaz unjustly lays to the charge of Job, as heretics often impute condemned tenets to Catholics. W.

Ver. 15. Wicked. Sept. Alex. "just." But Grabe substitutes unjust; (H.) as otherwise, Eliphaz would argue against his own principles: unless just be put ironically for hypocrites. C. --- Wilt thou imitate the ancient giants, before the deluge? C.

Ver. 16. Flood. Heb. "river," (Sept. C.) or "flood." Prot. This does not certainly allude to the deluge, though Job could not be unacquainted with an event (H.) which appears in the writings of the most ancient pagan authors. Grot. Relig.

Ver. 18. From me. He thus insinuates that Job entertained such sentiments, though he seemed to condemn them. C. xxi. 16. C. --- Sept. "is far from him,"

God.

Ver. 19. Shall. Sept. "saw." The Jews explain this of Noe, who saw the ruin of the giants with pity, mixed with joy, as he approved of the divine judgments.

Vatab. &c. --- The just can thus rejoice, only on this account; as they would not be just if they were devoid of charity. S. Greg.

Ps. lvii. 11. and cvi. 42. C.

Ver. 20. Their. Heb. "our." C. --- "Whereas our substance is not cut down." Prot.

H. --- But the Sept. and Chal. agree with the Vulg. which gives a better sense.

--- Fire, which consumed Sodom,

&c. C.

Ver. 22. Law of Moses, (Rabbins) or rather (H.) the natural law, which teaches that God is just, and deserves to be adored. He addresses Job, as if he had acknowledged no law or restraint.

Ver. 24. Gold, to build and adorn thy habitation, v. 23. Heb. "He will give thee gold instead of dust; (or more abundant) yea, gold of the torrents of Ophir."

The Phasis is said to roll gold dust, which is of the purest kind. Gen. ii. 11. C.

--- "Thou shalt lay upon gold as dust, and the gold of Ophir, as the stones of the brooks." Prot. H. --- This is an exaggeration, (3 K. x. 27. C.) and a sort of proverb, intimating that strength and plenty should

succeed to infirmity. The foundations should be the hard rock, instead of earth, &c.

Ver. 25. Silver. Sept. "But he shall purify thee, as silver, which has passed the fire." H.

Ver. 26. Face, with confidence of being in favour and accepted. C.

Ver. 27. Vows, after obtaining thy requests. M. ---

Et positis aris jam vota in littore solves. Æn. iii.

Ver. 28. Decree. Thy projects shall succeed. Sept. "But he shall appoint for thee the rule of justice." H.

Ver. 29. Glory, as the gospel declares. Mat. xxiii. 12. The Heb. is more perplexed. "When men are cast down, then thou shalt say, there is lifting up."

Prot. (H.) or "when thy eyes shall be cast down, they shall say to thee, Arise."

C.

Ver. 30. Innocent. Heb. "He shall deliver even the man who is not innocent, and that for the sake of the purity of thy hands." Chal. Jun. &c. --- God will even spare the guilty, to manifest the regard which he has for the intercession of the saints. These interpreters have taken ai in the same sense as ain, which is the case, 1 K. iv. 21. C. --- Others explain, "He shall deliver the island of the innocent, and it is delivered by the pureness of thine hands." Prot. This also would shew the merit and protection of the saints, as a whole island may owe its safety to one of God's servants. In effect, the would stands by the prayers of the saints. H. --- All that has been said from v. 21. tends to shew that God favours his friends; and, consequently, that he would never have punish Job, if he had not been guilty. C.

JOB 23

CHAPTER XXIII.

Ver. 2. Bitterness. Instead of comfort, he only meets with insult from his friends. He therefore appeals to God, (W.) but with fear. C. --- Scourge, is not in Heb. M. --- But it explains the meaning of "my hand," (H.) or the heavy chastisement (S. Greg.) which I endure. M.

Ver. 6. Nor. Prot. "No, but he would put strength in me." He would enable me to stand my trial.

H. --- He would lay no falsehood to my charge.

Ver. 7. Victory. Before such a judge I should hope to be acquitted. Job must have been well convinced of his innocence. For woe to man, if God treat him according to the rigour of his justice! C. --- Sept. "For truth and reproof are with him. But, oh! that he would bring my judgment to an end." H.

Ver. 8. East, or Heb. "before...if behind I cannot perceive him." C. --- Where, then, shall I find this just judge? v. 3. H.

Ver. 9. Right, southward. --- See. The southern part of the heavens, or the antarctic stars would not be discerned in Idumea. C. ix. 9. C. --- Job speaks in a human manner, as he was not ignorant of God's immensity. M.

Ver. 10. Fire. They had not a stone, like the Greeks, to try gold. C.

Ver. 12. Lips, given to Noe, (Gen. ix. 5.) or to Moses. This work was written by a Jew, who dresses up the sentiments of Job in his own style. The holy man was also acquainted with the Mosaic dispensation, though he was not bound to observe the ceremonial part of it. C. --- His words, may, however, be verified, though he speak only of the natural law, or of that which was preserved by tradition of the patriarchs, as both proceeded from God. H. --- Hid. Prot.

"esteemed...more than my necessary food. " H. --- Sept. agree with the Vulg.

The ancients placed in their bosom what they greatly esteemed. The Turks still use it as a pocket. Thevenot xxii. C.

Ver. 13. Alone. Self-existent. Heb. "in one thing," or resolution. He is immutable: all I could say would avail nothing. C.

Ver. 14. With him, to punish me afresh. Heb. "when he shall have appointed me my portion, he shall still have many such." He may treat me as a slave, allowing me only a certain portion of meat. Prov. xxx. 8. and xxxi. 15. C.

Ver. 17. Face. My afflictions have not yet taken away my life, as might have been expected. H.

--- I am less affected with my miseries, than with the dread of God's presence, v. 15. 16. C.

JOB 24

CHAPTER XXIV.

Ver. 1. Days, when he will be punished. M. --- They are convinced it will be sometime: while the wicked flatter themselves with impunity. W. --- Job has already shewn that his complaints had not been excessive, and that they were extorted chiefly by the dread which he had of God.

He now comes to prove that he had not denied Providence. For though he asserted that the wicked were sometimes at ease, he maintained that there was another world, where all would be set to rights. Without this the book would be inexplicable. C. --- Know him. Sept. "the impious."

H.

Ver. 2. Marks. This was a heinous offence, (Deut. xix. 14.) which Numa punished with death.

Halyc. i. C. --- And fed. Sept. "and those who fed them."

Ver. 4. Poor, by oppression, not allowing them to get their bread, or to walk on the same road. C.

--- And have. Heb. and Sept. "the meek...have hidden themselves together."

Ver. 5. Others. Heb. "Behold as," (H.) which may be explained of these oppressors, or rather of the poor, who are forced to flee before them to seek for food. C. --- The Vulg. and Sept. seem more favourable to the former supposition. H.

Ver. 6. Not, is omitted by the Prot. H. --- Heb. "they reap in the field food for the cattle." C. ---

His. Heb. "the wicked man's vineyard." H. --- They do not examine whether the person whom they plunder be just or not. C. --- Sept. "they have reaped before the season the field which was not theirs. But the poor (helpless men) have laboured in the vineyards of the wicked without wages or meat." H.

Ver. 7. Cold. Heb. is still ambiguous, as it may be understood either of the oppressor or of the poor. The cruelty here reprobated is contrary to the law.

Ex. xxii. 26. C.

Ver. 8. Stones, for their bed, though they be so wet. H.

Ver. 9. Robbed. Heb. and Sept. "snatched from the breast." --- Stript. Sept.

"knocked down."

Heb. "taken a pledge of, or seized the poor." C.

Ver. 10. Corn, which they had gleaned for their daily sustenance. Heb. also,

"the poor, perishing through hunger, carry the sheaf" of the rich.

Ver. 11. Of them. Heb. "of corn, and thirst while pressing out their olives." C. ---

Prot. "they take away the sheaf from the hungry, (11) which make oil within their walls, and tread their wine-presses, and suffer thirst," (H.) not being allowed to taste any thing, though the law of Moses would not suffer even the ox to be muzzled. Deut. xxv. 4. The rich look on without pity, taking their rest at noon, amid the heaps which really belong to the poor, whom they force to labour for them.

Ver. 12. Suffer. Heb. "and God suffers no disorder," according to you. C. ---

Sym. "God inspireth not folly: but they have," &c. v. 13. Sept. "But why does he not regard," (H.) or punish these things? C.

Ver. 13. Light of reason and humanity. C. --- Pineda understands that they have sought darkness, (v. 14.) to do evil. But this expression would be too harsh. C.

--- Heretics, acting against their own conscience, are stricken with blindness, so that they see not the truth. S. Greg. xvi. 26. W.

Ver. 14. Thief. Oppressing the poor, (Ven. Bede) and taking away their bread.

Eccli. xxxiv. 25.

Ver. 15. Face. Sept. insinuate "with a mask." Prot. "disguiseth his face."

Ver. 16. Themselves. The band of robbers had marked out their prey. H. --- Heb.

"In the day time they lie concealed, and know not the light." C. --- Sept. or rather Theodotion, from whom v.

15 to 17. is taken, "They have sealed themselves up during the day." If we should read eautois, Heb. lamo, we might translate as well "they marked them out for themselves." H. --- The adulterer had made is his arrangement with the faithless woman, when he should break into the house. M.

Ver. 17. Death. They are as much afraid of the light as others are of profound darkness. C. ---

They dread being detected. H.

Ver. 18. He is light, &c. That is, the adulterer, that he may not be perceived and discovered, steps as nimbly and as light as if he were walking upon the waters. Or the sense is: he is as light, that is, as swift and nimble as the running waters. --- By the way of the vineyards. That is, by the way where he may meet with fruit and blessings. Ch. --- The wicked are always inconstant. C.

Isai. lvii. 29. --- He deserves no temporal nor eternal happiness. If he were deprived of the former, he might perhaps endeavour to escape the torments of hell. H.

Ver. 19. Let. Heb. "Drought and heat consume the snow waters; so doth the grave those which have sinned." Prot. Ch. H. --- The wicked die quickly, and without a lingering illness. Piscat.

--- What foundation, therefore, has the hell of cold as well as of fire? says Amama. S. Jerom (in Matt. x.) observes, "We read very plainly in the Book of Job that there is a double gehenna, both of too much heat and of too much cold;" the latter occasions the gnashing of teeth. Mat. viii.

Carthus. --- "In this world people pass through a medium or temperate state.

But in hell, they pass from the excess of tormenting cold to that of burning fire; they will know no medium, because in this life they proceeded from one vice to another, even to the heat of lust. Albertus Magnus. H. --- Therefore they are punished with torments of a contrary nature. W. --- They go from the coldness of infidelity to the heat of heresy; (S. Greg.) from one calamity to another. Sa.

--- Sept. " For they have torn away the arm of the orphans. Then his or their sin has been remembered, and, like a dew-drop, he has disappeared. H.

Ver. 20. Sweetness. These will inherit him; (H.) for here all his pleasures will terminate. C.

Ver. 21. Fed the barren. That is, the harlot. Or else, he hath fed; that is, he hath fed upon the barren; that is, the poor and desolate. Ch. --- He has not had posterity, but pleasure, in view, when he married. Rabbins. --- Sept. agree with the Vulg. H. --- But most explain the Heb. "He hath oppressed the barren;"

which may denote those whose husband and children have been slain.

C. --- No good, but even dealt with them dishonestly. Cajetan.

Ver. 22. Down. Heb. "taketh along with him his guards for his defence. He riseth and is not sure of his life," fearing lest his enemies may still overpower him. This is a description of the tyrant's continual anxiety. C. --- Prot. "And no man is sure of life," may intimate that the wicked put all men in danger. H. ---

He who puts others in fear, must also be alarmed. M.

Ver. 23. God. Sept. "being sick, let him not expect to be healed, but he shall fall under sickness."

Heb. "Though it be given him to be in safety, whereon he resteth, yet his eyes are upon their ways," (Prot.) or "he has given (H.) himself, or appointed them (guards) for his defence, and rests on them; yet his eyes," &c. He suspects the fidelity of his servants. C. --- Pride. Man abuseth by his free-will the time which God had allowed him to repent from former sins. Rom. ii. W.

Ver. 25. And set. Sept. and Prot. "and make my speech nothing worth." H. ---

This conclusion come frequently. C. ix. 15. and xvii. 15. Job defies his friends to shew the fallacy of his arguments, or that the wicked do not enjoy prosperity, though they may be inwardly miserable.

C.

JOB 25

CHAPTER XXV.

Ver. 1. Answered. He directs his attack against Job's desiring to plead before God, and gives a wrong statement of his request, which he also attempts to refute, by urging the same inconclusive arguments as before. C. --- Blind and obstinate disputers still repeat the same objections; (W.) as Protestants do against the Catholic doctrines, which have been so often and so ably defended. H.

Ver. 2. Places. Directing all the heavenly bodies with perfect harmony. C.

Ver. 3. Soldiers. The works of the whole creation, particularly the stars and angels. M.

Ver. 4. Clean. Job had used a similar expression, as well as Eliphaz. C. iv. 17.

and xiv. 4. and xv. 15. The holy man did not assert that he was free from sin, but only that God did not punish him (C.) so dreadfully (H.) on that account, and that he has just reasons for afflicting his servants, if it were only to manifest his own power and glory. C.

Ver. 5. Sight, compared with him. The most beautiful things in nature are nothing; and of course, the most just are all imperfection, when left to themselves. C.

CHAPTER XXVI.

Ver. 4. Life. Sept. also seem to understand this of God. C. --- Job does not blame his friends for undertaking to approve the ways of Providence, but for condemning himself (S. Chrys.) rashly, (H.) and, with an air of haughtiness, endeavouring to restrain him from pleading his cause before the divine tribunal. M. --- Heb. "Whose spirit came from thee?" Prot. (H.) Did I receive my life, or do I seek advice from thee? C. --- God stood in no need of Baldad's wisdom (W.) no more than Job. H.

Ver. 5. With them. The less and greater fishes, (M.) or rather the giants and others who were buried in the waters of the deluge, and are confined in the dungeons of hell. The poets speak in the same manner.

" Hic genus antiquum terræ, Titania pubes,

Fulmine dejecti fundo voluntur in imo.

Aliis sub gurgite vasto,

Infectum eluitur scelus aut exuritur igni. " Æn. vi.

--- Homer (Iliad viii.) and Hesiod (Theog.) place the giants at the extremity of the earth, in the utmost darkness. See also Prov. ix. 18. Isai. xiv. 9. C.

Ver. 6. Hell. The grave. --- Destruction. Heb. abaddon. H. --- S. John (Apoc. ix.

11.) styles the bottomless abyss; (C.) or its angel, (H.) Abaddon, or Apollyon. It may here be called destruction, (C.) as all its victims are lost for ever to every thing that is good. The obscurity of the grave, and even that of hell, can hide nothing from God.

Ver. 7. North pole, which alone was visible in Idumea, and continued unmoved, while all the stars performed their revolutions. C. --- Nothing. Terra, pilæ similis, nullo fulcimine nixa. Ovid, Fast. vi. C. --- All tends to the centre, (M.) by the laws of attraction. Newton, &c. H.

Ver. 8. Clouds, as in a vessel or garment. Prov. xxx. 4.

Ver. 9. Over it. The firmament, with all its beauty, is but like a cloud, to conceal from our feeble eyes the splendor of God's throne.

Ver. 10. End. Till the end of the world, the ocean will respect these limits. H. ---

The ancients looked upon it as a continual miracle that the world was not deluged, as the waters are higher than the earth. Jer. v. 22. Amos v. 8. S. Bas.

and S. Amb. Hexem. Cicero, Nat. ii. --- Philosophers have explained this phenomenon. But it is still certain that the power and wisdom of God preserve the equilibrium, without which all would return to the ancient chaos. C.

Ver. 11. Heaven. The mountains are so styled by Pindar; and the poets represent them supporting the heavens. Totum ferre potest humeris minitantibus orbem. Petron. --- Yet others understand that power which keeps all things together, (C.) or the angels, to whose rule the ancients attributed the celestial bodies. S. Greg. Ven. Bede, &c.

Ver. 12. Together, at the beginning. Gen. i. 9. Heb. "By his strength he has divided the sea; and by his wisdom he has pierced the proud, or Egypt."

Rahab, (H.) or Rachab, is often put for Egypt; (Ps. lxxxviii. 11.) and all would naturally have concluded that the fall of Pharaoh was pointed at, if it had not been supposed that Job lived before that event. That is, however, dubious.

Isaias (li. 9.) uses the same terms in describing the fall of this tyrant. C.
--- Yet the Sept. translate,

"the whale," (H.) or some sea monster, which God holds in subjection, (Pineda) like the weakest creature. H. --- The foaming billows (M.) are likewise subject to his control. H.

Ver. 13. Heavens, with stars, &c. Ps. xxxii. 6. Wisd. i. 7. God also sends winds to disperse the clouds, that the heavens may appear. C. --- Artful, (obstetricante) "being the midwife." The least things are ruled by Providence.

W. --- Serpent; a constellation, lightning, the devil, or rather the leviathan. Isai.

xxvii. 1. Drusius. C. --- Sept. "by his decree, he killed the apostate dragon." H.

--- But there is no need of having recourse to allegory. C.

Ver. 14. Drop. This comparison is often applied to speech. Deut. xxxii. 2. Isai.

lv. 10. If the little that we know of God's works give us such an exalted idea of his greatness, what should we think if we could fully comprehend his mysteries? C.

JOB 27

CHAPTER XXVII.

Ver. 1. Parable: speaking in a figurative poetic style, Num. xxiii. 7. Job grants that God generally punishes the wicked, but he maintains that he also chastises the just; and hence admonishes all to revere his judgments and wisdom, and to decline from evil; which truths must always subsist, whatever may be the conduct of Providence. C. --- Parables do not always imply similes, but sometimes pithy, and profound sentences, spoken by the wisest men.

Ver. 2. Judgment. Chal. "my rule of judging." Sept. "Live the Lord, who hath judged me thus."

Sym. "hath despised my judgment." The expression seems very harsh, and may be one of those which God blames. C. xl. 3. E. C. --- Yet we shall examine that point later. C. xlii. H. --- He may only mean that he is so well convinced of his innocence, that he calls God to witness it, (C.) and adores his ways, (H.) in not permitting him to appear before his tribunal, (C.) to justify himself; (M.) so that he is abandoned to the rash judgments of others. C. xxxiv. 5. Isaias (xl. 27.) and Sophonias (iii. 15.) speak in similar terms. C. --- God deferred passing sentence, for Job's greater trial. W.

Ver. 3. Nostrils: while I live. H. --- Gen. ii. 7. Ezec. xxxvii. 14. C.

Ver. 5. Till. Never will I abandon this path, (H.) nor will I yield to your reasons, (C.) or cease to defend myself. M. --- It would have been contrary to justice and charity, (H.) as well as to truth, to confess a false crime. W.

Ver. 7. Enemy, or opponent. Heb. "my enemy shall be," &c. H. --- In effect, those who maintained the contrary to what Job taught, favoured the cause of impiety, as they represented God never punishing his servants, &c. (C.) which is contrary to experience; (H.) though it was not so evident at that time.

Houbigant. --- Job is so far from thinking riches a proof of sanctity, that he rather would wish his enemy to have them, (M.) as they are too frequently an incentive to sin. H.

Ver. 8. Soul, in death: What will it profit? &c. Mat. xvi. 26. All this proves demonstratively another world. C.

Ver. 9. Him. Like Antiochus, the wicked pray only through fear of punishment, and their request is therefore rejected. 2 Mac. ix. 13. M.

Ver. 11. Hand, or grace of God. --- Hath, how he acts, and with what design. C.

--- Quid disponat Deus. S. Aug.

Ver. 13. Portion. This you have repeatedly asserted; and (H.) I acknowledge it is generally, but not always, the case. C.

Ver. 14. Bread. Sept. "if they grow up to manhood, they shall beg." Ps. xxxvi 25. H.

Ver. 15. In death; without honour. Sanctius. --- Weep for him. Sept. "his widows no one shall lament, or pity." H. Ps. lxxvii. 63. M.

Ver. 18. Moth. Heb. "as the polar star." Jun. --- But the Chal. &c. translate with the Vulg. which agrees better with the latter part of the verse. The moth devours another's property, like the wicked man, who lodges commodiously, though not at his own expense. --- Keeper of a field, or of a vineyard. C. ---

Sept. "His house has slipt away like a moth, and what he has kept (or his riches) like a spider." H. --- The moth demolishes its own house, and is then disturbed, (M.) or thrown with the rotten wood into the fire.

Ver. 19. Nothing. His riches are all left behind! The men of riches have slept their sleep, and have found nothing in their hands. They awake as from a dream, (C. xx. 8. H.) and then they form a true estimate of things. M. --- God chiefly punishes the wicked in death. Ps. lxxv. W.

Ver. 20. Night. Darkness often denotes disgrace and misery.

Ver. 22. And he (God) shall, or Sept. the wind, (C.) "shall fall upon him." H. ---

Flee. Yet he will not escape, (M.) though he flee with all expedition. H.

Ver. 23. Place. God having waited patiently a long time, at last displays the effects of his indignation, with a sort of contempt. Prov. i. 26. Ezech. v. 13. C. Ps.

ii. 4. M. Pineda. --- Every passenger who shall witness his fall, and his now abandoned place, shall also testify his approbation. H.

JOB 28

CHAPTER XXVIII.

Ver. 1. Silver. Heb. "Surely there is a vein, or mine, for silver." H. --- The sagacity of man has discovered all these things. Wonderful also is the instinct of animals, v. 7. Yet wisdom comes from God alone; and those act rashly, who pretend to dive into his counsels in punishing his creatures and ruling the world. C.

Ver. 2. Stone. Prot. "and brass is molten out of the stone." H. --- "When brass comes out of the mine it resembles stone, and being mixed with earth is refined in the fire." Pliny xxxvi. 27. M.

--- All this process would require much ingenuity and time. Tubalcain was a great artist before the deluge; (Gen. iv. 22.) but we cannot tell who were the inventors of these things, though (C.) the Greeks have specified the names of some who introduced these metals into their respective countries. Pliny vii. 56.

H.

Ver. 3. He (God) hath, &c. H. --- Darkness, before which these inventions could not be made; (M.) or, man has been able to measure the hours of day and night by the shadow of the sun, and by other means. He always strives to perfect his works, and examines with care the mines which lay concealed in the most profound obscurity. C. --- Precious stones and metals lie the deepest.

M. --- From the consideration of these beautiful works, men ought to raise their minds to the Creator, and wisely rest in him alone. W.

Ver. 4. At. Nations are separated by waters from each other. C. --- Some, like the Chinese, keep all strangers at a distance. H. --- But the industry of man breaketh through all barriers. Heb. "a river separates a foreign nation forgotten by travellers; but these waters cannot stop man: they flow away." C. --- "The flood breaketh out from the inhabitants, even the waters; forgotten of the foot, they are dried up; they are gone away from men." Prot. "Sand cuts off a torrent: but those who forget the way of justice, have become infirm, and have been instable among mortals." Sept.

H. --- Travellers are sometimes parted by a swelling torrent; (Sa) and waters, bursting forth suddenly, change the roads of man. W.

Ver. 5. In its, &c. Heb. and Sept. "and under it is turned up as it were fire,"

which lies in it. H.

--- Fire, like Sodom; to which event Job alludes, C. xxii. 20. C. --- The furnaces to melt various metals have taken the place of corn, and occupy the land. M. ---

Men have extracted bitumen,

&c. even from the lake of Sodom. Pliny vii. 15. --- Nothing escapes them. C.

Ver. 6. Sapphires. The best are found in Media, in the country of the Taphyri, (Ptol.) or Raspires.

Herod. iii. 94. --- Gold. This precious metal, like all others, is found in the bowels of the earth, (H.) and in the bed of rivers, in Ophir, Peru, &c. C.

Ver. 7. Path of these metals, (M.) or a path in general. H. --- They fly, as beasts roam about, without keeping the high road; yet never miss their way, or fail to return to their own place, though they may have crossed the sea or woods, and been absent many months. This instinct is one of the wonders of nature.

C.

Ver. 8. Merchants, who go the shortest road. H. --- Heb. "of lions," which find their deans without asking for the path. C.

Ver. 9. Roots, in quest of precious metals. M. --- " Imus in viscera terræ et in sede Marium opes quærimus. " Pliny xxxiii. pref.

Effodiuntur opes, irritamenta malorum. Ovid, Met. i.

Ver. 10. Rivers. Or, the waters lodged in the mines. M. --- He hath even cut canals through the hardest rocks, (H.) and sunk wells. C.

Ver. 11. Searched, by diving; (C.) or, Heb. "he bindeth the rivers from flowing;"

diverting their course by dams, &c. This is another proof of the power of man.

C. --- Labor omnia vincit. Hor.

Ver. 12. Understanding, of supernatural things, which teaches us to love God, and to comprehend his counsels. This is very different from the human sagacity of which he has been speaking; and this is the gift of God alone. C.

Ver. 13. Price. It has none, like other precious things. Bar. iii. 15. --- In delights is not expressed in Heb. or Sept. C. --- But to live in misery is hardly to be accounted living, (H.) and the addition restrains the proposition, as some men possess this treasure, though not those who take no pains (C.) to mortify corrupt nature. H. --- Chal. "it is not found in the land of the proud, whose life is spent in sin." C. --- True wisdom is found, not in natural, but in supernatural, things. W.

Ver. 15. Finest, obrizum, which has the colour of fire. Pliny xxiii. 3. The old Vulg. and Sept.

read "locked-up gold," aurum conclusum, (C.) and the Heb. Segor, (H.) "that which is shut up,"

like things of value: gold is sometimes specified, 3 K. vi. 20.

Ver. 16. Dyed, &c. Heb. cethem ophir, (H.) "the shut up" (gold, though the Vulg.

Sept. &c. vary in the interpretation) "of Ophir." This country was famous for its gold. C. --- Its situation is not clearly ascertained. S. Jerom seems to have placed it in India, which Josephus, "in the golden country," now Malacca. ---

Stone. Prot. onyx. Heb. shoham (H.) means, probably, the emerald.

Gen. ii. 12. C. --- But these names are very indeterminate. Theodotion, from whom grater part of this chapter is inserted in the Sept. has "the gold of Ophir, and the precious onyx and sapphire."

H.

Ver. 17. Gold. This is the third time it has been mentioned, according to its different degrees of excellence. Hence it is called by the most common name, (C.) **zahab.** H. --- Crystal was formerly more "transparent" than we have it at present. C. --- **Zecucith (H.)** denotes something of this kind. C.

Ver. 18. Things. Heb. **Ramoth** and **Gabish (H.)** are terms much controverted.

The first may denote the unicorns, (Deut. xxxiii. 17.) and the latter the thunderbolt, or **ceraunia**, which were in high request. Pliny xxxvii. 9. **Ezechiel (xiii. 11. and xxvii. 16.)** mentions the former as carried by merchants to Tyre.

These stones, which fell from the sky, were used by the Parthian magi, &c.

for secret purposes. They have given rise to many fabulous accounts. Those which are to be seen, are by no means beautiful. C. --- Yet if the people esteemed them, Job might well include them among other things of most value. Prot. "No mention shall be made of coral, or of pearls, for the price of wisdom is above rubies." H. --- The latter part of the verse would be rather,

"the fishing for wisdom would be more difficult than that for pearls;" (C.) or,

"the extraction of wisdom is above the drawing for of peninim. " H. --- The pinna is a kind of fish which is fastened to the bottom of the sea, by roots, of which the byssus was made. 1 Par. xv. 27. Pearls were commonly found in the Persian Gulf, near Idumea. The art of diving for them, and extracting them from the fish, was very difficult, but nothing in comparison with the labour requisite to discover wisdom.

The ancients describe some pearls of a reddish gold colour. Athen. iii. 13. Jer.

Lam. iv. 7. --- Adam, which is interpreted red, in Jeremias, means also any thing very shining; in which sense the word *purpureus* is used. Hor. vi. Ode 1.

Bochart, Anim. p. 2, b. v. vi. (C.) and t.

iii. 681. 91. The opinion of this author seems preferable to that of Hutchinson and Cooke, who would translate *peninim* (H.) by "loadstones or magnets,"

which the former says are like "reddish clay," though they are really of a dusky iron grey, sometimes tinged with brown or red. This complexion would not be very beautiful. Yet the Nazarites are compared to *peninim*, (Lam. iv.) and to snow, (Parkhurst) as they were of a most fair red and white, like pearls. H. ---

Though the ancients seem to have been acquainted with the loadstone or magnetic needle, particularly the Phenicians (Odys. viii. 556.) and Chinese, for many ages, yet it was never so common as to form a popular comparison.

Aquila renders the word in question, *periblepta*, "conspicuous things;" and pearls were certainly highly valued by the Jews, &c. Parkhurst, in *pone*. ---

Theodotion, in the Sept. "draw forth wisdom before the inmost things." --- Both these versions agree with the Vulg.

as the most precious goods are kept out of sight. H. --- Yet the deepest mines of gold do not require so much diligence and sagacity for us to discover and possess them, as wisdom does; but, in return, it will abundantly recompense the man who finds such a treasure. Eccli. vi. 19. and 24.

Pineda.

Ver. 19. Ethiopia, on the east of the Red Sea. Pliny (vi. 29.) mentions the isle of Chuthis, which was also famous for the topaz. --- Dying. Heb. cethem, (H.) which we have observed relates to gold, v. 16.

Ver. 22. Destruction. Heb. abaddon, which is before (C. xxvi. 6.) used to signify the bottomless abyss. There, too late! the dead become acquainted with the value and nature of wisdom. H. ---

But their knowledge is imperfect, and of no use to us. C.

Ver. 25. Measure. He regulates the winds, and know the drops of water, (H.) which to man is impossible. Prov. xvi. 2.

Ver. 26. Storms; or Heb. "for the lightning, which attends thunder." C.

Ver. 27. It. All the works of God proclaim his wisdom. H. --- He never made an acquisition of it, but possessed it from all eternity. Prov. viii. 23.

Ver. 28. Understanding. This is the duty of man, and a thing of the utmost importance. This teaches us to adore God's judgments (C.) in silence. H. --- It is the most important instruction of the whole book. Pineda. --- Man must consider God's works to fear Him; and by avoiding evil, and doing good, (W.) to shew true wisdom. H.

JOB 29

CHAPTER XXIX.

Ver. 2. Me. Job perceiving that his friends made no reply, (C.) and yet did not appear satisfied, (H.) explains how he had behaved in prosperity, in answer to the insinuations of Eliphaz; (C. xxii.

5.) and what miseries he now experienced; though he maintains these were not inflicted on account of his sins. He continues this discourse in the two next chapters. C. --- He wishes to be restored to his former state, for his own vindication, (H.) and that he might exercise the works of mercy. Ven. Bede.

Ver. 4. Youth. Heb. also "autumn or winter," which are seasons of repose, when people enjoy the fruits of their labours. --- Tabernacle, and all consulted me as an oracle. C. -- Sept. "when God made the visit of my house," (H.) and filled it with blessings, like that of Obededom, 2 K. vi. 12.

Ver. 6. Butter. Many understand "cream." But butter was used to anoint the body, as well as oil.

Non omittendum in eo (butyro) olei vim esse, & Barbaros omnes infantesque nostros ita ungi.

Pliny ix. 41. --- Oil. These hyperbolical expressions denote the utmost fertility.

Gen. xlix. 11. C.

--- Sept. have "milk." On all sides, Job could behold his rich pastures and cattle, (H.) so that he might have washed his feet in butter and milk. The rocks also were covered with olive trees; (M.) or the stone used for a press made the oil gush forth. Cajet. Sa.

Ver. 7. To the gate. Sept. "early." --- Chair, or throne, where Job sat in judgment. H. --- It appears evident that he was the prince in his city. Idumea had at first several petty kings at the same time. Gen. xxxvi. 15. C. --- But Job had several princes (ver. 9. H.) under him. Pineda.

Ver. 11. Gave. Sept. "winked," through approbation. C.

Ver. 16. Diligently, not passing sentence at random. I also endeavoured to do justice to those who durst not make any complaint. The prince ought to have an eye to all things. C.

Ver. 17. Prey, which he had extorted from the poor. M.

Ver. 18. Nest, in security, and among my children. C. --- Palm-tree. Sept. "But I said, my youth shall grow old like the shoot of the palm-tree: I shall live a long time." This is clearly the meaning of this version, (H.) as appears from the word *stelechos*, "a shoot (C.) or trunk." M. ---

Yet as phoinix, signifies also "a Phœnician, and the phœnix," some have explained this passage of the latter, which seems agreeable to the mention of a nest. Many fabulous accounts have been given of this bird, of which only one is supposed to exist at a time, rising from its parent's ashes; which, if true, (C.) would have been very (H.) beautifully applicable to a future resurrection. S.

Clem. ep. 1 Cor. S. Amb. de fide Res. ii. 59, &c. See Solin, xlii. Tacit. Ann. vi.

This uncertain bird may have been confounded with the bird of Paradise.

Palm-trees live a long time, and multiply shoots all round them surprisingly.

Pliny xiii. 4. and xvi. 44. --- Yet the Scripture never elsewhere uses the term eul for this tree. The moderns generally translate, "I shall multiply my days like the sand," which is a very common expression. C. Diss. --- The following verse seems, however, favourable to the sense of the Sept. and Vulg. though the heavy nature of sand, which

"remains" in its place, might serve to express the confidence which Job had of continuing for a long time in the midst of prosperity. H.

Ver. 19. Harvest. Prot. "branch." Ps. i. 3. Isai. xviii. 4. H.

Ver. 20. Bow, strength. I thought my glory would never end. M.

Ver. 23. Shower, in autumn, at which season only, and in spring, it rained in those countries. C.

Deut. xi. 14. M. --- It would, of course, be very acceptable after the drought of summer. Prov.

xvi. 15.

Ver. 24. Earth, with neglect. C. --- My attendants could scarcely believe their own eyes, through joy, (H.) when I assumed a more familiar air with them. C. ---

They still revered my authority.

M.

Ver. 25. With. Heb. "in his army, like one comforting people in mourning." H. ---

Job was not merely as, or like a king, but also one in effect; exercising the power, (v. 7.) and wearing the royal robes, v. 14. S. Isid. Ven. Bede, &c. W.

JOB 30

CHAPTER XXX.

Ver. 1. Flock, to watch over them. Sanchez. C. --- I had so little confidence in them, (H.) or they were so very mean. C. --- They were not as well fed as my dogs. Nicetas. --- Job does not speak this out of contempt, as he was affable to all. But this proverbial expression denotes how vile these people were. M. ---

Even the most contemptible, and such as were not fit to have the care of dogs, derided him. W.

Ver. 2. And they. Heb. "Their old age is perished." They were good for nothing all their lives.

C.

Ver. 3. Who. Heb. "solitary in," &c. Yet these vagabond (H.) people now insult over me. C.

Ver. 4. Grass. "There (in Crete, where no noxious animal, no serpent lives) the herb alimos, being chewed, expels hunger for the day;" admorsa diurnam famem prohibet. Solin. 17. --- The Heb. malliuch, is rendered halima, by the Sept. (H.) and Bochart would translate, "who gather the halima from the bush."

C. --- Prot. "who cut up mallows by the bushes, and juniper roots for their meat." H. --- Yet all agree that the latter is not proper for food. C. --- Rethamim may (H.) designate any "shrubs or wild herbs," as the Sept. and Symmachus have explained it. C. ---

Perhaps the very poor people might use the juniper or broom roots for food, (M.) or to burn in order to prepare their victuals. H. --- The Arabs and Spaniards still use the word retama for "the birch-tree." Parkhurst.

Ver. 5. Who. Sept. "through excessive hunger. Robbers rushed upon me." Prot.

"They were driven forth from among men; (the cried after them as after a thief.") H.

Ver. 6. Gravel of the torrents. M. --- Heb. "in the rocks," living like the Troglodites. H.

Ver. 7. Pleased. Heb. "brayed." C. --- Briars. Prot. "nettles." They were driven from the society of men and forced to abscond. H.

Ver. 8. And not. Heb. "viler than the earth." Prot.

Ver. 9. Bye-word. "Proverb." H. --- They speak of me with contempt. C. xvii. 6.

Ver. 10. Face. This most people explain literally; while some, (C.) as Job was herein a figure of Christ, (M. Matt. xxvi. W.) think that the expression denotes the utmost contempt; (S. Greg. &c.) or that the people spit upon the ground (C.) for fear of contracting any infection; (H.) and because lepers were held in the utmost abhorrence. C.

Ver. 11. For he. Prot. "Because he hath loosed my cord, and afflicted me, they have also let loose the bridle before me," (H.) being no longer under any restraint. Sometimes it was customary to put bits into the mouth of a person who was led to execution. Isai. xxxvii. 29. C.

--- The Heb. plural, have put, insinuates the plurality of persons in God, (W.) though it may be as well referred to the enemies of Job.

Ver. 12. Forthwith. Heb. pirschach seems to be translated (H.) by three terms, rising, calamities, and forthwith, as it denotes "a bud" which suddenly appears. C. --- Sept. Blaston, "On the right hand of the bud they rose up." H. ---

Heb. "Youth stood up on the right," to accuse me; (Ps. cviii.

6.) or, "Scarcely had I begun to flourish, when they rose up," &c. The days of prosperity soon vanished, (C.) and young men were ready to insult the distressed, and, as it were, to trip them up.

M. --- Sept. "they stretched out their feet and trampled upon me, that they might destroy me. " H.

--- They seem to have read (C.) regliem, "their feet," though the two last letters are now omitted in Heb. H.

Ver. 13. Help them, or me. C. Sept. "they took off my garment." H. --- Job seemed to be besieged, and could not escape. C.

Ver. 14. Down, (devoluti sunt.) They have proceeded to aggravate my misfortunes. H. --- "They came upon me as a wide breaking in of waters: in the desolation they rolled themselves upon me.

Prot.

Ver. 15. Nothing. Heb. "terror." H. --- Desire. Heb. "princess," reason. C. --- Prot.

"soul."

Sept. "my hope has flown away like wind." H.

Ver. 16. Fadeth. Heb. "is poured out," (H.) ready to take its flight. Ps. xli. 5.

Ver. 17. They that. Heb. "my sinews take no rest." Sept. "are dissolved." H. ---

The worms prey upon me, and I am like one in a raging fever. C.

Ver. 18. Coat. The worms are so numerous, (M.) or my enemies pour upon me.

C. --- Sept.

"with great power He (God; Prot. my disease) has seized me by the garment."

Theodotion adds,

"He has taken hold of me like the collar of my tunic:" (H.) which corresponds with our shirt, and had an opening at the top. C.

Ver. 19. I am. Heb. "He hat cast me into the mire;" (Prot.) or, "He regards me as dirt; my portion is on the earth and dust." H. --- All look upon me with horror and contempt. C.

Ver. 20. Not is supplied by Prot. in the second part of the verse from the first; (H.) as this construction is not unusual in the Heb. Sept. "they

have stood up, and have considered me," (C.) to procure my entire ruin. H.

Ver. 22. Dashed me in pieces, as if I had been raised so high for that purpose.

Heb. "thou hast dissolved my substance," wisdom, &c. The signification of tushiova (H.) is very indeterminate.

C. v. 12. C. --- "Thou hast cast me far away from salvation." Sept. and Theodot.

H.

Ver. 23. Liveth. Death is a relief to a just man in tribulation. W.

Ver. 24. Consumption. Thou dealest mercifully with other people: but all the effects of thy anger fall upon me, even here. Sept. "O that I might lay hands on myself, or desire another to do this for me!" Heb. has nothing similar; but is very obscure: "He will not, however, stretch forth his hand to the grave; and when they are wounded, they are healed." C. --- Prot. "grave, though they cry in his destruction." H. --- The grave is more desirable than such a life. There the dead are freed from the miseries of this world. C.

Ver. 28. Mourning. Heb. "blackened without the sun." H. --- Bile has disfigured my countenance, through excessive sorrow, v. 30. The dark olive complexions of the Jews and Arabs would be more susceptible of these effects. C. ---

Indignation. I have not given way to passion, though I allowed full scope to my groans. Sept. H.

Ver. 29. Brother of dragons, &c. Imitating these creatures in their lamentable noise. Ch. -- I was like those beasts which retire in order to lament. W. --- The dragons hiss dreadfully, when crushed by the elephant; (S. Jer.) and the young ostriches, being abandoned, make great lamentations. M.

Delrio, t. ii. adag. 18. --- This comparison occurs, Mic. i. 8. Natural history does not, however, represent these animals as very plaintive. The former term may denote sea monsters, or crocodiles; thannim: (Sept. syrens) and "the daughters of the yahana, " signify "swans," (Isai. xiii.

21.) though commonly rendered ostriches, as they are by the Sept. &c. C. ---

Prot. have, "owls."

But we may adhere to the Vulg. H.

Ver. 31. Weep. I have exchanged my sons of joy for mourning. M.

JOB 31

CHAPTER XXXI.

Ver. 1. I made. Job is compelled to proclaim his own praises, for his vindication, as S. Paul was, being at the same time convinced that he had only done his duty. Luk. xvii. 10. This is the third part of his discourse. Having given a picture of his prosperous and of his miserable condition, he observes that the latter was not inflicted in consequence of any misconduct, since he had always been attentive to avoid (C.) the most remote danger of offending God, or his neighbour. H. ---

That I. Heb. "for why should I think upon a virgin?" H. --- Why should I expose myself, (C.) by indiscreet looks, (H.) since the passage from the eye to the heart is so easy. Eccles. ii. 10. M. ---

In the warfare between the flesh and the spirit, Job deemed this precaution necessary, (W.) and was thus preserved from carnal thoughts. S. Greg. xx. 2.

Ver. 2. High, if I should give way to such unchaste thoughts. M.

Ver. 3. Aversion of God. Hebrew "strange punishment. " Prot. Incontinence is a source of much mischief, and of the most dreadful punishments, as the deluge and fate of Sodom evince. H.

Ver. 5. Vanity, or hypocrisy, (C.) so as to overreach others. M.

Ver. 6. Simplicity, and "uprightness." Tummathi. H.

Ver. 7. Eyes. Sixtus V. read, "If my eye hath followed my heart." C. --- Job kept the utmost restraint both upon his eyes and heart, that no evil impressions from exterior objects might cause his ruin. Num. xv. 39. H. --- Hands, from presents, (C.) or injustice, particularly that of impurity.

H.

Ver. 9. Door, to seduce his wife. C. M.

Ver. 10. Let. Heb. "Let my wife grind for another, and let others bend over her,"

urging her to work like the meanest slave. C. --- Sept. "Let my wife please (Grabe substitutes l of r, and reads alesai, grind for) another, and my little children be brought low." H. --- Yet the sense of the Vulg.

is most followed. Eccli. xlvii. 21. Lam. v. 13. Ausonius (epig. 5) says, molitur per utramque cavernam. C.

Ver. 11. This adultery, to which I might have given way, and that of others with my wife, (H.) which would have been a requital, of which I could not indeed have complained, (M.) but which is nevertheless a most heinous offence. H. ---

Iniquity. Heb. "a crime of judgment," or capital.

Gen. xxxviii. 24. C. --- The canons of the Church (H.) have ranked adultery with murder and idolatry, which shews the horror in which it is held. C.

Ver. 12. Spring; the children. Eccli. xxiii. 35. Wisd. iv. 3. C. --- Prot. "all mine increase." H. ---

Adulteresses were formerly consigned to the flames. The injured husband would resent the offence, and even dislike her former children. Love is also like a fire, and those who entertain it, may soon consume all their substance (M.) in feasting and presents. Above all, the fire of God's indignation in hell will still pursue the libidinous.

Ver. 13. Me, in private; as slaves had no redress in the common courts of judicature. We cannot but admire Job's humility, and noble

**sentiments of God, (C.) whose majesty will eclipse all human grandeur,
and place the master and the servant on the same level. S. Greg. S. Aug.
de Civ. Dei. x. 25. Eph. vi. 9. Col.**

iv. 1.

Ver. 16. Wait, and not give sentence in due time, (H.) but frustrated her expectation. M.

Ver. 17. Alone. This was objected to S. Chrysostom. C. --- But his conduct proceeded not from pride or avarice. H. --- The ancient patriarchs delighted much in the exercise of hospitality; and Tobias (iv. 17.) exhorts his son to invite the poor. Cœna, or "supper," received its name from many eating

"together," while people dined alone. Plut. Sym. viii. prob. 6.

Ver. 18. Womb. I was of a compassionate disposition, with which I always corresponded. S.

Greg. --- Heb. "from my youth, pity (ceab, which Prot. translate "as with a father." H.) grew up with me; and from my birth I have preserved it!" C. --- Prot.

"From my youth he was brought up with me, as with a father, and I have guided her (the widow, margin) from my mother's womb."

Sept. "I fed him as a father, Theodotion adds, and was his leader from," &c. It was my earliest delight to assist the afflicted orphan and widow. H.

Ver. 20. Blessed me for clothing. M.

Ver. 21. Gate, in judgment, (C.) where I was the supreme judge, (H.) and none could resist me.

Ver. 22. With. Heb. "from its bone," at the elbow. Sept. C.

Ver. 23. Bear. I knew that he would resent the injury, though I might, for a time, oppress the weak.

Ver. 24. Fine obrizo. Heb. cethem. C. xxviii. 15. H.

**Ver. 27. Rejoiced. Heb. and Chal. "been seduced" to idolatry. M. ---
The worship of the sun and moon was most ancient. Ezec. viii. 16. ---
Mouth, to testify respect and admiration. This custom prevailed in
many nations. Lucian (dial.**

**de sacrif.) observes that this only sacrifice of the poor was not
disregarded.**

**The Syrians still extend their hands towards the altar, and then apply
them to their mouth and eyes, when the body and blood of Christ are
offered in the Mass. Life of M.**

**de Chateuil. C. --- Sept. (26) "Do I not see the shining sun eclipsed, (H.)
and the moon disappear, for light does not belong to them," but to the
Creator, from whom we have every thing; (C.) so that we should not
swell with pride.**

**Theodotion adds, (27) "and if my heart was secretly deceived." Sept.
continue,**

**"if indeed, putting my hand to my mouth, I kissed, (28) this would also
be imputed to me as a great transgression, because I should have acted
falsely before the most high God." H. --- He will admit of no rival;
hence the man who admits another god, denies Him. M. --- Job repels
the charge which had been indirectly brought against him. W.**

**Ver. 29. Rejoiced. Heb. "lifted up myself." Sept. "said in my heart, well,
well;"**

euge. H. ---

**These sentiments of perfection shew that the same Spirit animated
those who lived under the law of nature, as well as those who were
favoured with the Mosaic or Christian dispensation. C.**

Ver. 30. For. Sept. "Then let mine ear hear my curse, and may I fall a prey to the whispers of my people."

Ver. 31. Filled. If my servants have not testified sufficient affection for me, (H.) because I kept them under restraint, and obliged them to wait on my guests, (M. S. Greg.) I still would not omit that duty; (v. 32. H.) or if they gave way to the greatest excesses of rage, so as to threaten to devour me, I refrained from wishing any evil to my enemy, v. 30. C. --- Others suppose that Job's domestics urged him on to revenge, and spoke as if they were ready to eat his enemies; (Cajet.

T.) while some explain the expression in a contrary sense, to denote the extreme attachment of Job's servants to his person; in which manner the Church uses it, speaking of Christ's feeding us with his own body and blood.

C. --- Sept. "If frequently my maids said who?" &c. Heb. "said not, oh! that we had of his flesh! we cannot be satisfied." Prot. H. --- Have I given my servants any reason to utter these expressions?

Ver. 33. A man. Heb. "Adam," who, to excuse himself, threw the blame upon Eve. Gen. iii. 12.

C. --- His posterity have too frequently imitated his example. The name of Adam often designates any man. H. --- It was requisite that Job should assert his sincerity, that his friends might not suppose that he was actuated by self-love or obstinacy to defend his innocence. C. ---

Sept. "If falling into an involuntary fault I hid my sin, (for I feared not the crowd of people, that I should not plead before them) but if I let the needy pass my gate with his bosom empty." Theod.

xxxv. subjoins, "who would give me a hearer? but if I did not revere the hand of the Lord." Sept.

go on, "the bond which I had against any one, if I placed on my shoulder, as a crown, and read, an did not rather tear it, and give it up, taking nothing from my debtor. If," &c. v. 38. According to this

version, Job insists on his pity for the distressed, and shews that he had no reason to fear. But the Hebrew is more conformable to the Vulg.

Ver. 34. Have not. Heb. "that I kept silence, not going out of doors" to defend the innocent. H.

--- Moses commands judges to do their duty without fear. Ex. xxiii. 2. People in such situations ought to be uninfluenced by hatred, love, &c. Cæsar says, justly, (in Sallust) " qui de rebus dubiis consultant, ab adio, amicitîâ, irâ atque misericordia vacuos esse decet. Haud facilitè animus verum providet, ubi illa officiunt. " H.

Ver. 35. He himself. Heb. "my adversary would write a book." His very accusation would establish my cause, provided he adhered to the truth. C. --- I would carry it about as a trophy. H.

--- A book. The judge wrote down the sentence. Job appeals to God, and fears not being condemned.

Ver. 36. Crown. This shews that something pliable was then used to write on.

The people of the East still lift up to their heads such letters as they respect.

Chardin Perse, p. 218. See 4 K. xi.

12. C.

Ver. 37. To a. Heb. "as a prince would I approach to him," and not fear my adversary. H.

Ver. 38. Mourn, as if I possessed the land unjustly, or had committed some crime.

Ver. 39. Money. Or paying for them. M. --- And have. Prot. "or have caused the owners thereof to lose their life."

Ver. 40. Thorns. Prot. "cockle." Marg. "loathsome weeds." H. --- The precise import of the word is not known; but it means something "stinking." C. ---

Sept. Batos, "a briar." H. ---

Ended. Many Latin editions omit these words with S. Gregory, &c. The old Vulg. has & quieverunt verba Job, as a title. C. --- Sept. place at the beginning of the next chapter, "And Job ceased to speak. His three friends also left off contending with Job; for Job was just before them." Grabe substitutes

"himself," as they were not perhaps yet convinced. H. --- Job, however, addresses his discourse no more to them, but only to God, (C.) acknowledging some unadvised speeches; (W.) or want of information. H.

JOB 32

CHAPTER XXXII.

Ver. 1. Himself. They thought it useless to say any more.

Ver. 2. Buzite, a descendant of Buz, the son of Nachor. Gen. xxii. 21. C. -
-- Of,

&c. Sept. "of the country of Hus." --- Ram. Chal. "Abraham;" (M.) or rather (H.) this is put for Aram. Sym.

"Syria." 2 Par. xxii. 5. Some suppose that Eliu spring from Aram, the son of Esron, of the tribe of Juda. Others think that (C.) he was the same with Balaam.

S. Jer. Ven. Bede. --- He is never ranked among the friends of Job, as he perhaps did not come from a distance. His speech, or good intention, is not condemned by God; and Job seems to have acquiesced in what he said. C.

--- This silence of the latter might rather proceed from a just (H.) contempt, as Eliu said nothing to the purpose; many of his observations being palpably false, and others not at all controverted.

Yet with his private spirit he comes forth, not much unlike Prot. and Puritans, who pretend that they will overturn the Catholic faith by arguments which have escaped the sagacity of all preceding ages! W. --- God also did not let Eliu pass entirely unnoticed; but, in one line, showed his displeasure: (C. xxxviii. 2.

Houbigant) as Job perhaps did likewise, by repeating the same decision. C.

xlii. 3. H. --- Eliu vainly explains why he had not spoken before. He arraigns Job for asserting his own innocence, though the holy man only maintained that he was not punished thus for his crimes, according to the laws of vindictive justice; (C. xxvii. 2.) much less did he pretend

that he was juster than God, (C. xxxv. 2.) as his adversary asserts; taking thence occasion to praise the divine wisdom and power, as if Job had called them in question. C.

--- God, whose eyes behold the smallest faults. M. --- Heb. "rather on, or (H.) above God." C. --- This young man, who was learned and proud, is the pattern of those hot disputants who set themselves above their elders. S. Greg. xxiii.

2. W.

Ver. 3. Found. Heb. "produced an answer, but had still condemned Job;" (H.) or, "had made Job wicked," by giving him occasion to blaspheme, in order to defend his own righteousness. C. ---

Sept. "they took it for granted (or laid it down as a fact, ethento) that he was a wretch." This was not true: (H.) but they had also doe their best to prove it. C.

--- Job. Almost all the Rabbins assert that the original copies read Jehova, "the Lord;" (H.) and that the Masorets changed it, to avoid the apparent blasphemy; as if the three friends had rendered themselves guilty by not answering Job.

But the Chal. &c. are silent on this head, and Abenezra allows that the change is very doubtful. C.

Ver. 6. Hanging. Heb. "I fest a reverential awe, (Sept. I was silent) and durst not shew," &c. H.

Ver. 8. Spirit, which is communicated to the young, as well as to the old. M.

Ver. 9. Aged: poluchronioi. Sept. Rabbim, "the Rabbins," (H.) the "great ones,"

placed in authority. These are not always the wisest, as understanding is the gift of God, and not attached to rank. C.

Ver. 11. Disputing. Heb. "searching out words," or arguments. H.

Ver. 12. None. A notorious piece of arrogance, to esteem himself wiser than any of his own sect, or of his adversaries. W.

Ver. 13. Man. You seem to think this a convincing proof that Job is guilty: (Ven.

Bede. H.) but it is no such thing. You would fain excuse yourselves from saying any more, for fear of causing him pain, which is already very great; and you vainly imagine that you may thus leave him to be judged by God. We must however convince Job. C.

Ver. 14. He; Job, or God. I do not pretend that I have had any revelation, like Eliphas and Sophar. C. iv. 12. and xi. 5. Job has addressed himself to you; (C.) but I shall not answer him as you have done. M. --- Those who neither believe Catholics, nor their own teachers, but rely on the private spirit, think that the answers which have been given to others, on the same points, do not regard them. S. Greg. W.

Ver. 15. They. Eliu speaks thus contemptuously of the three friends, as if they had been absent.

In the former verse he spoke to them: now he turns to Job. Heb. "they were amazed." H.

Ver. 18. Me. And forces me to speak. Jer. v. 24. and xx. 9. Thus Juvenal describes a great talker. Tunc immensa cavi spirant mendacia folles.---

Conspuiturque sinus. Sat. vi. C.

Ver. 19. Vessels, made of skins. Heb. oboth. H.

Ver. 21. Man. Heb. "give flattering titles unto man." Prot. "I do not respect a mortal." Sept. (H.)

"nothing shall make me conceal the truth: I will give things their proper names." Job seemed to him to have arrogated to himself the perfection of God, in maintaining his own innocence. C. ---

He promises to stand up in defence of the Almighty, (M.) as his advocate. C.

Ver. 22. Away. I shall therefore speak with the utmost caution, (H.) as one who must shortly appear before the divine tribunal. M. --- Heb. "For I know not how to call things by their surnames, (C.) or titles of vanity; (H.) If I do, may my Creator soon (C.) take me away." Sept. "I know not how to admire the face. If it be not so, the worms shall consume me." H.

JOB 33

CHAPTER XXXIII.

Ver. 3. Sentence. Some Edit. have scientiam, "knowledge," with the Heb. C.

Ver. 4. Spirit. We are therefore equal. M. --- Thou canst not fear being overpowered with the divine majesty, in this dispute. C. xiii. 21. C. --- Life. Sept.

"instruction." H.

Ver. 6. Formed. Job had expressed a desire to plead before a man. C. ix. 32.

and xiii. 19. and xxxi. 35. Eliu offers himself to maintain the cause of God. C.

Ver. 7. Wonder (miraculum.) Heb. "terror," (H.) in allusion to Job's words. C.

ix. 34. ---

Eloquence. Heb. "hand." C. --- Sept. "the dread of me shall not cast thee down, nor my hand be heavy upon thee." Arrogant men esteem their own observations as something wonderful. S.

Greg. W.

Ver. 9. In me. Job had not said so in express terms, though he had said something to the same purpose. But he had sufficiently explained himself, and Eliu could not be ignorant that he only meant that his present sufferings were not proportioned to his guilt. C.

Ver. 10. Complaints. Something similar had indeed come from Job's lips; (C.

xiv. 17. and xx.

21.) not that he pretended that God sought to find him guilty without cause; but he meant that He treated him as an enemy, for some secret purpose. C.

Ver. 11. Stocks. C. xiii.14. and xiv. 16. Eliu interprets the words in the worst sense, though Job had only expostulated with God on the treatment which he received, testifying a great love and confidence in him. He acknowledges some want of knowledge. C. xlii. 3. C.

Ver. 12. Man: so that he is not obliged to explain his reasons. M.

Ver. 13. Because. Sept. "Thou hast said, Why has not He heard every word of my pleading or judgment." Aquila and Theod. "for all his words are unanswerable." Prot. "He giveth not account of any of his matters." H.

Ver. 14. Time. One decision ought to suffice; and God had declared Job innocent. C. i. 8. &c.

W. --- His decrees are immutable; and yet thou wouldst have him to explain his conduct, as if he could be under a mistake, and correct it. He manifests his will, and it is our business to be attentive. We cannot expect that he should speak twice, though he does so frequently in his great mercy. Heb. "God speaketh once, and he regardeth not a second time." C. --- Sept. "But the second time, (15) a dream," &c. H. --- Eliu specifies three methods by which God declares his will; (v. 26) 1. By vision; 2. by afflictions; 3. by the voice of angels, or of preachers, v. 19. 23.

Ver. 15. Beds. It seems prophetic dreams were not then uncommon.

Ver. 16. Instructeth. Heb. "sealing," that they may not mistake such a favour for a common dream. C.

Ver. 17. Him. Sept. "his body from the fall [of iniquity.]" Grabe. H.

Ver. 19. Also. This is the second method of instruction. Eliu pretends that Job had thus been visited by God, and had not understood his meaning.

Ver. 21. Bare. The skin will scarcely cover them. He will appear ghastly, like a skeleton. C. ---

Heb. "his bones...shall stick out." Prot. H.

Ver. 22. Destroyers; the worms in the grave, (H.) or to sickness, (M.) "which bring on death."

Pagnin mortiferis.

Ver. 23. Angel, by secret inspirations, (S. Tho. T. &c.) or a man sent by God, to announce the truths of salvation. Mariana. --- Man's, or "to man." C. --- Heb. "a messenger with him, an interpreter, one...to declare to man his uprightness."

Prot. (H.) "If there be any merit in him, the angel comforter, chosen from a thousand accusers, is ready to declare to the son of man his rectitude." Sept.

"If there be a thousand destroying angels, not one of them shall hurt him; if he consider in his heart to be converted unto the Lord. Though he (the angel) lay before man his reproof, and shew his folly, He (God) will take hold of him, that he may not die. He will renew his flesh as the plaster of a wall, and fill his bones with marrow: (25) he will make his flesh soft, like that of an infant, and will place him in manhood among men." H. --- But this is different from the Heb. C. --- The intercession of angels is very powerful. They are represented as suggesting motives, which prevail on God to shew mercy, v. 24. H.

Ver. 25. Consumed. Heb. "fresher than a child's," (H.) as was the case of Naaman. 4 K. v. 14.

Ver. 26. And he. It is ambiguous whether this refer to God or to man. C. --- But both shall see each other with joy. The penitent will be restored to as much favour as if he had never sinned. H.

Ver. 29. Times, or often. God instructs man by visions, sickness, and the intercession and inspirations of angels, v. 14. C.

Ver. 30. Living, both soul and body, delivering them from adversity. C.

Ver. 32. Just, and to be so indeed. M. --- How much would his vanity be mortified, when Job answered him only with silence! (H.) though he urged him to reply so often. W.

JOB 34

CHAPTER XXXIV.

Ver. 3. Taste. The most accurate philosophers attribute this faculty to the tongue, (C.) rather than to the throat, guttur. Heb. "mouth or palate." H. --- But Eliu speaks agreeably to the notions of the vulgar. C. --- Intellectus saporum cæteris est in prima lingua, homini et in palato. Pliny xi.

37.

Ver. 5. Judgment. C. xxvii. 2. Job had used this expression, but only to intimate that strict justice did not take place, as he thought his faults had not deserved so severe a chastisement. He did not pretend that God was unjust, or that he was quite blameless; and he had so explicitly declared his sentiments, that Eliu could not well be ignorant of them. C.

Ver. 6. There. Sept. "he has been deceived;" epseusato. Heb. "I will convict my judge of lying;"

or (C.) Prot. "should I lie against my right?" H. --- Job, in the excess of grief, had expressed himself forcibly. C. xix. 6. and xxiii. 7. But great deductions must be made from such hyperboles; and he had frequently praised the mercy and justice of God, and his just punishment of the wicked. He had indeed excepted himself from the number; and Eliu ought to have proved that he was wrong in this respect. But he seems to have all along evaded or mistaken the point under dispute. C. --- Arrow, which pierces me. H. --- The deferring judgment was not a subversion of it, as Eliu would argue,. C. xxvii. 2. W.

Ver. 7. What. This may be a continuation of Job's speech, who seemed to assert that none had ever been insulted like himself, nor borne it with greater patience; (C. xvi. 4.) or Eliu reproaches him with talking scornfully to his friends and to God. C.

Ver. 8. Goeth in. Sept. insert a negation, which is not found in Heb. Chal. &c.

They may be understood to speak ironically. C. --- "Who committeth no sin, nor iniquity, nor has had any society with lawless people, so as to walk with wicked men." H.

Ver. 9. With him, and strive to please him. Horrible blasphemy! of which Job was incapable: as if God were a cruel master, and threw us into despair. He had asserted that God punishes the wicked, and often

treats his friends with the like severity, (C. ix. 22. and xxx. 26.) in this world: which is very true. C. ---

Sept. "Say not that man is visited. He is indeed visited by the Lord."

H. --- Eliu wrests Job's words, in order that he may have something to say against him. S. Greg.

xxiv. 25. W.

Ver. 13. Earth? If God cannot be unjust, hat he given the administration of the world to some other, who may have been deceived? This will not be asserted.

Heb. "who hath visited the earth for him?" or, "who hath set him over the earth?" Is he a hired judge, who may be bribed? C.

Ver. 14. To him, and examine his conduct with rigour: there is scarcely a moment of our lives in which he would not discover a just reason for withdrawing his hand, and suffering us to die. Ps.

ciii. 29. C.

Ver. 17. Judgment. How can we hope for redress from God, while he condemns his conduct?

M. --- How can we bring Job to a sense of his duty, since he entertains such perverse notions?

Heb. "Shall he hold dominion, who hates justice?" If God be unjust, does he deserve our adoration? (C.) or, "ought not the person to be put in prison, who resists judgment?" Grot. "If thou dost not think that He who hates crimes, and destroys the impious, is eternal and just?" Sept.

H.

Ver. 18. Who. Theod. in Sept. "wicked is he who says to the king, thou actest contrary to the law; and to the rulers, thou most impious." H. --- Apostate. Heb.

"Belial."

Ver. 19. Tyrant. This title is not always odious. It formerly was given to all princes, and came to be used in a bad sense, on account of the misconduct of some kings of Sicily. Tyrannus a rege distat factis, non nomine. Sen. Clem. xii.

--- Heb. "the rich more than the poor." H. --- God fears not to rebuke even the greatest princes, and dost thou dare to arraign his justice? C.

Ver. 20. They, the wicked, whatever may be their station in life. H. --- God takes off the tyrant (C.) when he least expects it, as well as the poor. H. --- Troubled, or make an insurrection. C. ---

This often proves the ruin of tyrants. H. --- Hand, by the destroying angel. C.

Ver. 22. Death, or the most obscure recess. H.

Ver. 23. Man. Heb. "He will not lay upon man (C.) more than right (Prot. H.) to,"

&c. After once passing sentence, all is over. C. --- When man has fallen into sin, he cannot with a god grace contend with God. C.

Ver. 24. Stead. Where are not the ancient Assyrians, Carthaginians, &c. who once made such a figure in the world? C. --- Sept. "glorious and sudden, and unnumbered." The next eight verses are taken from Theodotion. H.

Ver. 25. Night, calamities. At once the shall be oppressed. C.

Ver. 26. Sight. Lit. "in the place of the beholders," (H.) in public. C.

Ver. 27. All. Prot. "Any of." The wicked observed none of God's commandments as they ought.

He that offends in one become guilty of all. Jam. ii. 10.

Ver. 29. Condemn, either God or the person whom he approves. Does not he exercise dominion over all? C. --- Men. Lit. "all men." Heb. "a man." God may destroy either a part or the whole of creation. Sometimes whole nations or cities are cut off, and the deluge nearly swept away all mankind. H.

Ver. 30. People. A hypocrite denotes one infected with all sorts of crimes. S.

Iræn. v. 24. Such a king is sometimes given to punish a wicked people. Ose.

xiii. 11. Isai. iii. 4. This sense is beautiful, and followed by the Chal. Sept. &c.

We may explain the Heb. in like manner, by neglecting the Masoretic points. C.

**--- Prot. "That the hypocrite reign not, lest the people be ensnared." H.
--- Heb.**

"He overturns the throne of hypocrites, on account of the scandal of the people," or "he delivers the people from servitude." The sense of the Vulg.

seems preferable. C.

--- Eliu insinuates that Job had been a hypocrite and an oppressor; but God exculpates him. W.

Ver. 31. Seeing. Heb. "Thou shouldst have said to the Lord, I have suffered enough: (C.) I will not offend." Prot. H. v. 32. --- Turn. He had undertaken to plead God's cause. C.

Ver. 33. It, my iniquity. M. --- Will God make thee accountable for it? H. --- Yea, if thou keep silence, (C.) thou wilt seem to connive at it. H. -- - He wishes to engage Job to speak. Heb. may be translated many ways. C. --- Prot. " Should it be according to thy mind? He will recompense it whether thou refuse, or whether thou choose; and not I. Therefore speak what thou knowest." H.

Ver. 36. Father. From God all the rights of a father spring. Ephes. iii. 15. C. ---

Sept. "No indeed: but learn Job, answer not like fools." Prot. "my desire is, (marginal note, my father) that Job may be tried unto the end, because of his answers for the wicked." H. --- He has imitated their wicked discourses; let his chastisement deter others. C. --- The sequel seems to intimate, that Eliphaz is here styled Father. M.

Ver. 37. Fast, and pressed by arguments. M. C. --- Heb. "since he adds crime (C. Prot.

rebellion) to his sin, and clappeth his hands among us, and multiplieth his words against the Lord." Eliu concluding that Job was obstinate, (H.) invites his friends to join in prayer, that he might be still more severely chastised, to make him enter into himself. Such a strange petition might possibly proceed from charity. But Eliu had given too many proofs of passion, to allow this interpretation. Had he evinced that Job as a criminal? and were not his sorrows already too great, so

that he might rather have prayed that God would alleviate them, or grant him more patience?

JOB 35

CHAPTER XXXV.

Ver. 2. God. Eliu being greatly mortified at Job's silence, uses still more provoking expressions, and pretends to refute one of the holy man's assertions, which never escaped his lips, though he had complained that God treated him as an enemy, and with more severity than his sins deserved; (C. vi.

2. C.) or, that his affliction was greater than his sin. C. xxiii. 7. &c. Eliu therefore calumniates him. W.

Ver. 3. Please thee, since thou punishest the guiltless. M. --- If I sin. Job had not said so, but it seemed to follow from his expressions. C. xxi. 7. See C. xxii.

3. Whether sin be committed and punished, or not, what does it profit God? C.

--- His sovereign perfections require that he should not let sin pass unnoticed, and Job never entertained an idea to the contrary.

Ver. 4. Thee. I will shew that you are all wrong. H. --- I will supply what the three have left imperfect. C.

Ver. 5. Thee. Thy sin cannot hurt, nor thy virtue add any thing to God. He is not therefore actuated by resentment, or jealousy, but by justice. C. --- He revenges the injury done by the sinner to himself, v. 8. S. Aug. Conf. iii. 8. ---

The inference is therefore wrong, (C.) that God will not regard the sins or punishment of men, because he thence derives no profit, v. 3. H. ---

The strong sentences of Eliu agree not (or are ill-applied) to the blessed Job.

S. Greg. xxvi. 7. W.

Ver. 9. Out. The wicked shall cry out, through vexation, but still they will not address themselves to God, v. 10. Why are the abandoned, but because He takes cognizance of all?

Ver. 10. Songs. Arab. "thoughts," by means of visions. Chal. "where is the Lord, in whose presence the angels sing canticles of praise in the night?" C. ---

Sept. "who has ordered the night watches;" (H.) the stars, which display the power of God? His servants also are filled with interior joy, even in the midst of afflictions. C.

Ver. 11. Air: and yet the wicked make not use of their understanding, to have recourse to God under distress. C.

Ver. 13. Vain. Heb. "falsehood." He will not relieve the hypocrite, who does not cry to him with sincerity. This conduct shews that God acts with discretion, and hears people according to their deserts. C.

Ver. 14. Before him. Try whether the assertion be true. H. --- Only change thy life, and hope in him, and thou wilt see the good effects. C.

Ver. 15. For. Prot. "But now because it is not so, he hath visited in his anger; yet he (marg. Job) knoweth it not, in great extremity." H. --- In this world, God punishes not with rigour. C.

Ver. 16. Knowledge. I have shewn that God punishes or rewards according to our deserts, and is not indifferent about our sins. If Job have not experienced the divine bounty, it is because he has not deserved it. C.

CHAPTER XXXVI.

Ver. 3. Beginning. Heb. "afar" from that God, who is ancient, and not of human invention; (Jer.

xxiii. 23.) or from the consideration of the heavens. Nothing could be more magnificent than the descriptions which conclude this fourth part of the discourse. C.

Ver. 4. Lie. Every orator will promise to speak the truth, and will do so sometimes to gain credit.

W. --- Shall be. Heb. "is with thee." Thou art not devoid of sense, and thou wilt (C.) surely approve my reasons, which are suggested by the God of all knowledge. H.

Ver. 5. God. Sept. "Know that the Lord will not cast away the innocent." Theod.

continues to v.

12: "The mighty, in strength of heart, (Wisd. vi.) will not make the impious live, and will render judgment to the poor." H. --- They seem to have read Thom, which is now wanting in Heb. C. ---

"Behold God is mighty, and despiseth not any: mighty in strength and wisdom." Prot. H. --- Eliu begins to prove that God administers justice to all equally. C.

Ver. 7. Just. Heb. Syr. &c. "the just man, he will place him with kings on the throne." C. ---

Exalted, or "extolled" for ever, if they have done well. W. --- He always disposes of kingdoms.

M.

Ver. 9. Violent, while in power and on the throne, or because even in a private station, their will has risen up in rebellion against God. H. --- Poverty and afflictions are scourges, which are often inflicted by mercy, to bring us to a sense of duty. C.

Ver. 10. Ear, by secret inspirations, or by the admonition of pastors. C. - --

Afflictions will also speak louder to them than any orator. H.

Ver. 12. Folly. Heb. "without knowledge." He speaks of princes, (C.) and of all the wicked, who have not known the day of their visitation. H. --- They shall suffer the punishment prepared for fools or wicked men. M.

Ver. 13. Bound, in misery and evil habits. They will not have recourse to God by humble prayer, though they perceive his displeasure, and design in punishing them.

Ver. 14. Storm. Heb. and Sept. "in youth," (H.) being suddenly cut off, without having deplored the sins of their youth. C. --- Effeminate. Heb. "the consecrated" to prostitution. Eliu compares those who will not attend unto God, to the most infamous characters. C. --- Sept. "and let their life be taken away by the angels" (H.) of death. C. xxxiii. 23. C. --- He may allude to the impure Sodomites. M.

Ver. 16. He shall. He would have prevented thee from falling into this irremediable distress, if thou hadst imitated the poor who trust in Him. C. ---

Yea, he will still restore thee to favour, if thou wilt repent. H. --- He will fill thee with joy and plenty. M. --- Foundation. Hebrew, where there is not straitness.

**Prot. He would have rescued thee from distress, and set thee at large.
H.**

--- The psalmist often speaks in the same language. C.

**Ver. 17. Recover. Thou shalt be treated as thou hast treated others.
Heb. is not well understood.**

**It may be, "Thou hast spoken like the impious; but judgment and
justice rule.**

**(18) Beware lest wrath overtake thee, so that thy prayers may not avert
it. (19) Will He regard thy cries, thy riches, gold or strength?" C.**

**Ver. 19. Without, or before thou be forced by tribulation. M. --- Lay
aside all sentiments of pride, (S. Greg.) or keep in awe the mighty, who
administer justice in thy name. M. --- Prot.**

**"Will he esteem thy riches? No, not gold, nor all the forces of strength."
Sept.**

**"Let not a willing mind incline thee unjustly to the prayer of the needy
in distress." H.**

**Ver. 20. Prolong not the night, &c. Prolong not causes that are brought
before thee, but dispatch, by early rising, the business of them that
come up to thee.**

**Ch. --- Sept. "and all the men of power do not withdraw in the night,"
from just punishment. Theod. adds, "that the people may come up
against them," to demand vengeance. Do strict justice both to the rich
and to the poor, without pity or fear. H. --- This text is very obscure;
and the Heb. may have different meanings, which do not, however,
seem well connected with the rest. "Plant not after night, when people
retire home;" (C.) or Prot. "are cut off in their place." H. --- Delay not
to banish temptations, or they will increase. S. Greg.**

xxvi. 38. W.

Ver. 21. Iniquity, or blaspheming, (C. xxxiv. 37. M.) and murmurs, to which alone thou hast given way since thy fall. C.

Ver. 22. Lawgivers. Heb. more, "a master." In Chal. "a sovereign." Grot. Sept.

"what potentate is against him?" H. --- What art thou, to dare thus to resist him? C. --- S. Gregory (xxvii. 1.) explains this as a prediction of Christ, "or singular lawgiver." God is most able to punish transgressors, and willing to reward those who obey his laws. W.

Ver. 24. Not, is omitted in Heb. and Sept. "Remember that thou magnify his work, which men behold;" Prot. (H.) or "thou hast magnified," formerly. Do so again. --- Sung. The memory of great exploits was commonly preserved by canticles. C.

Ver. 25. All. The rest of this chapter, and the five first verses of the next, seem to be inserted in the Sept. from Theodotion. "Every man sees in himself how many mortals are wounded," &c. ---

Off, in the stars, &c. or in ancient times, what wonders God has performed. C.

--- The works of God are like a ladder, by which we may ascend to the knowledge of him. M. Wisd. xiii. H.

Ver. 27. Floods. God causes the water on the earth to evaporate, (C.) to form the clouds, (H.) which afterwards fall in torrents. M. --- Theod. "the drops of rain are numbered by him," &c. C.

xxvi. 8.

Ver. 29. If. Heb. "Also can any understand the spreading out of the clouds, the elevation or noise of his pavilion?" H. --- What could be more magnificent than the throne of God! C.

Ver. 30. Ends. Lit. "the hinges," or poles, cardines. H. --- Heb. "roots;" Aristotle (Meteor. ii. 1.) and Hesiod (Theog. 727,) use the same term, (C.) to denote the fountains which supply the sea.

H. --- Who ever discovered these deep recesses? Eliu describes a thunder-storm, when the sea is covered with darkness. He intimates that the pavilion of God, though hidden from us by the clouds, is not destitute of light. C. --- God inhabits light inaccessible. H.

Ver. 31. Mortals. Heb. "in abundance." H. --- By thunder he overwhelms many nations, while by moderate rains, he causes the earth to fructify (C.) and nourish mankind. M.

Ver. 32. Hands, or clouds, which are compared to a hand. 3 K. xviii. 44. He opens his hand, and light appears. This expression denotes the utmost facility with which a very surprising thing is effected. --- To come. Heb. "by this obstacle." He alludes to the sun's eclipse, as if God's hand covered its disk. C.

--- Prot. "He...commandeth it not to shine, by the cloud that cometh betwixt."

Ver. 33. To it. The tabernacle of God is designed for his friends. Heb. is very obscure. "Thunder announces the rain, and the very animals know it;" (Virgil describes their signs, Geor. i.) or "His thunder announces from above the clouds his wrath to men." C. --- "The noise thereof sheweth concerning it, the cattle also concerning the vapour."

CHAPTER XXXVII.

Ver. 1. This thunder, the effects of which are so terrible, that it is often styled the voice of God.

C. Ps. xxviii. M. --- The consideration of rewards (C. xxxvi. 33.) stimulates the good, while thunder strikes the heart with terror. W.

Ver. 3. Earth. Lightning appears from the east to the west. Mat. xxiv. 27.

Ver. 4. After. Light travels faster than sound, (H.) though thunder and lightning are produced at the same instant. C. --- Found out. Philosophers can only propose their conjectures on the cause of thunder. This sense is confirmed by the Greek, Chal. &c. Heb. may be, "he delays not;" C. ---

Prot. "he will not stay them;" (H.) rain commonly falling soon after thunder. As the latter is occasioned by the collision of clouds, when they come to a certain distance from the earth, the heat causes them to dissolve into showers, which augments at each crack. C. --- Sept. "For he has done great things, which we have not understood." This is connected with C. xxxvi. 24. Then we read, (v. 7.)

"that man may know his own weakness." All the intermediate verses have been supplied by Origen from Theodotion, or others. H.

Ver. 7. He sealed up, &c. When he sends those showers of his strength; that is, those storms of rain, he seals up; that is, he shuts up the hands of men from their usual work abroad, and confines them within doors, to consider his works; or to forecast their works; that is, what they themselves are to do. Ch.

--- We are all the servants of God. He marks us in the hand, as such. Isai. xlv.

5.

Ezec. ix. 6. Apoc. xiii. 6. The Romans marked soldiers with a hot iron in the hands. Veget. i. 8.

--- The abettors of chiromancy have hence vainly pretended that they can discover each person's future in the lineaments of his hands. C.

Ver. 8. Den. Foreseeing the tempest and retreating for shelter.

Ver. 9. Parts. The south, (C. ix. 9.) whence storms commonly came in that country, (C.) from the sea or desert of Idumea. H. Ps. lxxvii. 26. Zac. ix. 14. Isai.

xxi. 1. --- North wind or pole.

W. --- Yet the south seems to be designated; (v. 17. and C. xxxviii. 32.) though cold comes from the north, in Idumea as well as here. C. --- Mezarim, is rendered by Prot. "north." Marg.

"scattering winds. " Sept. akroterion, "summits" of mountains.

Ver. 10. Abundantly. He cause it to freeze or rain at pleasure. H. Ps. cxlvii. 17.

M.

Ver. 11. Corn requires rain. H. --- Light. As they are transparent, they do not hinder the sun from appearing. Heb. "the brightness of the sky disperses the clouds, and the clouds shed their light" in the rainbow, (v. 15. Grot.) or lightning. Jun. C. M. --- Prot. "Also by watering, he wearieth the thick cloud, he scattereth his bright cloud, (12) and it is turned round about by his counsels, that they may do whatsoever," &c. God prohibits or gives rain. H. --- Nothing is left to chance. C. --- He directeth the clouds as a master does his ship. W.

Ver. 13. Tribe. Hebrew also, "for correction." H. Amos iv. 7. --- Land of promise.

Ps. lxxvii. 10.

Ver. 15. Light: the rain-bow, according to the best interpreters; or the lightning.

C.

Ver. 16. Paths. Heb. "the balancing of the clouds, the wondrous works of Him whose knowledge is perfect?" C. xxxvi. 4. Dost thou know what suspends the heavy clouds in the air? C.

Ver. 17. Are. Heb. "How thy," &c. It is also beyond thy comprehension, why thou shouldst be too hot when the south winds blows (H.) moderately, though tempests generally proceed from the same quarter, v. 9. If thou art in the dark, respecting these things, which thou feelest, how canst thou pretend to fathom and condemn the counsels of God? C. --- Job was far from doing either.

His friends rather undertook to explain God's reasons for punishing thus his servants, which Job acknowledged was to him a mystery, (H.) till God had enlightened him. C. xxii. 3. Houbigant.

Ver. 18. Brass. Heb. "Hast thou with him stretched out (or beaten, as brass, tarkiang; which word Moses uses for the firmament) the heavens, which are as solid (Chal. and like) a molten looking-glass?" which was formerly made of metal. Ex. xxxviii. 8. The Hebrews looked upon the sky as a sheet of brass; and the poets speak of the brazen heaven. Pindar. Nem. vi. Iliad A.

Ver. 19. Darkness. Thou who art so learned, give us some information, what we may blame in the works of God. Cutting irony! C.

Ver. 20. He shall be swallowed up. All that man can say, when he speaks of God, is so little and inconsiderable in comparison with the subject, that man is lost, as it were swallowed up in so immense an ocean. Ch. --- The man who should dare to mention what I could reprehend in God's works, would soon be overwhelmed with majesty. C. --- Alphonsus IX. king of Leon, (A.D.

1252) surnamed "the wise and the astronomer," said "he could have given some good advice respecting the motions of the stars, if he had

been consulted by God;" meaning to ridicule some vain systems of philosophers, then in vogue. Dict. 1774. H.

Ver. 21. Light; being hindered by the clouds, and dazzled when they are removed. Yet we presume to judge of the secrets of Providence! C. --- Away. As there is a constant vicissitude of these things, so there is of happiness and misery. M. --- Sept. "For the light is not seen by all. It is refulgent in beauties, as that which comes thence upon the clouds." If, therefore, this light does not pervade all places, why should we wonder that all do not understand the ways of God? H.

Ver. 22. Gold. Sept. "from the north, gold-coloured clouds. Above these, great is the praise and honour of the Almighty." H. --- When the wind blows, the clouds are dispersed, and the sky appears serene. Each country has its peculiar advantages. In the north, Ophir, &c. may boast of gold: but what ought to be most conspicuous in the praises given to God, is an humble fear.

Pindar begin his Olympic Odes somewhat in the same style. C. --- "Water is excellent, and gold...But if, dear heart, thou wilt sing of games, regard no other star...as brighter than the sun...nor shall we celebrate any game more excellent than that of Olympia." H. --- God disposes of all things as he pleases. He makes the golden day succeed a tempest. But it is our duty to praise him with awe, whatever he may ordain. This is the epilogue. Pineda. --- Man must praise God with fear, as he cannot do it sufficiently. W.

Ver. 23. Worthily. Heb. "the Almighty, we cannot find him out," (H.) or comprehend his nature or mysteries. C.

Ver. 24. Fear him, and receive with respect whatever he shall appoint. H. --- And all. Heb. "he fears not any that are wise of heart." He knows that the most intelligent (C.) must confess their ignorance, when they attempt to examine his divine nature. Simonides being desired by Hiero to express his sentiments on this subject, always requested more time to consider of it. Quia, inquit, res videtur mihi tanto obscurior, quanto diutius eam considero. Cicero, Nat. i. 60.

Selectæ e Prof.

i. 3. --- "With thee (says S. Aug. Conf. i. 6.) stand the causes of all instable things," &c. H. ---

Those who are really wise, will therefore adore God's judgments in silence, while the presumptuous will be forced to yield. This is the excellent conclusion of all that had been said.

Pineda. --- The sentence is beautiful, but ill-applied (H.) to Job. Philip. See Prov. iii. 7. H. --- He convinced the other three with sound arguments, "and this last and most arrogant disputant with silence." W.

JOB 38

CHAPTER XXXVIII.

Ver. 1. Then. Sept. "After Eliu had ceased to speak." H. --- Lord. That is, an angel speaking in the name of the Lord. Ch. --- The name Jehova (H.) here occurs, though it never does in the speeches; whence many have inferred that the Lord spoke in person; which argument, however, is not conclusive; and that this work was written after the apparition in the burning bush. C. --- The Heb. edition would at least be given after that event. --- Whirlwind, designed to strike the senses, (H.) and to represent the distressed condition of Job.

Pineda. --- This awful appearance imposed silence upon all. H. --- Some think that a time was allowed for reflection and repentance, before God passed sentence; but the Sept. &c. seem to suppose that the cause was decided as soon as Eliu had ended his discourse. C. --- God discusses the controversy, and gives sentence in favour of Job. W.

Ver. 2. Words. Many explain this as a condemnation (C.) of the last speaker, (D.) who would otherwise pass without any reproach, (H.) though he had spoken with less reserve than the rest.

C. --- Pineda allows that this opinion is very plausible; but he thinks that Job himself is reprehended, not for any grievous offence, but for indiscreet expressions. C. xli. The context also seem to require this, as Job take it to himself. C. xxxix. 33. C. --- The change of persons might rather imply the contrary: Who is this? Eliu. 3. Gird up thy loins. Job. H. --- Can we admit that the devil got the victory; or, that God falsely declared that Job had spoken right? C.

xlii. Houbigant. --- Did not the latter maintain the truth with greatest zeal, while his friends certainly mixed unskilful words or inferences with sentences of the greatest consequence? His face I will accept, that your folly be not imputed to you; for you have not spoken right things before me, as my servant Job hath.

C. xlii. 8. Heb. "Who is this that darkeneth counsel, by words without knowledge?" Prot. "Who is the who concealeth counsel from me, keeping words in his heart, and thinketh to hide from me?" Sept. Eliu pretended to explain the counsels of God, and perhaps did not utter all that he had in his mind; but God condemns the very harbouring of thoughts, which are contrary to truth and justice. H. --- Job's friends laboured under great prejudices, and condemned him without cause, (C.) thinking that they were doing a service to God, like those who put the apostles to death, and persecuted Catholics on account of their religion. But this plea will not excuse them. Here one line suffices to refute the long harangue (H.) of Eliu; (S. Greg. Ven. Bede. T. &c.) though we have observed, (H.) some understand the words to be addressed to Job, as a rebuke for his too warm expressions. S. Chrys. S. Aug. &c.

C. --- The remainder of the discourse is designed for Job's instruction.
H. ---

Hoc (Eliu) despecto ad erudiendum Job verba vertuntur. S. Greg.

Ver. 3. Loins, like one about to engage in an arduous task, (H.) or journey, (C.) to explore the ways of divine Providence. H. --- Answer my reasons, if thou art able. C. --- Heb. "make me know." H. --- Only the Creator hath perfect knowledge of all his works, as may appear by induction or example: 1. of inanimate; 2. of living things, v. 39. W.

Ver. 4. Foundations. The Hebrews placed the earth in the centre of the universe, resting upon nothing, (C. xxvi. 7. and xxxvi. 30.) or upon itself. See Hesiod, Theog. 325. C. --- These questions seem intended to shew, that if God has created all things for man, he will not surely neglect to watch over him. M.

Ver. 5. Upon it. He speaks of the world as of a vast house, (C.) or palace, (M.) in which the Architect has shewn his art. H.

Ver. 7. Sons. Sept. "all my angels." Hence it appears that the angels were among the first of God's works, formed probably at the same time with the heavens, (C.) or light. Gen. i. 3. H. ---

The praise of the stars is figurative, (C.) as they tend to raise our hearts to God by their beauty, (H.) whereas that of the angels is real. C.

Ver. 8. Shut. Heb. also, (H.) "facilitated the birth of the sea," as a midwife. Grot.

C. --- Forth.

Sept. "raged." H. --- God represents the waters ready to overwhelm all when first produced out of nothing, if he had not shut them up in the abyss, like a child in a cradle, or a wild beast in its den, v. 10. C.

Ver. 9. Mist. So Moses says darkness was on the face of the abyss. Obscurity covered it, as swaddling bands do a child's body. C.

Ver. 10. Set. Prot. "brake up for it my decreed place." Marg. "established my decree upon it;"

(H.) or, "I gave order to break it," against the shore. Jer. v. 22. Amos v. 8.

Ver. 12. Place. Thou art but as yesterday: where is thy power? C.

Ver. 13. And didst. Some explain Heb. "that it (Aurora) might spread at once to the extremities of the earth. Then the wicked flee before it;" as they hate the light. C. xxxiv. 26. Jo. iii. 20. C.

--- Sept. and Prot. may be understood in this sense. H. --- Allusion may also be made to the shaking of a sieve, to separate the wheat from the chaff; (Amos ix.

9. Luk. xxii. 31. C.) or of a carpet, to clean it from the dust. D. --- Did God ask thee to help him to exterminate the wicked?

The short digression in these three verses, shews the punishment exercised on offenders. It is not contrary to the true spirit of poetry. M.

Ver. 14. Seal. Men, formed to the image of God, shall die; and others shall be place in their stead, (M.) with as much ease as an impression is

made upon clay. H. --- Garment. The body seems to be the clothing of the soul, and will be changed. Ps. ci. 27. M. --- Chal. "their form will be changed to clay, and they shall resemble a tattered garment." Heb. "their seal shall be changed like clay,"

&c. All their glory shall perish. C. --- Sept. "hast thou taken earth or clay, and formed a living creature, and endued it with speech on the earth?" Is man the workd of thy hands? H.

Ver. 17. Doors? Sept. "through fear; or have the porters of hell flown away at thy sight?" H.

Ver. 19. Darkness. The poetical style of this book represents these things as real beings, in the same manner (C.) as the house, (v. 20) or palace of the sun,

&c. are described by the ancients. H.

Ver. 23. War. Hail, &c. are like the arrows of God. Jer. x. 13. and l. 25. C.

Ver. 24. Heat. Heb. kadim, (H.) the "east." Sept. "south wind." Perhaps the east winds produced the same bad effects in Egypt, as the south wind did in Judea; (C.) or this noxious burning wind might proceed from the south-eastern point of both countries. H.

Ver. 25. Noisy. Heb. "for lightning, which accompanies thunder?" By these questions, respecting things which to man are impossible, and many inexplicable, God humbles (C.) the pride of the human heart. H.

Ver. 26. Dwelleth. This shews the magnificence of God, (M.) at least. H.

Ver. 31. Pleiades. The seven stars. --- Arcturus. A bright star in the north. Ch. ---

The same terms occur, and are explained, C. ix. 9. H.

Ver. 32. Day-star. Heb. mazzaroth, (H.) corresponds with the "inner parts of the south;" (C. ix.

9) though some translate, "the signs of the zodiac, or the influences," &c. The antarctic constellations could not be seen in Idumea, while those of the north pole (C.) must appear to those who live on that side of the line, (H.) as the perpetual sentinels of the sky. --- Evening-star.

Heb. "Wilt thou make hayish and her daughters go to rest?" These indicate the arctic stars. Here two quite opposite stars are meant; (C.) though (H.) with us the evening and morning star be the same, being so styled according as it appears after or before the sun. M. --- Prot.

"Canst thou bring forth Mazzaroth (Sept. also retain the original term, Mazouroth) in his season, or canst thou guide Arcturus, with his sons?" The former term signifies things "scattered,"

the planets, (H.) or

"the grains of gross air dispersed" to all the extremities, which returning to the centre, occasion cold. C. xxxvii. 9. Parkhurst.

Ver. 33. Reason. Heb. "dominion," (H.) or influence upon the earth.

Mathematicians thought they had discovered these laws, and the number of the stars; but daily experience evinces their error. M.

Ver. 34. Voice, to mimic the thunder of God, (C.) or to order it to rain. H.

Ver. 36. Understanding. That is, to distinguish the hours of the night. Ch. ---

Sept. "Who gave to women the knowledge of the loom, and the art of embroidering?" H. --- It was the part of women to weave, as appears from the conduct of queen Penelope. But the best interpreters translate, "Who has placed wisdom in the reins, or who hath given understanding to the heart," or soul? C. --- God gives wisdom to man, and an instinct to cocks, (H.) or the skill, of which the former is deprived, (W.) to know the approach of day. D.

Ver. 37. Sleep. The ancients have celebrated this harmony. Cic. Somn. Scip. ---

Sept. "Who numbereth the clouds in wisdom, or hath bent the sky down to the earth?" Prot. "or who can stay the bottles of heaven?" H. - -- Canst thou cause it to rain, or to be fair? (C.) or make the celestial bodies (H.) rest from motion?

W.

Ver. 38. Together. When was the water separated from the earth? H. --- Where wast thou when I gave consistency to the rocks? C.

Ver. 39. And satisfy. Sept. "or fill the souls of the dragons?" H. --- Here Heb.

edit. commence the following chap. (C.) and are followed by Prot. (H.) and others, as the proof of God's superior knowledge begins to be established by the consideration of various animals. W.

Ver. 41. Wandering. Sixtus V. reads vagientes, (C.) "crying like children." H. ---

The ravens presently drive their young away to seek for fresh habitations.

Pliny x. 12. Ps. cxlvi. 9. C. --- If God provide for such creatures, He will shew still greater attention to man. W.

JOB 39

CHAPTER XXXIX.

Ver. 1. Goats (Ibex. Heb. Yahale. H.) frequent rocks, and places which are almost inaccessible to man. C.

Ver. 3. Roarings. They pretend that these animals bring forth with great difficulty. Ps. xxviii. 9.

Vatab. &c. --- Aristotle (v. 2. and vi. 29.) asserts, that they receive the male bending down, as Heb. may be here explained. "They bend, they divide their young," as they have often two; "and they leave their strings" at the navel, &c.

C.

Ver. 4. Feed. Being weaned very soon. Pliny viii. 32.

Ver. 5. Wild ass, described, C. vi. 5. The industry of man cannot make this beautiful and strong animal serviceable to him. The like would be the case (C.) with many others, if Providence had not ordered it otherwise. H.

Ver. 6. Barren. Lit. "salt." H. --- This is of a nitrous quality, which renders those countries barren. The salt in snow and dung gives warmth and fruitfulness.

Ver. 9. Rhinoceros. See Deut. xxxiii. 17. Num. xxiii. 22. Sanchez says they are untameable. M.

--- But this is not true, when they have been taken young. Malvenda. C.

Ver. 10. Valleys, or furrows. Can he be made to harrow?

Ver. 13. Hawk. We may also read, "Is the wing of the ostrich like?" Sept. or Theod. "The bird of Neelasa is rejoicing, if she take the Asida, &c. the Neessa."

H. --- Heb. is variously translated,

"The ostrich lifts itself up with its wings, which have feathers, as well as those of the stork."

Bochart. --- It flutters, running like a partridge, swifter than any horse.

Adamson. --- "Canst thou give to the stork and the ostrich their feathers,"

which form all their beauty? C. --- Prot. " Gavest thou the goodly wings upon the peacock, or wings and feathers unto the ostrich?" H. ---

The import of these names is uncertain. M. --- Renanim, (from Ron, "to cry, or move quickly,") may signify peacocks, ostriches, &c. Chasida, "a stork, (H. Jer.) falcon, (W.) or heron; notsa "a hawk, or a feather." H. --- The first term occurs no where else, and may denote any singing birds or grasshoppers, as the last may be applied to the ostrich, which has "wings," though it fly not.

Grot. C. --- Acknowledge the wisdom of Providence, which has thus enabled such a huge animal to travel so fast. M. --- See Parkhurst, álcs. H.

Ver. 14. Dust. This might help to hatch them. C. --- Heb. "earth, and warmeth them in the dust."

Prot.

Ver. 16. Ones, or eggs which she leaves. C. --- Ælian (xiv. 6.) asserts that this bird will expose her own life to defend her young. Yet the neglect of her eggs, will suffice to make her deemed cruel. Lam. iv. 3. H. --- Her. Other birds leave their nests through fear; (C.) but this, after sitting a while, will depart carelessly, (H.) and if she meet with other eggs on her road, will take to them, thus rendering her own useless. Bochart.

Ver. 17. Understanding. This bird has a head disproportionately small; insomuch, that Heliogabalus served up the brains of 600 at one supper. It greedily eats iron, &c. which may help its digestion, as sand does that of other birds. C. --- When it is hunted, it hides its head only, as if this would be a sufficient defence, (Pliny x. 1.) and is taken alive by a man, clothed in the skin of an ostrich, who moves the head with his hand. Strabo xvi. --- All which proves its stupidity. C.

Ver. 18. High. With her head erect, the ostrich is taller than a man on horseback. Pliny x. 1. ---

Its wings are used like sails, and enable it to run as fast as many birds can fly, (C.) while it hurls stones at the pursuer with its feet, so as frequently to kill them. Diod. ii. --- Rider, as they can travel with equal speed. M. v. 13. ---

Adamson (Senegal) placed two negroes on one, and testified that it still went faster than any English horse. H.

Ver. 19. Neighing. Heb. "thunder," to denote the fierceness of the horse; or

"with a mane,"

(Bochart) "armour," (Syr.) or "terror." Sept. C. --- Wilt thou enable the horse to neigh, (M.) when he appears so terrible? H.

Ver. 20. Up. Heb. "frighten," (H.) or "make him leap." Bochart. C. --- Nostrils.

Sept. "of his chest, or shoulders, is boldness." H. --- This inspires the rider with courage, and the enemy with fear. But the Vulg. is more followed. C.

Frænoque teneri

Impatiens crebros expirat naribus ignes. Silius vi.

Ver. 21. Hoof. Ploughing, or rather prancing, through impatience. C. --- Boldly.

Heb. "he exults in his strength," being sensible of glory and commendation. C.

--- Non dubiè intellectum adhortationis et gloriæ fatentur. Pliny vii. 43.

Ver. 23. Shield, or lance. Jos. viii. 18. C. --- The din of armour does not disturb the horse, which has been inured to such things. H. --- It is of singular courage. W.

Ver. 24. Ground. This expression is still used by the Arabs, to denote velocity.

Grotius. --- Sept.

"in wrath he will make the earth disappear." H. ---

Mox sanguis venis melior calet, ire viarum

Longa volunt latumque fugâ consumere campum. Nemesianus.

--- Account. Heb. "believe that," or "stops not when." He is so eager to rush forward to battle.

Si qua sonum procul arma dedêre,

Stare loco nescit, micat auribus et tremit artus. Georg. iii.

Ver. 25. Ha. Lit. "Vah," a sound of joy, (M.) or of contempt. Sept. The trumpet having given the sign, he will say, Well: Euge. Nothing could be more poetically descriptive of the war-horse. H.

Ver. 26. Feathered. Heb. "fly." H. --- South, at the approach of "winter retiring"

to warmer regions. Pliny x. 8. --- Sept. "spreading her wings, looking unmoved, towards the south." The hawk alone can stare at the sun, and fly to a great height. Ælian x. 14. --- Hence the Egyptians consecrated this bird to the sun. C.

--- The eagle is of the same species, and has the same properties. H. Aristotle mentions 10, and Pliny 16 species of hawks. W.

Ver. 28. Access. See Abdias iv. Arist. anim. ix. 32.

Ver. 29. Off. The eagle was remarkably (C.) quick-sighted, (W.) as well as the serpent. Hor. i.

Sat. iii. Homer, Il. xvii. --- They say it can discern a fly or a fish from the highest situation; (Bochart) and if its young seem dazzled with the sun-beams, it hurls them down as spurious.

Pliny x. 3.

**Ver. 30. Blood, gushing forth from the animals, which the eagle brings.
M. --- S.**

Chrysostom explains this of the vulture, (Mat. xxiv. 28. C.) which is of the same species. M. --- Some eagles will not touch carcasses, but others are greedy of them. Pliny x. 3. Prov. xxx. 17. --- There. Our Saviour quotes this passage. Lu.

xvii. 37. C.

Ver. 31. Went on. Sept. "answered." This was the conclusion drawn from the display of God's wonderful works. If we cannot sufficiently admire them, why should we be so much surprised, as Job acknowledged he was, at the ways of Providence? It would, therefore, be better to keep silence, v. 35. H.

Ver. 32. Be so. Receive instruction, or (C.) instruct him? Wilt thou learn to admire my works?

(H.) or dost thou attempt to give me any information? C. --- Him. Heb. "it." Sept.

"shall he decline judgment with him who is competent?" ikanou. Theod. adds,

"the man who accuses God, shall answer it," or stand his trial. H.

Ver. 34. Spoken inconsiderately. If we discuss all Job's words, (saith S.

Gregory) we shall find nothing impious spoken; as may be gathered from the words of the Lord himself; (chap. xlii. v. 7.

8.) but what was reprehensible in him was the manner of expressing himself at times, speaking too much of his own affliction, and too little of God's goodness towards him, which here he acknowledges as inconsiderate, (Ch.) or rather as the effect of inculpable ignorance; (H.) as the present order of things being then novel, confounded the sagacity both of Job and of his friends.

The wicked had formerly been the victims of justice, but henceforth, says Job, (Heb.) "if it shall not be so, who can convince me of lying?" C. xxiv. 25. Yet he did not perfectly discern the intention of God, in abandoning his servants to the power of satan, till the Lord himself had explained it in the parables of behemoth and leviathan. Then Job

testified his conviction and entire submission. C. xlii. 5. Houbigant observes that the Vulg. is perhaps less accurate here, and C. xlii. 3. as God exculpates Job, v. 8. Yet the latter might entertain fear at least, of having exceeded in words, after such pungent question. We may translate, (H.) Heb. "Behold I am vile, (C.) what shall I answer thee?" Prot. or Sept. "Why am I still judged, being admonished and rebuke by the Lord, hearing such things?" (Grabe, after Origen, marks with an obel what follows, as not found in Heb.) "I, who am nothing, what answer shall I then give to these things?" H. --- If we discuss all Job's speeches, we find nothing spoken wickedly, but only a species of pride, in talking too much of his sufferings, and too little of God's goodness and justice, which he ought to have confessed. S. Greg. xxxii. 3. W.

Ver. 35. One. Sept. "Once I have spoken, but I will not add again." H. -- - I have spoken too much, but I will be more cautious. Heb. "I have spoken one thing, and I will not answer; (C.) yea, two things, but I will go no farther." Many of my observations may be too strong, as I am not perfectly aware what may be the designs of Providence in my regard. H.

JOB 40

CHAPTER XL.

Ver. 3. Judgment. Job had frequently acknowledged that God could not be in the wrong. But he had expressed himself in too forcible language, of which God makes him, as it were, ashamed. C.

--- Sept. "rejectest thou not my decision? yea, dost thou think that I have judged thee in a different manner, in order that thou mayst appear just?" H.

Ver. 6. Scatter. Sept. is shorter: (C.) "Send angels or messengers in wrath, and humble every insulting person. 7. Extinguish the proud, destroy the wicked at once. 8. Hide them in the earth together, and fill their faces with shame." H.

Ver. 8. Pit, or grave. Cause the earth to swallow them up, and I will confess thy power. C.

Ver. 10. Behemoth; the elephant, (Ch.) "as some think." Prot. marg. H. --- This is the most common opinion, though Sanchez explains it of the bull; and Bochart, after Beza and Diodati, declares in favour of the hippopotamus, (C.) or "river horse." Parkhurst even thinks Bochart has proved this "to a demonstration." The sea or river horse, (H.) is an amphibious animal, (C.) found in the Nile and Indus, and said to have the feet of an ox and the teeth of a boar, but not quite so sharp, while the neighing, back, mane, and tail, resemble those of a horse. Its hide, when dry, is said to resist even a musket-ball. Button. Dict. --- We find a good description of this animal in Watson, p. 91.

But the plural Bemoth, female (H.) "beasts," seems more applicable to the elephant, on account of its great size, as it is designated by *theria*, or *Bellua*, by the Greek and Roman authors. Suidas. 1 Mac. vi. 35. Pliny viii. 3. --- It may have received the name of elephant from (C.) *alp*, "to lead or teach," (H.) on account of its great sagacity and strength. All that Job says of behemoth, may be well explained of it. The Fathers have supposed, that the devil is meant: but we stick to the literal sense.

C. --- He may, however, (H.) have been hinted at by this name, (W.) as well as by that of leviathan. Houbigant. --- With thee, on the same day, or as well as thee. Amama. --- Grass. The elephant does so, and is by no means savage. C. --- Sept.

"Yet, behold, near thee wild beasts, equal to oxen, eat grass." H. --- The spontaneous productions of the earth, and branches of trees, afford the principal sustenance to satisfy the prodigious stomach of the elephant; which is frequently twelve feet high, and of a dark colour. A sword can pierce it in the back or sides. It has small eyes, eight teeth, and two tusks; which last are sometimes above a hundred weight each, and being cast every tenth year, (Button) afford ivory. The proboscis serves it instead of hands to collect the smallest grain, or to defend itself.

H. --- The female goes with young a whole year, and the duration of its life is generally supposed to be above a hundred. Elephants inhabit warm climates, and were formerly much used in war, to carry wooden towers, from which twenty, or even thirty, men might throw darts. 1 Mac. vi. 37.

Button. --- If this greatest and most temperate of all beasts be overcome by the unicorn, or led by the nose, how much more will God enable man to overcome the devil? W.

Ver. 11. Loins. The towers were fastened here by an iron chain. --- Belly. Yet it is nowhere so easily wounded. 1 Mac. vi. 45. Pliny viii. 20. -- - Hence some would translate Heb. "and its pain in the belly," (C.) as it is only subject to an inflammation and flux; profluvium alvi. Pliny. Ælian xvii. 44. --- But the original rather denotes the parts of generation, which lie concealed, (Arist.

anim. ii. 1. and v. 2.) and are styled the strength. Gen. xlix. 3. Deut. xxi. 17.

Ver. 12. Tail, which is very small, and without hair. C. --- Vavassor rather thinks

"the trunk" is meant. D.

Ver. 13. Gristle. Heb. again, "bones." C. --- Sept. "back-bone, like cast iron."

Ver. 14. Beginning, or prince. H. --- The elephant may be considered as the king of beasts for strength, agility, gratitude, longevity, &c. None approaches so near to man. Pliny viii. 1. C.

Lipsius, 1 ep. 50. Amama. --- Sword; which is the rhinoceros, killing the elephant under the belly with its horn; (Pliny viii. 20. Grot.) or God seems to have entrusted his sword to the elephant, for the destruction of his enemies.

Nothing can withstand its fury, as it overturns houses and trees with its trunk.

Jun. C.

Ver. 15. Play. No animal is of a milder nature. It never attacks, unless in its own defence. When a crowd of other beasts obstruct its passage, it removes them quietly with its proboscis. Pliny vi.

9. &c.

Ver. 16. Places, insomuch that Ælian (iv. 24.) styles it a "beast of the marshes."

It is fabulous that it is forced to sleep against a tree, as if it could not rise without much difficulty. C. --- Sept.

(14) "This is the beginning or chief (arche) of the creation of the Lord, being made for his angels to play with, or beat. Departing to the craggy rock, it has made sport for the quadrupeds in the field. It sleepeth under all sorts of trees; near the reed and papyrus, and the boutomon, or ox-herb." H.

Ver. 18. Wonder. Heb. "make haste," taking time to render it muddy. Ælian xiv.

44. --- It can drink a great deal at once, and then abstain for a week. C. --- Run.

Heb. "he may draw." Sept.

"may knock at his mouth," (H.) in vain, (C.) as long as it can breathe by holding by holding its trunk out of the water. Arist. ix. 46. --- Theod. in the Sept. "If there should be an inundation, it shall not perceive. It confideth that, or when, the Jordan shall knock at its mouth. He shall take it by its eye; saying snares, he shall bore [its] nose." H.

Ver. 19. Stakes. Serpents attack the eyes of the elephant, and sometimes drag it by the trunk into the deep, where it is drowned. Pliny viii. 12.

Solin xxxviii. ---

Others read with an interrogation:

"Shall one take?" &c. Will any one dare to attack it openly? The elephant is taken by stratagem, either in pits covered with a little earth, or by a tame elephant in an inclosure, and (C.) lying on her hack to receive the male. Arist.

anim. v. 2. --- When he has entered, the gate is shut, and the animal is tamed by hunger; being thus taken by his eyes. Judith x. 17. Chal. "They pierce his nostrils with bands." Thus other animals are led about, (v. 21) and the elephant might be so treated in those days; though of this we have no account. C. ---

Prot. "his nose pierceth through snares;" or marg. "will any bore his nose with a gin?" Here they conclude this chapter, which commences C. xxxix. 31. in Heb. But the Sept. agree with us. H.

Ver. 20. Leviathan: the whale, or some sea monster. Ch. --- Prot. marg. "or a whirlpool." H. ---

But some animal is designated; and Bochart understands the crocodile, which agrees very well with the context. The Thalmudists also say that the calbish is a small fish, which gets into the throat of the leviathan. They mean probably the ichneumon, which kills the crocodile by that means. Leviathan, "the winding serpent," (C.) often denotes the dragon or crocodile, (Ps. ciii. 26.

Isai. xxvii. 1.) which frequents the Nile. H. --- It can live as well by land as under water, (Watson, p. 293) and hence may be translated, (H.) "the coupled dragon." Parkhurst. --- Moses mentions the choled, (Lev. xi. 29.) which the Sept. and most others translate, "the land crocodile:"

but what could induce the Prot. "to render it tortoise, we are at a loss to determine." Crocodiles lay about sixty eggs, like those of geese, in the sand, the warmth of which soon hatches them.

Their bodies are covered with scales, which are scarcely penetrable, except under the belly; and they are between twenty and thirty feet in length, running very fast, straight forward, though their feet be short, and they cannot turn easily. They have several rows of sharp teeth, which enter one within another, and their throat is very wide. Button. --
- The same word may however denote whales, (Parkhurst) which are the greatest fishes with which man is acquainted. H. --- They may also be styled coupled dragons, because many smaller fishes accompany them, and they are well protected by scales, &c. M.

--- This huge fish, perhaps the whale, representing the devil, is subject to God.

W. --- Cord. The crocodile may be taken, but with the utmost hazard; though the Tentyrites attacked it without fear. C. iii. 8. Herodotus (ii. 70.) says it may be caught with a hook, baited with hog's flesh, while the fisher has a pig grunting, at which the crocodile come open-mouthed. Having swallowed the hook, it is drawn to land, and its small eyes being filled with dirt it is easily slain. But the method was not yet invented, or was deemed too rash in Job's days.

Ver. 21. Buckle. Lit. "bracelet," (armilla. H.) or ring. Horses were thus ornamented, (Virg. vii.

7.) and other beasts led about. But this fierce animal could not be tamed. Heb.

"Wilt thou put a rush through its gills, or nose, or pierce its jaw with a thorn?"

like those little fishes which are thus brought fresh to market. C.

Ver. 22. Will it lay aside its ferocity, (H.) and flatter thee? M.

Ver. 24. Handmaids? or little girls. C. Sept. "Wilt thou tie it like a sparrow for thy boy?" H.

Ver. 25. Friends. Heb. also, (H.) "enchanters." C. --- Frigidus in pratis cantando rumpitur anguis. Virg. Ec. viii. --- Sept. "the nations." --- Merchants. Sept. "the generation of the Phœnicians (Heb.) of Chanaan, (H.) famous for merchandise, (C.) insomuch that the name is used for any merchant. H. --- Will they salt the crocodile for sale? C. --- Its flesh was much liked.

Herod, &c.

Ver. 26. Cabins, (gurgustium) the reservoir or basket. C. --- Prot. "Canst thou fill his skin with barbed prongs, (for which they have now irons) or his head with fish spears?" --- But this is hardly the meaning of the original. C. xli. 6.

Heb. "wilt thou fill tents with its skin, or the fish net, with its head?" to catch other fish, or to cover thy tent? &c. The skin is very hard, except under the belly. C. --- One defended itself against 36 men, who fired at it six times in vain.

Herera. --- Sept. "a whole fleet collected would not carry off the skin of its tail."

H. --- They seem to speak of the whale. C. --- Theodotion adds, "and its head in fisher boats." H.

Ver. 27. Speak. Heb. "do." H. --- Thy rash attempt will prove thy ruin. If thou escape, thou wilt not dare to engage again. C. --- Sept. "Wilt thou lay thy hand upon it, remembering the battle with its body? and let it not be done any more.

(28.) Hast thou not seen it, nor been astonished at what has been said?" H.

Ver. 28. Down, whoever engages in the conflict, (M.) except the bold citizens of Tentyra. All the rest are terrified at the very sight. Hence the Egyptians have ever given divine honours to the crocodile. C.

JOB 41

CHAPTER XLI.

Ver. 1. I. Heb. "None is so fierce that dare stir it up." H. --- Cruel, or rash, like those to Tentyra.

C. iii. 8. C. --- This monster is terrible to those that flee, while it retires from the pursuer. --- But only these people dare to attack it. Pliny viii. 25. --- "I will not ask the crocodile to revenge me of my enemies," as some might do in a rage, through impotence. H. Sanchez. M. --- Countenance, even though they might overcome the crocodile. God is here speaking. Sept. "Dost thou not fear, since it is ready for thee, (Grabe substitutes, "me," for who will resist me?" or, "who shall stand against me, and live? All," &c. v. 2. H. --- God ruleth not with cruelty, like a tyrant, but with justice, ease, and power. W.

Ver. 3. Supposition. This is explained by the Fathers as spoken of the devil.

Amama. --- But the Hebrew may signify, that God will reward each one according to his deserts, and that Job had consequently no reason to complain; or it means, that the strength and beauty of the crocodile should be made known. C. --- "I will not conceal his parts, nor his power, nor his comely proportion." Prot. "I will not keep silence on his account, and the word of power shall take pity on his equal." Theod. in Sept. H.

Ver. 4. Garment, or the skin. M. --- Who shall look steadfastly, or dare to take off its skin? ---

Mouth. Prot. "Who can come to him with his double bridle?" (H.) though it be of the greatest strength; or, who will enter its jaws, or put bits in them? It is reported that the Tentyrites jump on the crocodile's back, and having thrown a piece of wood into its open mouth, like bits, which they hold with both hands, they conduct it to the river side, and kill it. Pliny viii. 25. --- Sept. "Who would enter the wrinkles of his breast, (C.) or the folds of its coat of arms?" which may allude to the

almost impenetrable scales of the leviathan. H. --- Sym. "Who will enter the folds of its scales?" The crocodile can open its mouth so wide as to swallow a heifer, or to let a man stand upright. C. --- Each jaw is furnished with thirty-six teeth. Vansleb.

Ver. 6. Body. Sept. "entrails are like brazen shields." Prot. " His scales are his pride shut up together, as with a close seal." H.

Ver. 9. Sneezing. When the whale breathes, it causes the water to foam.

Pineda. M. --- The eyes of the crocodile are also (H.) very bright, when out of the water. Pliny viii. 25. They appear first, and therefore were used as an hieroglyphic of Aurora, (Horus i. 26.) or of the morning star. H. ---

Syr. "His look is brilliant." Arab. "The apples of his eyes are fiery, and his eyes are like the brightness of the morning." Sept. "like Aurora." C. --- Olaus (xxi. 5.) says, "that they eyes of the whale shine at night,...and at a distance, are taken by fishermen for great fires."

Ver. 10. Fire, when they spout water, (M.) or pursue their prey open mouthed.

This description is extremely poetical, like that of anger. 2 K. xxii. 9. C.

Ver. 11. Smoke; breath, or streams of water sent upwards.

Ver. 12. Breath, like bellows, v. 10. M.

Ver. 13. Neck. Some deny that the crocodile has any, being formed like a lizard.

But it is a dispute about words. The animal turns with difficulty, so that Thomas Gage assures us he escaped one by going in different directions. ---

Want. It ravages a whole country. Heb. "fear."

C. --- Prot. "sorrow is turned into joy before him;" which seems strange. Sept.

"destruction runs before him." H. --- The poets place fear, carnage, &c. in the train of Mars. C.

Ver. 14. Place; though people may shoot at him, they will make no impression.

C. xl. 20. 26. H.

--- If God send his thunderbolts at him, the monster must however perish. C. ---

Sym. "His flesh being cast for him, as in the foundry, (molten) is immoveable."

H. --- Yet God destroyeth him whom man cannot overcome. W.

Ver. 15. Stone. Pineda understands this of the whale's heart. Others suppose that it alludes to its cruel and fearless temper. M. --- The Arabs call a valiant man, "heart of stone." C. --- Smiths.

Prot. "as a piece of the nether millstone, " (H.) which must be larger and more compact than that which is above. C. --- Sept. "He hath stood immoveable as an anvil." H.

Ver. 16. Angels. Elim. That is, the mighty, the most valiant, shall fear this monstrous fish, and in their fear shall seek to be purified, (Ch.) by contribution. Sanchez. --- R. Levi has given a ridiculous exposition, which is adopted by Sa (Amama) and others, (H. see Ezech. ii. 7. Arist. iv.

prob. 32.) as the natural consequences of fear. C. M. --- The Fathers refer this to the fall of Lucifer, when the other angels might tremble for their own safety.

H. --- Angels with reverent fear honour God's power, and his most perfect servants are filled with apprehensions at his judgments; as the most valiant are terrified at the sight of this huge fish. W. --- Sept. "If he turn, there is fear among the wild quadrupeds, jumping on the land." Heb. "When he raiseth up himself, the mighty are afraid: by reason of breakings, they purify themselves."

(Prot.) or "spoil themselves," (C.) expecting nothing but certain death. Amama.

Ver. 17. Plate. Prot. "habergeon." The precise nature of these arms is not known. C. --- Neither offensive or defensive weapons can avail. M. -- All agree that the crocodile can be pierced only under the belly. C.

Ver. 19. Are. Lit. "are turned into stubble," as in Heb. H. --- They have no more effect. M.

Ver. 20. Hammer. Sept. sphura, means also, "the bottom of a rock." This would not overwhelm the whale; as some are represented like floating islands. Prot.

"darts." H. --- Chal. "axe." Others have, "the ballista;" an instrument to throw stones. C.

Ver. 21. Under him. He shall not value the beams of the sun: and gold to him be like mire. Ch.

M. --- Heb. "sharp stones (or potsherds) are under him; he spreadeth (or lieth upon) sharp-pointed things, as upon the mire." H. --- He is not afraid of being hurt.

Ver. 22. When. Heb. "a pot of ointment." This boils out very much. C. -- The flesh of the crocodile has also the smell of musk; (Bochart) and Peter Martyr asserts, that Columbus found some in America, which plunged into the water, and left behind them the odour of musk or castor.

When they are wounded, they give the same perfume to the sea, or rather to the waters, where they abide. The Hebrews style all deep rives and lakes, seas.

C. --- Crocodiles were kept in the lake Mœris, being adored and honoured as gods. Herod. ii. 69. --- Sept. "He deems the sea as a vase of ointment; (23) and the Tartarus of the abyss, like a prisoner." Theod. adds, "He hath considered the abyss as a walk."

Ver. 23. The deep as growing old. Growing hoary, as it were, with the froth which he leaves behind him. Ch. --- The Vulg. has well expressed the force of the original, and shews the rapidity with which the crocodile moves. C. --- Prot.

"one would think the deep to be hoary." The devil transforms himself into an angel (H.) of light. D.

Ver. 24. Power. Heb. and Sept. "none like him on earth," for bulk. --- One. Sept.

"made to be played with, or beaten, by my angels." H.

Ver. 25. He is king, &c. He is superior in strength to all that are great and strong amongst living creatures: mystically it is understood of the devil, who is king over all the proud. Ch. S. Greg.

xxxiv. 4. and 17. W. --- Hence Job perceived that God has also now permitted this cruel foe to exercise a dominion over him, and to pull him from his high station, though innocent. H. --- This would henceforward be more frequently the order of Providence, and therefore he expresses his entire resignation. C.

xlii. Houbigant. --- Pride: the strongest and fiercest animals. H. --- The crocodile has been seen encountering even the elephant, and gaining the victory. He is king of all fishes. Sept. "of all in the waters." Chal. "of all the sons of the mountains:" or Theod. "of arrogance." This may particularly denote the Egyptians, as the crocodile was one of their gods; and people are often styled after them. Num. xxi. 29. Jer. xlviii. 46. C. --- Pharaon even means

"a crocodile," in Arabic. Bochart, Anim. p. ii. b. v. 16. --- He is styled simply, the proud. Ps.

lxxxviii. 11. C. --- The pride of the Egyptians was notorious. Ezec. xxxii. 12. C.

JOB 42

CHAPTER XLII.

Ver. 2. I know. So the Keri orders us to translate, with all the ancient versions, as the Heb. text has, "thou knowest;" which Prof. Chappelow and Schultens deem more "sublime," though one would think it was hardly "sense."

Kennicott. --- Hid. Heb. "of thine can be hindered." All thy orders must be obeyed. It is in vain to keep silence: (C. xxxix. 34.) I will confess openly thy justice and power. H. -- He acknowledges his error, in not having before spoken enough of a just Providence. W.

Ver. 3. Who. Heb. "Who is he that hideth counsel without knowledge?" Prot.

This seems to allude to the words of God. C. xxxviii. 2. Each of my friends has only rendered the ways of Providence more obscure, and I myself have not perfectly understood them. H. --- Unwisely. See C. xxxix. 35. W. D. --- Heb.

"without knowledge, thing wonderful to me, which I knew not." H.

--- Now I comprehend that thou didst not afflict me, but hast given me into the hands of the enemy, as thou wilt hereafter do others of the greatest virtue, that their patience may shine the brighter, and be rewarded. I need inquire no father, now I see thy design plainly, v. 5. He does not accuse himself of any sin or false assertion, but acknowledges his infirmity in not having understood this before, v. 6. Houbigant. --- Sept. "I have been told what I knew not, things great and wonderful, of which I was not apprized." H. --- Who can deny God's providence? D.

Ver. 5. Seeth thee. Some have thought that God now manifested himself from the cloud. Euseb.

Dem. i. 4. Titalman, &c.) But all now agree that he only enlightened his understanding, and made known his designs more clearly. C. --- Job

now perceived that he had spoken too boldly, in saying, Hear, and I will speak, &c.

v. 4. The rest of this book is in prose. T.

Ver. 6. Reprehend. Heb. and Sept. "vilify." H. --- I recall the obscure expression which has occasioned my friends to mistake. D. --- Penance. Heb. "groan."

Sept. "pine away, I look upon myself as dust and ashes." Such are the sentiments which every one will entertain the nearer he approaches to the divine Majesty. H. --- I no longer assert my innocence, but wait patiently in my present forlorn condition, till thou shalt be pleased to dispose of me. How much would the reputation and authority of Job sink, if some of his assertions had been destitute of truth, particularly as the sacred author does not mention which they were! But God exculpates his servant, v. 8. Houbigant. --- Chal. "I have despised my riches, and I am comforted with respect to my children, who are now reduced to dust and ashes." I find a consolation in submitting patiently to my sufferings, which I may have deserved on account of my unguarded speeches. C. --- Job waits not for God's answer, v. 4. He at once feels an interior light, and is resigned. H. --- He had defended the truth against men: now, with more resignation, he is content to suffer, and does penance for himself and others. W.

Ver. 7. Two friends. It is astonishing that Eliu is not also reprehended, as he was no better than the rest. Some answer, that god had passed sentence upon him first. Others maintain, that he spoke with greater dignity of God's judgments, and that his ignorance was blameless; while others remark, that he was connected with some of the three friends, or only came accidentally to enter into the debate. God gives sentence in favour of Job, though with some reproof for his manner of speaking. --- As. They had maintained false doctrines, and shewed a want of due respect and compassion for their friend; (T.) whereas Job's assertions were true. C. --- How then can he be accused of denying the divine justice, or of speaking disrespectfully of Providence? God seemed to interrogate him on this account, though he approved of his sentiments, because some might draw such inferences from his words

as all his friends did. But Job entertained no such ideas. He was not guilty of such folly, v. 8. Sept. "Thou hast sinned, and thy two friends, for you have spoken in my presence nothing true like my servant Job."

Ver. 8. Offer. Sept. "Thou shalt make an oblation, karpoma, for you."

H. --- Yet holocausts seem to have been the only species of sacrifice before Moses. The number seven, has always been in a manner sacred; (C.) being doubled, it shews the greatness of the offence. S. Greg. W. --- Job was to present these victims to God, (C.) as the priest and mediator, (D.) of whom God approved. He officiated for his family, (C.) and was the most honourable person there. H. --- It seems Job was not present when God gave this injunction; perhaps some time after their debates. C. --- Pray.

Behold the efficacy of the prayers of the saints, even while upon earth. How much greater will it be, when their charity is greater and unfailling! H. --- The many sacrifices would not have sufficed, if Job had not joined his prayer, as S.

Chrys. (or 5 con. Judæos) observes. His mediation did not derogate from God's mercy, under the law of nature; not does that of other men injure Christ's under the law of grace, 2 Cor. i. 11. We have here also a proof that both sacrifice and the devotion of the offerer, have their distinct effects; opus operatum, and opus operantis, as the schoolmen speak. Thus Job was honourably acquitted, while his friends were justly rebuked.

Eliu needed no express condemnation; as what God says to one, must be applied to another in the same circumstances. C. xxxiii. 14.

Protestants are therefore inexcusable, who preach a doctrine not only condemned in their fellows, Luther, &c., but long before in ancient heretics: as the justification by faith alone was in the apostles' time, the rejection of the ceremonies of baptism, of confirmation and penance, in the Novatians, &c. See S. Cyp. iv. ep.

2. W. --- Face. Sept. "For I would not accept his face, and if it were not on his account, I had surely destroyed you. For you have not said to me

any thing good (Rom. true,) against (or concerning, kata,) my servant Job."

They acted both against charity and truth. H. --- Before. Prot. "of me the thing which is right."

The words underlined were not so in the earlier edition by Barker, printer to James I. (1613) where some of the marg. translations are also omitted, v. 14,

&c. The matter is of no farther consequence, than to shew that alterations have taken place since the days of James I. who Bible is supposed to be the standard of the English Church. The marginal version is also frequently neglected altogether, (A. 1706) though the authors seem to have looked upon it as equally probable with that in the text. Pref. H.

Ver. 10. Penance. Heb. "return." He resolved to restore him to his former prosperous condition, while he prayed for those who had so cruelly exercised his patience. C. --- Prot. and Vatable, "the Lord turned the captivity of Job:" so any great distress may be styled, though Job was in a manner abandoned to the power and bondage of satan. Sept. "But the Lord gave an increase to Job, and while he was praying for his friends, He forgave them their sin. And," &c.

H. --- Twice, excepting children, who were living (W.) with God. Rabbins. S.

Greg. &c. --- Some also include the years of Job's life, but that is not clear, (see Spanheim, c. 7. C.) though not improbable; as he might very well live twice as long as he had done, if we suppose that he was about (H.) 50 when he was so much distressed (Petau); and thus arrived at the age of 140, v. 16. H.

Ver. 11. Brethren. Who had before shamefully abandoned him. C. vi. 13. C. ---

Bemoaned. Lit.

"shaked their heads at him," (H.) out of pity, (M.) or astonishment, (T. C.) at his fallen state, and at the present change for the better. They helped to restore him to affluence, in conformity with the will of God, who caused their presents of multiply. The kindred and friends of Job were undoubtedly numerous. H. ---

Ewe. Kesita, "lamb," as most of the ancients agree, (Spanheim) or a piece of money, (Bochart) marked with the figure of a lamb. Grot. See Gen. xxxiii. 19. C.

Ear-ring. Heb. Nezem, an ornament (H.) "for the nose," still very common in the East. Sym.

adds, "it was unadorned," (C.) or plain. Sept. "a piece of gold worth four drachms, and not coined," asemon. H. --- Oleaster supposes that the nose was perforated, like the ear. But the ornament would thus be very inconvenient, and we may rather conclude that it hung down from the forehead upon the nose. S. Jer. in Ezech. xvi. Pineda.

Ver. 12. Asses. Sept. "droves of," &c. which would greatly increase the number.

Ver. 14. Dies, &c. "Day...cassia...and horn of antimony." Heb. ---

Yemima...Ketsiha...Keren hapuc. This last may signify (H.) "horn of change,"

(Pagn.) in allusion to Job's different states.

M. D. --- Sometimes we find the Latin names retained, and at other times translated. It would perhaps be as well to give their force

uniformly in English, or rather to insert the original terms, if they could be now properly expressed.

But that is impossible. Prot. Jemima, "handsome as the day." Kezia, "superficies, angle, or cassia." Keren-happuch, "the horn or child of beauty."

The marginal explanations are given at least in the edit. Edinb. 1787. H. ---

Cassia, an aromatic herb, which is perhaps not now found to be found in Europe, Matthiol. in Dios. i. 12. --- The Arabs like to give such names to their children. Spanheim, Hist. Job. --- Cornustibii, (Heb. Puc) means a sort of paint, used to blacken the eyelids, (4 K. ix. 30.) or a precious stone, Isai. liv. 11. Chal.

"brilliant as an emerald." She was so styled, on account of her great beauty, (C.) in which she was not inferior to her two sisters. Sept. "Horn of Amalthea,"

(H.) or of plenty, (C.) which is not an approbation of the fable, but to show the abundance which Job now enjoyed. Nicetas. ---

Cassia might remind him of the bad smells to which he had been exposed. M.

T.

Ver. 15. Daughters. Sept. Alex. adds, "and sons." --- Brethren. This was contrary to the custom of the Jews, (Num. xxvii. 8.) but conformable to the Roman laws, and to the Koran. Sur. 4. C.

Ver. 16. Years, in all, as Judith is said to have dwelt in the house of her husband 105 years; though it is agreed that she only lived that space of time.

H. --- Authors are much divided about the length of Job's life. Some suppose that he was afflicted with the leprosy at the age of 70, for several months, (T.) or for a whole year, (C.) or for seven, (Salien) and that he lived twice as long after his re-establishment, in all 210. C. T. Sept. "Job lived after his chastisement 170," (Grabe substitutes 140 years. Then he marks with an obel as redundant) "but all the years which he lived were 248;" and adds from Theod. "And Job saw his sons and their children, even the fourth generation."

H. --- The old Vulg. had also 248 years; while some Greek copies read 740. But Grotius thinks the life of Job was not extended beyond 200. Petau and Spanheim say 189, (C.) and Pindea 210, or rather 280, years. Yet the life of man, in the days of Moses, his contemporary, was not often longer than 120; so that if we allow Job 140, he would be an old man, and might see the fourth generation, v. 10. H. --- The Greeks celebrate his festival on the 6th, the Latins on the 10th of May. Pineda. -- Days. Here a long addition is found in the Greek, Arab. and old Vulg.; and Theodotion has also inserted it in his version, as it seems to contain a true and ancient tradition, (see Eus. præp. ix. 25.) though the Fathers have properly distinguished it from the inspired text. It stands thus in the Alex. Sept. with an obel prefixed: "But it is written, that he shall be raised again, with those whom the Lord will restore to life. " He, this man, as it is translated from the Syriac book, lived in the land of Ausites, (Hus.) on the borders of Idumea, and of Arabia, and was before called Jobab. But marrying an Arabian woman, he begot a son

by name Ennon. But his father was Zareth, a descendant of the sons of Esau, and his mother was Bossora; (Arab, a native of Bosra) so that he was the 5th (Arab the 6th) from Abraham. Now these were the kings who reigned in Edom; over which country he also ruled. First, Balac, son of Semphor; (others have Beor) and the name of his city was Dennaba.

After Balak, Jobab, who is called Job. After him, Assom, a leader from the country of Theman. After this man, Adad, son of Barad, who slew Madian in the plain of Moab; and the name of his city was Gethaim. But the friends who came to him were, Eliphaz, [son of Sophan] of the sons of Esau, king of the Themanites; Baldad, [son of Amnon, of Chobar] of the Auchite tyrant; (Grabe substitutes the tyrant of the Sauchians, as they call our Shuhites) Sophor, king of the Mineans." What is marked with crotchets, (H.) has been probably taken from Theodotion. See the Greek Catena. What follows occurs in the Alex.

MS. C. --- "[Theman, son of Eliphaz, he, as the Syriac book is rendered, lived in the land of Ausites, on the borders of the Euphrates. His former name was Jobab, but Zareth was his father, from the sun rising."] or eastern country. H.

--- Job might very well be the 5th or 6th from Abraham, if he were a contemporary with Moses, as Levi and Amram would live at the same time with Rahuel and Zare; (See 1 Par. i. 35. 44.) so that this tradition agrees with history.

But what is said of the Syriac version is not so certain. C. --- Some think the Syriac or Arabic was the original text, as the Greek seems to indicate, *outos ermeneuetai ek tes Suriakes Biblou, en men ge katoikon, &c.* The passage at the end, where this is repeated, may be an interpolation, as the latter part seems rather to belong to Job. For how could Theman have both Eliphaz and Zareth for his father? Grabe therefore, marks it as such. It would be too long for us to transcribe (H.) the praises which the Fathers have given to Job, and the resemblance which they have discovered between him and Jesus Christ.

See Heb. iv. 15 and xiii. 12. Tert.

patient. S. Chrys. hom. xxxiv. in Matt. S. Ambrose, in Ps. xxxvii. 21. observes, that his behaviour on the dunghill was the greatest condemnation of satan, who fell by pride, though so highly favoured. C. --- Besides the literal sense of this book, which displays the trials and victories of Job, we may consider him as a lively figure of Christ; who was perfectly innocent, and yet a man of sorrows: we may raise our minds to the contemplation of the greater glory which will attend the bodies of the just, after the resurrection; and, above all, we may discover lessons of morality, enforcing the observance of every virtue, and particularly of patience and resignation. S. Greg. &c. W. --- The books of Machabees, which are the only remaining pieces of sacred history, might have been here inserted, as they are in Calmet's edition, that so all the historical part might come together. But it is more common to place those books after the prophets. They only relate a few of the transactions which took place during the 400 or 500 years preceding the Christian era. The rest must be borrowed from Josephus, or from profane authors.

It would, however, be proper to read those books, and to have an idea of that period, before we attempt to explain the prophecies. H.